

*Our
Twelfth Step Work*

**THE FORTY-EIGHTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*1998
Final Report*

Crowne Plaza Manhattan, New York, NY April 19-25, 1998

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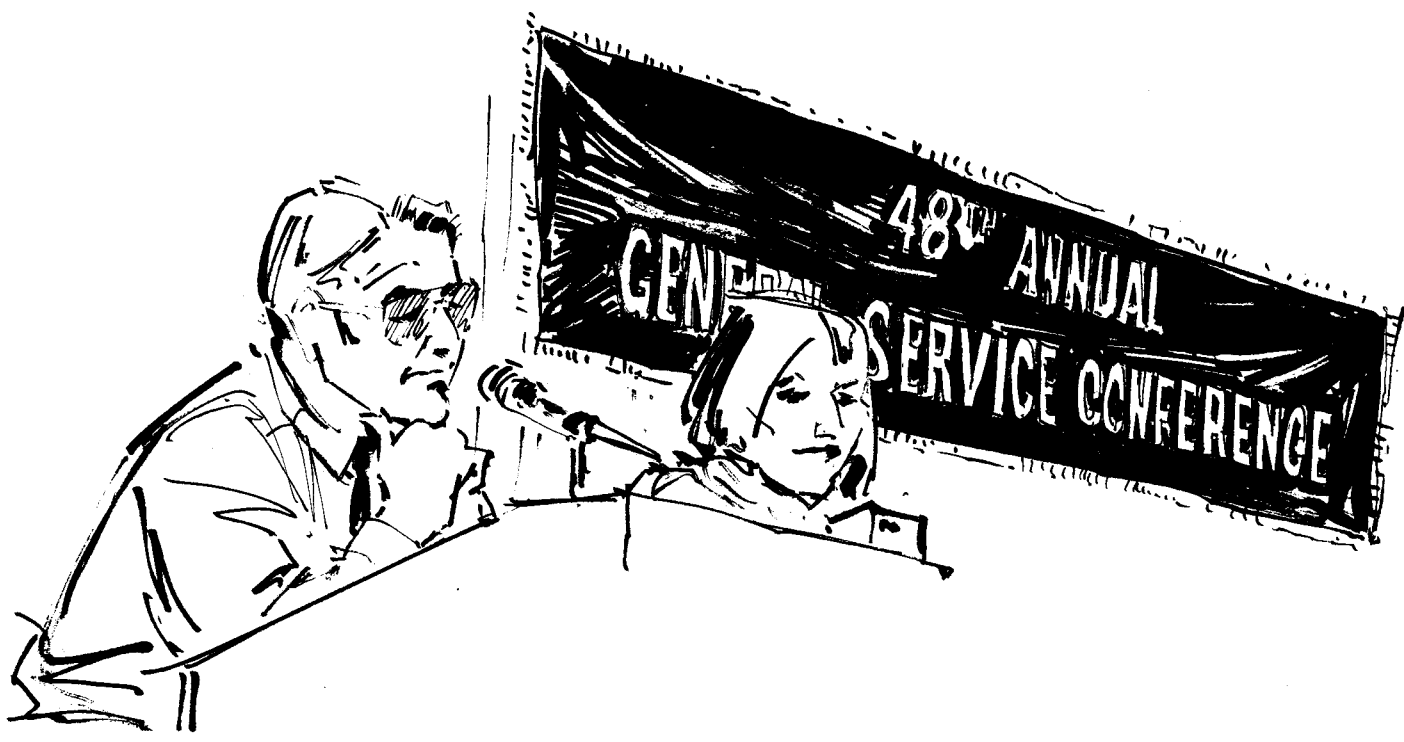
Contents

Our Twelfth Step Work	3	International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums	30
Greetings	4	Literature	31
Keynote	5	Loners, Internationalists, Homers	33
Workshop	5	Nominating	33
Conference Advisory Actions	7	Public Information	34
Floor Action	7	Service Material	36
Agenda	7	Spanish Services	36
Cooperation With the Professional Community	7	Staff Coordinator	36
Correctional Facilities	7	Treatment Facilities	37
Finance	7	Reports from the A.A. Grapevine	38
Grapevine	7	Grapevine Circulation—Geographic Breakdown	40
International Conventions/Regional Forums	7	Literature Distribution	41
Literature	7	Area Service Highlights	44
Policy/Admissions	7	Additional Committee Considerations	51
Public Information	8	Committee Recommendations Not	
Report and Charter	8	Resulting in Advisory Actions	53
Treatment Facilities	8	Floor Actions Not Resulting in Advisory Actions	53
Trustees	8	Financial	54
Presentations	9	Combined Statements of Financial Position	54
Finance	9	Combined Statements of Activities	55
Our Twelfth Step Work	11	Combined Statements of Functional Expenses	56
Reaching the Newcomer	11	Combined Statements of Cash Flows	57
Carrying This Message	11	Report of the Independent Auditor	58
Back to Basics	13	1998 Budget Highlights: G.S.O. and Grapevine	61
Tools for Twelfth Stepping	13	1998 G.S.O. Budget	62
The A.A. Member	13	1998 Grapevine Budget	63
Sponsorship	14	1998 Contributions from Groups—by Delegate Area	64
Literature	15	1998 Conference Committees	65
Diversity of Twelfth Step Work	16	1999 Chairpersons and alternates	65
Home Group	16	1998 Trustees' Committees	66
Service Structure	17	1998 Conference Members	67
Around the World	17	Trustees (General Service Board)	67
Reports from the General Service Board,		A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors	69
Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.	19	G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs	69
General Service Board	19	Area delegates	69
A.A. World Services, Inc.	21		
Archives	23		
Conference	24		
Cooperation With the Professional Community	25		
Correctional Facilities	26		
Finance and Budgetary	27		
Estimates of Groups & Members	27		
General Sharing Session	28		
International/World Service Meeting	29		

Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



48TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Our Twelfth Step Work

In Rosedale, Indiana, two evenings prior to leaving for the General Service Conference, Sue Felgenauer found herself fretting over last minute Conference preparation—travel plans, packing, pet care arrangements. Then it was time for the new (Panel 48) delegate to make that final call to her sponsor. During the conversation Sue learned that a woman she had previously sponsored was out drinking, after four years of sobriety. Sue immediately made the Twelfth Step phone call—just as the woman was heading out to meet her drinking companion.

"That phone call was right on time for both of us," Sue said. "Our friend found a bit of hope in our conversation, and is back in A.A. meetings, and I was no longer worried about the logistics of the week ahead. Instead, I was focused more than ever on our Conference theme, 'Our Twelfth Step Work.' I was grateful, renewed, reminded, remembering."

The 48th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, U.S. and Canada, met at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan, April 19-25. The Conference consists of 131 voting members: delegates from the 92 service areas in the U.S. and Canada, 20 trustees (13 alcoholic and 7 nonalcoholic) of the General Service Board, plus directors of the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Corporate Boards and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff.

Some interesting statistics on the 92 delegates: The average delegate age is 50.7, with the oldest being 70 and the youngest 31; average length of sobriety is 14.8, longest sobriety 30 and shortest 7; with average length of service 12.6, longest 27, shortest 7.

Sunday evening, prior to the Monday morning opening session of Conference week, there was the Opening Dinner/Reception, followed by a A.A. meeting. Joe Varonin (Southern California) chaired the meeting and Eddie McGee (Northern New Jersey) led. Speakers were: Christine Hofer (Southeast Michigan); Keith Lake (Northwest Ontario); Cynthia Keyworth, Grapevine senior editor; George Dorsey, G.S.O.'s general manager; and Julian Rhinehart, Pacific regional trustee. It was an upbeat, noisy, joyful time, with new delegates (Panel 48) getting acquainted with the second-year delegates (Panel 47), trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors and staff.

Monday morning the Conference was officially opened with a welcome from chairman of the board Gary Glynn, followed by the calling of the roll, and greetings by delegate chair Bob Kosloff (page 4). The keynote address was given by Bill Bungay, Eastern Canada regional trustee (page 5).

This year's Conference was chaired by Gary Glynn, Class A

(nonalcoholic) chairman of the General Service Board. Assisting with the chairing duties: George Dorsey, G.S.O.'s general manager; Bob Kosloff, delegate chairperson (California, Northern Coastal); and John Chappel, M.D., Class A trustee and vice-chairperson of the board. G.S.O. staff member Joanie Moncrief was Conference coordinator.

Throughout the busy week, often from 9:00 am to 9:00 pm, Conference members heard Presentations (page 9) and Area Service Highlights (page 44). There were two What's on Your Mind? sharing sessions and a workshop based on the Conference theme (page 5). Each morning at 7:30 the G.S.C. Serenity A.A. Group met to share on various readings from A.A. literature. And, of course, there were the meetings of the 12 standing Conference committees where individual agenda items were discussed and reviewed. Beginning Wednesday evening, each committee presented their report, recommendations and suggestions to the entire Conference for consideration and voting. Many of these recommendations became Advisory Actions (page 7).

Wednesday afternoon trustee elections were held. Marne Hill of Thunder Bay, Ontario, was elected to serve as the new Eastern Canada regional trustee, replacing rotating Bill Bungay; Jim Clough of Newport Beach, California, will be the new Pacific regional trustee, following Julian Rhinehart. Jacqueline Johnston, of Westlake Village, California, will serve as the new general service trustee. New nontrustee directors will be Jan Polek and Ron Gauthier, A.A.W.S. Board.

At the Delegates Only Dinner, Tuesday evening, Vic Booth, Western Ontario, was elected delegate chair for the 1999 Conference; Bjarne (B.J.) Kristiansen of Wyoming will be the alternate chair.

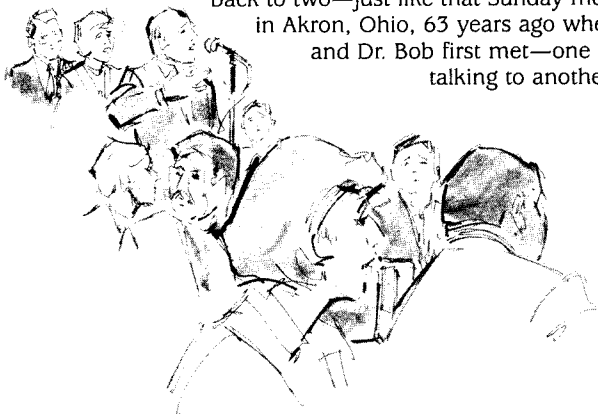
The 48th Conference closed Friday afternoon with the Serenity Prayer in English, French and Spanish. At the Saturday morning Closing Brunch all came together for the final time to hear talks by the two rotating regional trustees, Bill Bungay and Julian Rhinehart, and John N. Chappel, M.D., Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, who has served on the board since 1989.

G.S.O.'s general manager, George Dorsey, who will retire at the end of the year, also gave a farewell talk. This was George's thirteenth Conference, having served as delegate, A.A.W.S. director, trustee and, since 1992, general manager.

Sadly missing from this final gathering, but remembered with love and gratitude, was Raul M., Southwest regional trustee, who died in March.

Throughout the presentations, workshop, sharing sessions (both formal and informal) many ideas were put forth on the ways and means of A.A.'s Twelfth Step—being available to and welcoming the newcomer; being there to listen; making coffee; supporting and serving our home group, district and area; just staying sober.

But, when all is said and done, with all the sophisticated technology—computers, videos, PSAs, printed word, it still goes back to two—just like that Sunday morning in Akron, Ohio, 63 years ago when Bill and Dr. Bob first met—one drunk talking to another.



Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

Welcome to the 48th General Service Conference. I am grateful that you have allowed a drunk like me to participate in an event like this. For those attending their first Conference, I want to assure you that as the week progresses your view of Alcoholics Anonymous will grow beyond your wildest imagination. Last year, as the delegate chairperson was greeting the Conference, I was almost ready to go home out of frustration and a feeling of being scared and overwhelmed. In the true spirit of A.A., my fellow delegates treated me with love and kindness. You allowed me to open my mind to new and different ideas, and to soften my heart to those around me. You also reminded me that, as strange as it sounds, in a certain respect what we do here is not the most significant part of the experience. What I will always remember and hold in my heart about the General Service Conference is the "process"—how we do our business.

Our theme for this Conference is "Our Twelfth Step Work." During the week we will hear various presentations from several delegates, and on Wednesday we will all have the opportunity to engage in a loving discussion at the workshop sessions. In reflecting back on last year's Conference, I am grateful to have this theme to guide us this year.

The person who was instrumental in guiding me into general service is fond of referring to the types of things we do here as a "Twelfth Step to the future." Whenever I find myself caught up in a loving discussion of what I think is important A.A. business, or dissecting a new agenda topic, I like to be reminded of the fact that I am here to serve—not govern.

In that spirit, the theme this year helps us to remember that there are numerous ways we, as members of Alcoholics Anonymous, can go about doing "Our Twelfth Step Work." I can welcome a newcomer to their first meeting; I can make coffee for my home group; I can inform my group of the literature that is available to help carry the message; I can do my share of performing group service positions—the list is endless. What is important is that I not lose sight of my purpose—to stay sober and help other alcoholics achieve sobriety.

Although I had been in general service for a number of years prior to attending my first General Service Conference as delegate last year, I was unfamiliar with how the process of the committee system works. We can achieve a huge amount of work here this week, and remain relatively sane, if we do not micro-manage every suggestion a committee presents to us later in the week. As we go about our business, I would hope that we carry on the custom of previous Conferences, to laugh with one another as we try to mix A.A. business with what I believe all of us truly want—to insure that we do our best, in heartfelt gratitude, to be a part of Alcoholics Anonymous and reaching out to the drunk who still stumbles in the darkness.

I want to personally thank the G.S.O. staff for making the Conference so wheelchair accessible that even I do not stumble—either in the darkness or in broad daylight. In performing our tasks as we go through the week, let us remember those serving with us who are also committed to the process. Our Twelfth Step work can begin right here with each other. As we are faced with challenges and the inevitable time crunch this week, let us trust the committee system, and each other, to do the work we have been sent here to do. Sometimes our Twelfth Step work is to simply love and respect the person we are having a loving discussion with.

Thank you for allowing me to join you as we trudge the road toward happy destiny.

*Robert Kosloff, California, Northern Coastal
delegate chairperson*

Keynote Address

Good morning and welcome to our 48th General Service Conference. My name is Bill and I am an alcoholic; my home group is the Corner Brook East Serenity Group in Corner Brook, Newfoundland. The theme of our Conference this year is "Our Twelfth Step Work," and over the last few months I have been putting a lot of thought into how we are carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Step Twelve reads: "Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics and to practice these principles in all our affairs."

In *The A.A. Service Manual*, Bill Wilson wrote about A.A.'s Legacy of Service: "Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles, it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die.

"Hence, an A.A. service is anything whatever that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer—ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service.

"Services include meeting places, hospital cooperation, and intergroup offices; they mean pamphlets, books, and good publicity of almost every description. They call for committees, delegates, trustees, and conferences. And, not to be forgotten, they need voluntary money contributions from within the Fellowship.

"These services, whether performed by individuals, groups, areas, or A.A. as a whole, are utterly vital to our existence and growth....

"Concerning any given service, we therefore pose but one question, 'Is this service really needed?' If it is, then maintain it we must, or fail in our mission to those who need and seek A.A." (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, pp. S7-8)

The other question we must ask ourselves, is, "Why do we need a Conference?" The late Bernard Smith, then chairperson of the board of trustees, answered that question superbly in his opening talk at the 1954 meeting. "We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery. We do need it to insure recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness one short block from this room. We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined to alcoholism. We need it to provide, in keeping with our Twelfth Step, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who, in the ages ahead, can find in A.A. that rebirth which brought us back to life." (*ibid*, p. S43)

On a personal note, I could not find sobriety through the Fellowship until I started practicing the Steps on a continual basis. Looking back to my early days of sobriety, I realize the importance of belonging to a home group and that is where I started to do Twelfth Step work.

I can remember my first call to A.A. It was in March 1966. An A.A. member came to my house that night and shared his story and how he was staying sober on the A.A. program. He told me that alcoholism was a disease and that I was only asked to stay sober one day at a time. These were the only words that stuck with me that night and I knew I wanted what this man had. I went to my first meeting the next night and was greeted with open arms, and I got such a lift from that meeting that I felt I was walking on a cloud. However, after a few months I began to doubt if I really was an alcoholic. I couldn't identify with a lot of the sayings in A.A. or I wouldn't let myself become part of the

program. What happened? I went out drinking again. I was in and out of A.A. for about a year after that, and each time I came back to A.A. after a slip I was welcomed back and told to keep trying. I am grateful today that the members that Twelfth Stepped me went that extra mile. If this hadn't happened, I would not be here today.

Over the years I have had some wonderful experiences doing Twelfth Step work. Sometimes it has not been successful, but we must remember that in trying to help another alcoholic we are helping ourselves. This is why A.A. is called a selfish program. I also have some fond memories of helping someone on this program who is now living a full, content life.

There is "...no greater joy than in a Twelfth Step job well done. To watch the eyes of men and women open with wonder as they move from darkness into light, to see their lives quickly fill with new purpose and meaning, to see whole families reassembled, to see the alcoholic outcast received back into his community... and above all to watch these people awaken to the presence of a loving God in their lives—these things are the substance of what we receive as we carry A.A.'s message to the next alcoholic." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 110)

"Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics. It works when other activities fail. This is our *twelfth suggestion*: Carry this message to other alcoholics! You can help when no one else can. You can secure their confidence when others fail....

"Life will take on new meaning. To watch people recover, to see them help others, to watch loneliness vanish, to see a fellowship grow up about you, to have a host of friends.... Frequent contact with newcomers and with each other is the bright spot of our lives." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 89)

In closing I would like to quote from the Twelfth Step: "We have been talking about problems because we are problem people who have found a way up and out, and who wish to share our knowledge of that way with all who can use it. For it is only by accepting and solving our problems that we can begin to get right with ourselves and with the world around us, and with Him who presides over us all. Understanding is the key to right principles and attitudes, and right action is the key to good living; therefore the joy of good living is the theme of A.A.'s Twelfth Step." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 125)

Thank you for listening and God Bless!

William Bungay,
Eastern Canada trustee

Workshop: Our Twelfth Step Work

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups of 12 to 14 for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme. Following are the questions and a summary of responses from these discussions.

1 In the Home Group: How are newcomers made to feel welcome and accepted? How is sponsorship emphasized? How is the importance of Twelfth Step work conveyed? What about support of the local central office/intergroup?

The consensus was that newcomers are vitally important to the life and health of the home group. Greeters at the door are a customary way to welcome newcomers and help them to feel accepted. Many groups have Beginners and Open meetings that focus on the first three Steps. Big Books, literature packets, local meeting lists and telephone numbers are given out to newcomers; many groups offer temporary sponsorship. Some home

groups give out chips to celebrate sobriety dates, and many have sobriety day-counts. A good number of groups welcome newcomers from treatment or correctional facilities, as well as court-referred attendees. Conference members pointed out that the benefits of service are often emphasized beginning with helping to pick up chairs and doing kitchen chores.

Most groups stress the importance of sponsorship, (the sponsorship pamphlet is a useful tool), and many groups hold regular topic meetings on sponsorship. Temporary sponsorship is common, whenever possible assigning same-sex sponsors to newcomers. A good number of groups conduct annual sponsorship workshops or stress the value of sponsorship when taking an annual group inventory.

Being involved in Twelfth Step work is paramount in most groups—through the avenues of speaking; sponsoring; offering car rides; taking on the responsibility of institution meeting commitments; arranging, in some cases, to offer translation or signing services; and being available to service committees, as needed, as a P.I. speaker in schools and elsewhere.

The vast majority of home groups support their local central office, intergroup or answering service, either through direct participation, by answering telephones, being available for call-forwarding, or being on other Twelfth Step lists. Financial support of these A.A. entities by the groups is an important commitment for most A.A. groups.

2 In the Service Structure: How are G.S.R.s welcomed and made to feel “a part of...”? Are members not yet involved encouraged to attend district and area meetings? Are areas and districts democratic in thought and action?

G.S.R.s are welcomed into the structure in all areas. Some send out welcome letters, others begin organizing car pools to be sure that new G.S.R.s can get to assemblies. Many delegates or D.C.M.s schedule visits to the G.S.R.s’ home groups. New G.S.R.s are introduced at assemblies in various ways: some ask the new G.S.R.s to stand up, individually or collectively, and be introduced; others line up at the microphones and are invited to share or at least introduce themselves; What’s on Your Mind?

sessions are scheduled for the newcomers; and different color identifying badges are often provided. Many areas hold “G.S.R. Orientation Workshops,” with handout packages; in some areas the new officers are assigned to area or district service committees; most include G.S.R.s in assembly voting. Some areas provide service sponsors for G.S.R.s.

All A.A. members are welcome and encouraged, by printed or oral announcements, to attend service structure meetings. Some send out notices directly to the groups inviting attendance. Others schedule service workshops at each area meeting.

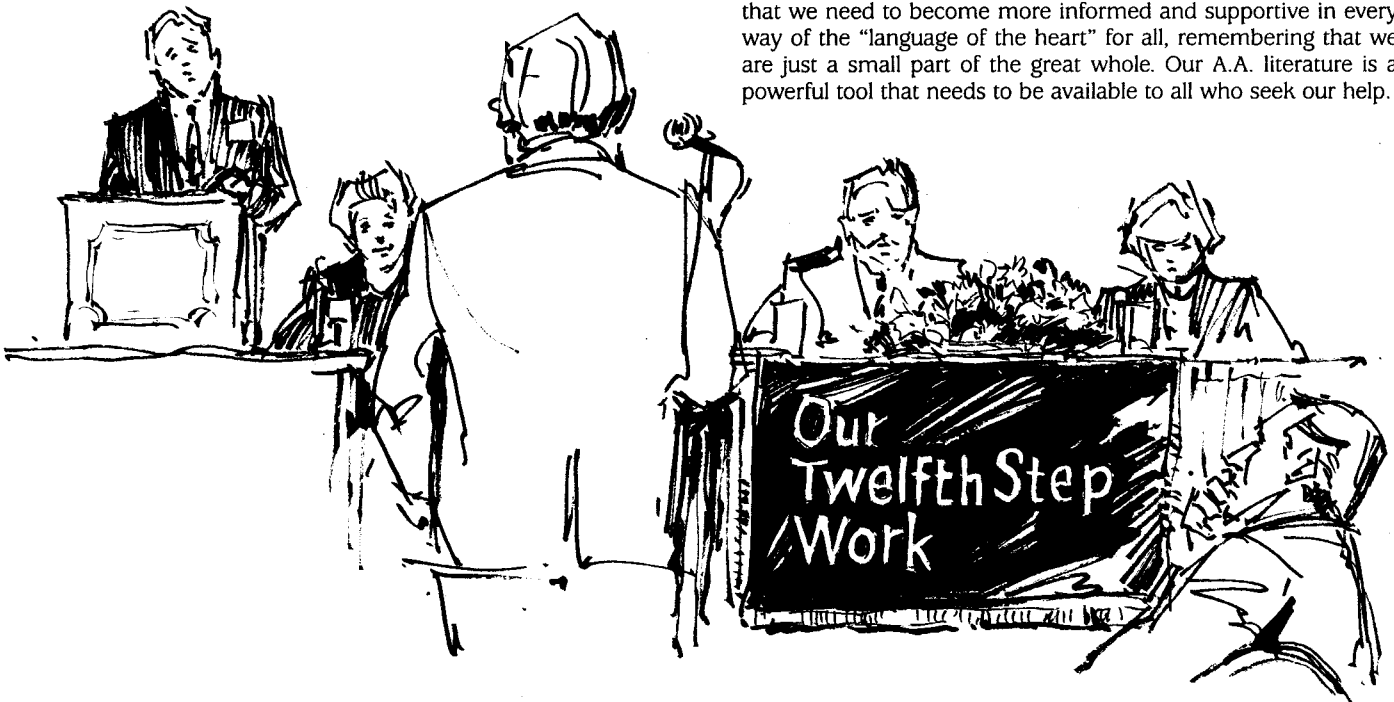
Conference members all agreed that they strive to be democratic in thought and action. Everyone is entitled to the right to be heard, and the minority opinion must be respected. The need for rotation was recognized as essential to A.A.’s democratic process.

3 Around the World: Is your group, district and area aware of the need for translations of A.A. literature? Does your area support A.A.W.S. in sending “free” literature to fledgling groups in countries where A.A. is forming? Do you know about the World Service Meeting, and share that information in your area?

Awareness and interest in the World Service Meeting and A.A.W.S.’s role in translating and helping out with A.A. literature varied. Many areas do display foreign literature at every assembly. In some situations, the G.S.O. staff or the trustees-at-large are invited to assemblies or regional conferences to speak about A.A. in other countries, foreign literature, and the need for financial support of translations.

Some Conference members said many A.A.s are unsure about the scope of our involvement in worldwide A.A., but all seemed to be in support of the efforts to better carry the message, and to protect its integrity, once they are aware of the needs and the work being done. There is a growing awareness of efforts to reach out to remote communities in their native languages, and support for whatever needs to be done with translated material.

Many areas bring the World Service Meeting Reports to their assemblies, although discussion of world service cooperation is often given a low priority—the end of the session when time is usually running out—in most areas. One workshop section noted that we need to become more informed and supportive in every way of the “language of the heart” for all, remembering that we are just a small part of the great whole. Our A.A. literature is a powerful tool that needs to be available to all who seek our help.



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 1998 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

1 The following sections from the pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be added as an appendix to the booklet *Living Sober* at its next printing:

- The lead-in and 9 points on pages 5 & 6 in the section entitled "A report from a group of physicians in A.A."
- Page 13 entitled "However, some alcoholics require medication. . ."

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

2 The theme for the 1999 General Service Conference be: "Moving Forward: Unity through Humility."

3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1999 General Service Conference:

- a) Our Responsibility to A.A. Unity:
 - 1) Home Group
 - 2) A.A. Service Structure
 - 3) A.A. Worldwide
- b) Many Faces — One Fellowship:
 - 1) Accepting Our Differences
 - 2) I Am Responsible...
 - 3) Principles Before Personalities
- c) Our Future Together:
 - 1) Sponsorship
 - 2) A.A. Literature
 - 3) Tradition Seven

4 The following be the workshop topic for the 1999 General Service Conference:

Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility:

- a) Harmony in the A.A. Community
- b) Principle of Rotation
- c) Spiritual Significance of Anonymity

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

5 The draft revision of the pamphlet to replace "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" be approved with the title "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" and the following changes:

- In the section to the co-worker, delete the line: "Al-Anon is not affiliated with A.A., but its contribution to increased understanding of the A.A. recovery program has been substantial."
- In reference to Al-Anon in the text of the pamphlet, insert the text from the footnoted material on page 121 of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* as follows: "Though it is entirely sepa-

rate from Alcoholics Anonymous, it uses the general principles of the A.A. program as a guide for husbands, wives, relatives, friends, and others close to alcoholics."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

6 The video entitled "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls," developed to encourage more A.A. members to participate in carrying the message into correctional facilities, be approved with two minor focus adjustments to safeguard the anonymity of A.A. members.

7 An addition relative to carrying the message into youth detention centers and short-term facilities be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

FINANCE

No recommendations.

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

It was recommended that:

8 As at previous International Conventions, non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate in the 2000 International Convention at A.A.'s expense with the number not to exceed 21 people.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

9 The video, "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure," be approved for distribution.

10 A draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, continue to be developed and a progress report brought to the 1999 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that, if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

11 Martha van den Adel, chairperson of the General Service Board in the Netherlands and a World Service Meeting delegate, be invited to attend the 48th General Service Conference as an observer.

12 The 51st General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2001 since those dates do not conflict with any significant religious holidays.

13 When calculating the number of votes to determine substantial unanimity or a 2/3 majority on the Conference floor, when the number is a fraction, the next higher whole number will be used.

14 The timetable for the election of delegates from the West Central Region be revised to allow for a more even distribution of new delegates on each panel as suggested in the proposal submitted by that region.



place of the delegate, may be elected to serve his or her own term.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

18 The four proposed television Public Service Announcements developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee emphasizing membership of young people, minorities and generic A.A. information be approved.

19 Inventory items TV-25 and TV-34 be removed from current inventory and the following three Public Service Announcements extracted from these two inventory items be incorporated into a new P.S.A. inventory item:

B.G.'s Advice: 30 seconds (from TV-25)

B.G.'s Advice: 30 seconds with subtitles (from TV-25)

High/Low Bottom: 20 seconds (from TV-34)

20 The 1998 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 1996 A.A. Membership Survey.

REPORT AND CHARTER

No recommendations.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

21 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1998 (See page 34; the Conference and board approved the slate).

22 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. World Services Corporate Board (see page 34; slate of directors approved).

23 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 34; slate of directors approved).

15 The revised timetable for the election of delegates from the West Central Region be accomplished for the election of Panel 50 delegates by having two areas in the West Central Region elect two delegates for one-year terms with the understanding that those two delegates would have the opportunity to stand for his/her own two-year term in the following election as suggested in the proposal submitted by that region.

16 A Conference Archives Committee, composed of nine delegates (five from Panel 48 and four from Panel 49), meet at the 49th General Service Conference as a secondary committee assignment and that the committee meet jointly with the trustees' Archives Committee.

17 The following statement under Delegate Term on page S73 of the 1997-1998 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* which reads:

The Conference strongly recommends limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate delegate who, after filling one year of the delegate's term, may be elected to serve his or her own term.

be revised to read:

The Conference strongly recommends limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate delegate who, after attending one Conference in



Presentations

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report was given by Art Knight, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. The report was followed by questions and sharing. For more details please see the Finance section of this Report, and the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee's report.

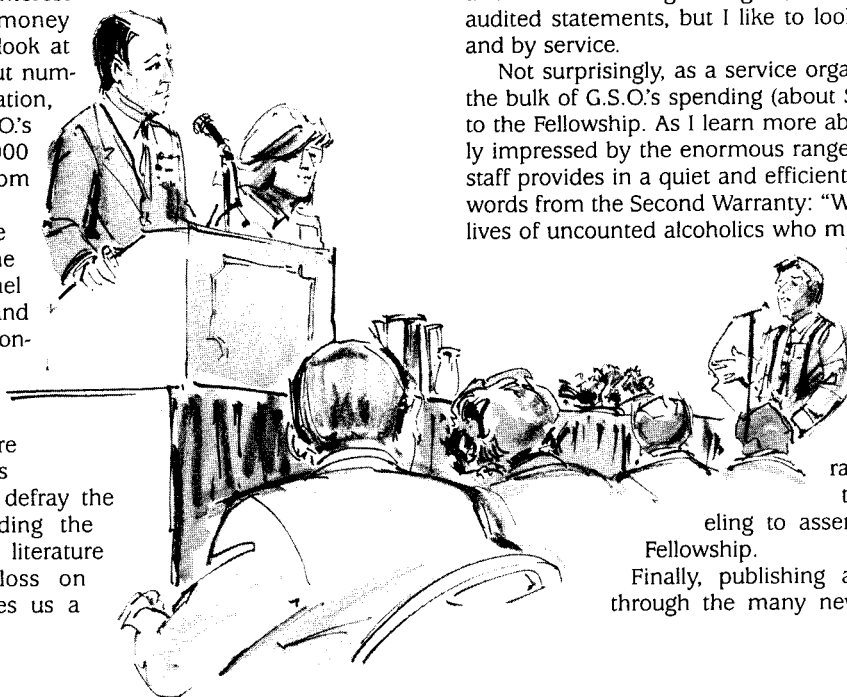
As treasurer of the General Service Board, I have the distinct honor of reporting on a subject near and dear to many an alcoholic's heart—money. And I appreciate the fact that, having heard that this report was to be on finances, half the room didn't get up and leave.

That actually happened to me once, early on in my service to A.A. I was invited to speak at an area assembly. The person who did the inviting asked that I speak a bit about the role of a Class A trustee and relate my story (if you will) about how I came into service with the Fellowship. Nothing to do with finances, he assured me. Apparently, the program chair and the meeting chair didn't clearly communicate, for I was introduced as Art Knight, from New York (I'm from Chicago, by the way), here to talk about A.A. finances. Well, half the room left for a coffee break!

Talking about money—finance—can be dull and difficult, and certainly not as inspiring as hearing about important Twelfth Step work. Yet Bill W. recognized, and wrote extensively, about the importance of financial soundness and stability to the primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Today, as we discuss A.A.'s finances, I hope to be able to relate the dull and sometimes difficult to understand numbers to that all-important job of reaching out and always being there.

In the back of this *Report* is the complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company. Rather than try to "explain" the audit report, I'm going to try to put the significant numbers and trends in perspective to give us all some common basis for our discussion.

Let's first look at the General Service Office. Where does the money come from to support its activities? Well, in the broadest terms, G.S.O. gets its funds from the gross profit from literature sales (that's what's left over after all the costs of production and distribution are paid) and from group contributions. A tiny amount comes from interest-bearing checking or money market accounts. If we look at last year's results and put numbers to that income equation, it looks like this. Of G.S.O.'s total income of \$8,103,000 about 52% came from gross profit on literature (which is the profit before the costs of running the office—such as personnel and office expenses), and 48% came from group contributions. After deducting the cost of running the publishing operation from literature gross profit, there is \$1,843,000 left to help defray the cost of "Services." Adding the \$1,843,000 profit from literature and the \$2,088,000 loss on "Services" together, gives us a



net loss for G.S.O. of \$245,000. Contributions covered approximately 65% of the service expenses while literature profits provided about 31%.

A couple of personal observations about these income numbers: In the Second Warranty of the Twelfth Concept, Bill W. writes: "In about half of the last twenty years, A.A. group contributions have failed to meet our world needs. But the Reserve Fund, constantly renewed by book sales, has been able to meet these deficits—and save money besides. What this has meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or nonexistent, no one can guess. Financial prudence has paid off in lives saved." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 65)

We could update the date, and say the same thing today. While literature unit sales continue to decline at a rate of about 4%, income from literature continues to help A.A. meet the needs Bill so eloquently defined. And, the Big Book remains one of the outstanding bargains in the publishing world today. Here's an illustration of the price of the Big Book from 1955 to today. What cost \$3.00 in 1955, last year cost \$4.70, an increase of less than 1% a year over those 43 years. I have a paperback book published in the early 1950s—it cost .35 cents. A recent paperback—just about the same size—costs \$8.00 (\$10.00 in Canada). Close to a million Big Books were shipped last year—how many of those "uncounted alcoholics" that Bill spoke of were reached because an inexpensive Big Book is still available.

Turning to the group contributions, I must report that contributions were about 4% below the G.S.O. budget for the year, and about 2% less than in 1996. Contributions averaged about \$68 per group. There are approximately 56,000 groups registered with G.S.O., of which 43% contributed. This is about on par with 1995, but reverses the hoped for start of a positive trend of 1996, when the percent of groups contributing increased to 45 percent.

For this year, based on last year's experience, G.S.O. has established an income budget that assumes a further 4% decline in literature unit sales, and a 2% increase in contributions. The projected income for this year, therefore, is \$8,715,000, an increase of about 8% over last year. My personal hope is that, as a result of this Conference's theme, we will see the use of literature increase as the Fellowship goes about carrying the message.

Now that we know where the money comes from, let's take a look at where it goes. Again, a detailed breakdown is in the audited statements, but I like to look at our expenses by type and by service.

Not surprisingly, as a service organization to the Fellowship, the bulk of G.S.O.'s spending (about \$6.0 million) is on services to the Fellowship. As I learn more about G.S.O., I am continually impressed by the enormous range of services that dedicated staff provides in a quiet and efficient way. Again I think of Bill's words from the Second Warranty: "What [has this] meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or nonexistent. . . ."

You can see that the next biggest chunk of our spending by service relates to what I would characterize as "getting together to share." That ranges from this Conference to Regional Forums to traveling to assemblies at all levels of the Fellowship.

Finally, publishing all the shared experience through the many newsletters and communica-



tions that flow from G.S.O. and the support services required to operate the office, form the balance and smallest portion of expenses.

If we look at our expenses a different way, by type of expense, we can see that "people costs"—salaries and benefits for the G.S.O. staff and personnel that performs all those services—is, not surprisingly, our largest expense. Next comes various service costs, such as communications pieces, free literature, and the associated costs of writing, mailing, etc., as well as the "getting together costs" referred to above. Running the office—paying for everything from rent to paperclips, is next, while the other expenses (things like the cost to pay for our audited financial report) are last.

In total, G.S.O.'s expenses last year were \$8,348,000. On a group basis, service spending averaged \$106. Spending was essentially the same as the year before, and continues a trend of "flat" spending that reflects, in my opinion, the "financial prudence" of the entire staff at G.S.O. The Fellowship gets cost effective service from this dedicated group of people.

For this year, expenses are projected to increase just 1.5%, so with income up about 8%, we hope to see a modest excess of income over expense for the year.

Turning to the Grapevine, we can view its financial health in a similar way. Like G.S.O., it receives its income from sales of its principal publication, the Grapevine, as well as sales of other special items, like *The Language of the Heart*, other specialty literature, tapes and calendars. However, by its very charter, the Grapevine receives no contributions, and therefore, if it cannot break even, it must look to the Reserve Fund to make up any deficit.

If we put numbers to the question, "Where Does the Money Come From?" we see that the Grapevine operates on income of about \$1.3 million. That's after all the costs to produce the magazine and related items. Interestingly, since the editorial costs of producing the magazine are "fixed"—or the same, regardless of whether one or a million copies are sold, the impact of any change in circulation is dramatic and can mean the difference between being self-supporting or having to tap into the Reserve Fund.

For example, last year all costs for editorial, circulation and administrative expenses were about \$1.4 million dollars, so the Grapevine needed help from the Reserve Fund. However, last year, circulation was just about 120,000, a decline from the prior year of about 8,000 subscriptions. Had the average circulation been even with 1996, the Grapevine would have been self-supporting. I guess the moral of that story is that the Fellowship's

response to the Grapevine not only determines the financial health of the publication, but affects the general health of the Fellowship's Prudent Reserve as well. Like the Big Book, the Grapevine is a powerful Twelfth Step tool; hopefully, as a result of this Conference, your Twelfth Step work will include the Grapevine.

For this year, the Grapevine is projecting a slight loss of \$10,000. Having worked closely with the Grapevine Board and management during the development of the budget, I know they are really shooting to be self-sufficient. To that end, we can all help.

As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 1997 average circulation of close to 8,400. Personally speaking, La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and will continue to grow in circulation. Like the Grapevine itself, the editorial and production costs are the same, whether one or a million copies are produced, so circulation growth is critical to the magazine's success.

To date, the project has incurred losses of \$270,000, and those losses have been funded from the Reserve Fund. For this year, La Viña is budgeted to show a loss of about \$78,000, based on a modest circulation increase to 9,500. Obviously, if circulation increases beyond the projected level, the loss will be reduced, and conceivably could be eliminated.

All this brings me to my final point ("Thank goodness he's almost done!"), and that's the health of the Reserve Fund. Since I've already invoked the Second Warranty, let me quote its opening sentence, which is drawn from the Traditions: "Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample Reserve, should be its prudent financial principle." (*Ibid*, p. 63)

Following three years of planned operating losses to bring the Reserve Fund back to a "prudent" (under ten month) state, we are clearly there. Last year, the fund was used to offset the loss at G.S.O. (\$245,000), the slight loss at the Grapevine (\$83,000) and the La Viña project loss (\$102,000). The fund now stands at just nine months reserve and, given the expectations for 1998, should remain at about that level. Therefore, I can report to you today that your Fellowship is financially healthy. Let me reiterate Bill's admonition from that Second Warranty, "Financial prudence has paid off in lives saved."

Arthur L. Knight, Jr.,
Class A trustee & treasurer, G.S.B.

OUR TWELFTH STEP WORK

Monday evening's presentations addressed the Conference theme, Our Twelfth Step Work. Robert Miller, D.D., Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee served as moderator.

Reaching the Newcomer

"Every day, somewhere in the world, recovery begins when one alcoholic talks with another alcoholic, sharing experience, strength and hope." Thus ends the Foreword to the Third Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* (p. xxii), launching millions of readers into our basic text with a statement of the timeless, fundamental method we use to transmit our message.

One alcoholic talking with another. This simple concept of one-to-one sharing is the spiritual heart of every service we provide, be it the Twelfth Step call being made by one of your home group members tonight, the letter being written by an oldtimer in your community to a young inmate in a prison anywhere in the country, or the A.A. information booth arranged by your area that is being set up at a state-wide social services conference this weekend.

That spiritual heart beats here at the Conference, as well. As we deliberate on these diverse agenda items, our analysis of their ultimate value is rooted in our "basic training" in the trenches of countless A.A. meetings: In the end, will our action help a newcomer find a way into the light? Bill Wilson gives us a succinct benchmark of this definitive accountability to the newcomer on page 140 of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*: He states: "Regarding any particular service, we need to ask only one question: 'Is this or that service really needed?' If it is not, then let it be eliminated. But if it is needed, then maintain it we must or fail in our mission to those who want and seek A.A." "This or that service" may take many forms: the most compelling identification we can offer through the stories in the Big Book, any aspect of our ongoing guardianship of the Traditions that keep us in unity, the clearest message we can provide to professionals, the common experience we can aid our area and district service committees in codifying, or even how we can best transmit both the imperative need and the joy of participation in our Three Legacies to our own members. The benchmark is the same; eventually—in a day, a week, a year, or a generation—our goal is to reach the newcomer.

On the evening I was preparing this talk, I also attended my home group's weekly newcomers meeting. It was full of the usual variety of "people who normally would not mix." One might be there at the suggestion of his doctor, who had learned something of us reading a C.P.C. pamphlet given to him by an A.A. member who was also a patient. Two or three probably were from the young adults treatment center down the road, picked up during our group's monthly A.A. meeting commitment there, arranged for by our area treatment facilities committee. One might have seen a public service announcement and subsequently been referred to our meetings by our local intergroup. Leading the meeting was a young man who I had the honor of watching sober up and grow into happy usefulness. When the time came to start, he looked around the room smiling, and said softly, "I know something of God now. I've seen Him in all of you, and I've seen His work in my life, and I know that God is good." I felt a chill up my spine as those words struck me, and I felt time stop as he launched into the story of what he was like, what happened, and how he lived today. I saw the eyes of the newcomers spark with recognition, and from behind the flat look of dogged stubbornness or bleak cynicism, something like hope shone out.

That young man and two million men and women like him need as many opportunities to say those words as we have the capacity to give them, for it is the continued transmission of that message which is most vital to our future well-being. We must open wide every possible door and guard ourselves from every diversion, all in order to ensure that in a day—or a week, a year, a generation—a newcomer can find themselves with someone who'll share, one alcoholic to another, how they found out that they could stay sober a day at a time, and that God was good.

We stand as a Fellowship and a Conference at the brink of the 21st century, our membership expanding worldwide, our experience forged by the hammer of millions of one-on-ones, faced with material challenges that sometimes seem to defy a simple spiritual solution, but with our primary purpose intact, unchanged. Sixty-four years ago an out of work stock analyst stared bleakly across his kitchen table at a childhood friend and realized that, as he tells us in "Bill's Story" on page 11 in the Big Book, "Here was something at work in a human heart which had done the impossible." Sixty-three years ago that same still out of work, now vision-struck man desperately reached out to a cynical, failing, equally despairing doctor. They were strangers, until a God-given time just moments afterwards that they became fellow travelers. I have had that experience of God transforming a stranger into a life-long friend in an instant, as I know have each of you.

I serve here as a delegate to the 48th Conference with a full heart, knowing that when I return to my home group next Sunday, I'll look first for the newcomers at my meeting. They have reached our doors by a variety of means, and I'll be able to glimpse the chain of anonymous effort, the hand of our organized services in many of them. Surely God is good to have given us, in his wisdom, the privilege of participating in our own and our fellow sufferers' salvation!

One of the most amazing spiritual awakenings I had last year as a first-year delegate was the realization that what we do here has impact only because it both *reflects* and is *supported* by the ultimate authority and final responsible parties—members gathered in the power of the A.A. groups. We have *collectively* forged, we collectively wield, a powerful set of spiritual tools to aid us in our primary purpose. And throughout, the hand of A.A. remains a *member's* hand, reaching out to a newcomer, one-to-one.

During this Conference week, I'll think often of one of my favorite stories, an anecdote that opens "*Pass It On*," the biography of that vision-stuck stock analyst who eventually *did* find his real work, as a co-founder of Alcoholics Anonymous. To me, it speaks with great humility to the heart of service—reaching the newcomer: "...I'll never forget the first time I met Bill Wilson. I was a couple of months sober and so excited, so thrilled to actually meet the co-founder that I gushed all over him with what my sobriety means to me and my undying gratitude for his starting A.A. When I ran down, he took my hand in his and said simply, 'Pass it on.'"

Karin Nord, Southern Minnesota

Carrying This Message

Carrying this message—what is more central to our Fellowship? *The A.A. Service Manual* (p. S7) begins with: "Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die."

There is nothing of greater importance to the A.A. member and to A.A. as a whole. To share what was so freely given to them with another alcoholic is where "Even the newest of newcomers finds undreamed rewards as he tries to help his brother alcoholic, the one who is even blinder than he." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 109) Now the question arises, how do I carry this message? Or possibly the question is better asked: How do we carry this message?

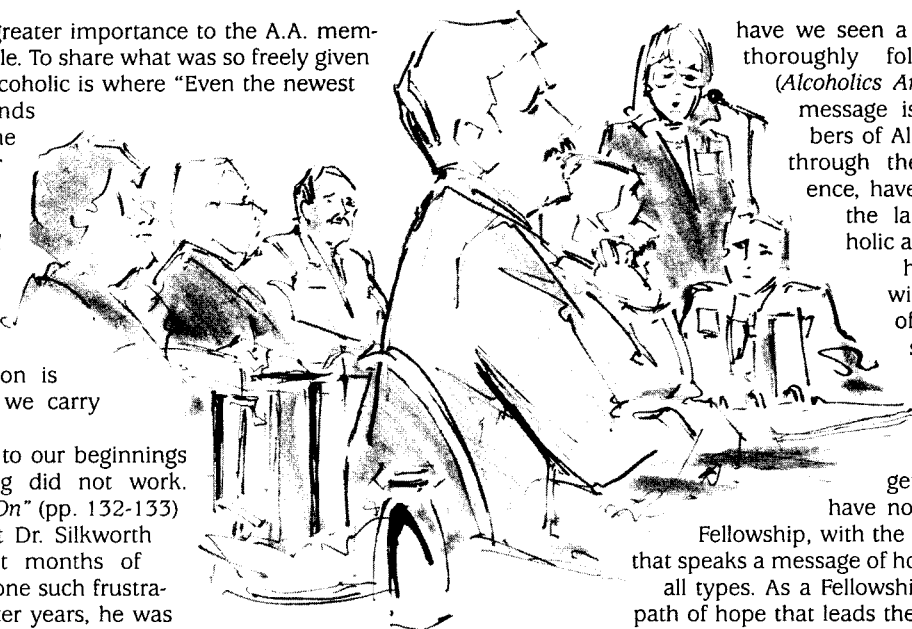
When we look back to our beginnings we find that preaching did not work. When we read "*Pass It On*" (pp. 132-133) we find the advice that Dr. Silkworth gave: "During the first months of 1935, Bill encountered one such frustration after another. In later years, he was to explain the failure as being one of method: During this period he said he was preaching to the drunks. Also, he still believed that an alcoholic required a spectacular spiritual experience, similar to his own, in order to recover. And he was hardly humble about the crusade he was on; while he did realize that working with other alcoholics did give him a tremendous lift, he did not realize he actually needed the sick alcoholic."

"It was Dr. Silkworth who helped straighten him out: Bill was preaching, said the doctor, and his preaching was driving his prospects away.... Why not talk about the illness of alcoholism? Why not tell his alcoholics about the illness that condemned them to go mad or die if they continue to drink? 'Coming from another alcoholic, one alcoholic talking to another, maybe that will crack those tough egos deep down,' Silkworth said. 'Only then can you begin to try out your other medicine, the ethical principles you have picked up from the Oxford Group.'"

Here we find our first good direction—"One alcoholic talking with another." This is where the success of our program began and what is still the linchpin of our growth—the message of hope that only one alcoholic can give to another. This message of hope is being transmitted every day by a warm smile at the door of a meeting. By the cup of coffee offered and received. By the voice at the end of the telephone at all hours of the day and night. And by the trips that A.A. members make into prisons and institutions every day to carry this message. So, we have a message being carried by the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous through its members.

We also can thank the friends of A.A. who bring our message to those who we have yet to meet. There are our friends in the media who publish articles about us and run our public service announcements. We can thank our friends in medicine and religion who direct alcoholics to us. While we are at times concerned that our message is not always carried as we believe it should be, are we doing our part? Are we keeping to our simple message and informing our Fellowship, in the spirit of love, of the experience that brought about our Traditions? Are we, the individual members of A.A., doing our part to learn about and preserve the Traditions of A.A.? If so, then we can have faith that God will guide and protect our Fellowship.

But what is this message? Our message is that there is a program of action, based upon twelve spiritual principles that offer a solution to the alcoholic problem. Our message is that "Rarely



have we seen a person fail who has thoroughly followed our path."

(*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p.58) Our message is simple. The members of Alcoholics Anonymous, through their personal experience, have the ability to speak the language of the alcoholic as no one else can. We have been blessed with an understanding of the alcoholic circumstances, the tools to reach the alcoholic, and a program that works.

While this is a generous blessing, we have not been blessed, as a

Fellowship, with the language of the heart that speaks a message of hope to the addictive of all types. As a Fellowship, we know only the path of hope that leads the alcoholic to our program.

While the individual may understand and seek to help those who have problems that are similar, but not alcohol related, the spirit and Tradition of A.A. says that this is best done as an individual effort or within the multitude of other fellowships that are available today. When we represent A.A. our message is that there is a solution to the alcoholic problem.

The importance of carrying this message undistorted is one of the basic reasons for our book *Alcoholics Anonymous*—"...such a book could prevent the otherwise inevitable garble and distortion that would start as soon as publicity came." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, pp. 144-145) This message is so vital, so precious, and so rare that we dare not allow it to be distorted. While we are excited by our newfound gift, both then and now, we often think that we have found the solution to a multitude of society's problems. We must remember, as Dr. Silkworth had shown us, that our success is based upon "One alcoholic talking to another." How can we deny this truth?

When the Big Book was written we took the time to gather and publish the stories of recovering alcoholics. In this way, those who met us through the book could find the voice of an alcoholic speaking to them and carrying the message of hope and the program of recovery. This is seen today in the action taken by the 47th General Service Conference, which asked for the development of a draft of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book. In seeking new stories that can help alcoholics who may be having trouble relating to the stories presently in the Big Book, we underscore the primary importance of carrying the message of hope through personal experience.

I can think of no better conclusion than to quote from *Alcoholics Anonymous*, (p. 89), published for the first time almost 59 years ago: "This is our *twelfth suggestion*: Carry this message to other alcoholics! You can help when no one else can. You can secure their confidence when others fail. Remember they are very ill."

Clay Rittenhouse, Eastern Pennsylvania

Three Conference members had the same last name, albeit different spellings: Bill Reinhart, Arkansas delegate, and Class B trustees Julian Rhinehart and Dean Rinehart. They had an informal meeting and decided they were probably all related to the clan from the N.C./Tenn./Ky. region. "Probably some old horse thief," said Dean.

Back to Basics

When asked to give a presentation at this Conference on “Back to Basics,” the next few days were spent with my mind racing as to how to accomplish this. The topic of Twelfth Step work is of such importance, not only to my own sobriety, but to the groups, the areas, this Conference, and A.A. worldwide. We here at this Conference need to constantly ask ourselves, “What is the best way to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers?”

I then went to my two invaluable resources that have never let me down, the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and the Twelve and Twelve. After reading Chapter 7, “Working With Others,” I found that someone has once again added some things since the last time I read it. This also happened when I read Step Twelve in the Twelve and Twelve. It was then that I remembered the very basic thing that you had taught me to do before any A.A. activity—pray. This is what I had forgotten to do, because I had gotten wrapped up in what my message was to be and not, as the Twelfth Step suggests, that “we tried to carry this message to alcoholics.” So I backed up and said the Third Step prayer, “God, I offer myself to thee—to build with me and to do with me as Thou wilt. Relieve me of the bondage of self, that I may better do Thy will. Take away my difficulties, that victory over them may bear witness to those I would help of Thy Power, Thy Love, and Thy Way of Life. May I do Thy will always.” (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 63) Prayer is the first basic before making a Twelfth Step call.

The second basic I should remember is that I am doing a Twelfth Step call so that I can stay sober. In November of 1934, Bill received a phone call from one of his old drinking companions, Ebby. Now, the fact of the matter was not that Bill had wanted to stop drinking, but that Ebby needed to carry the message to another drunk so that he could stay sober. During the course of this conversation Ebby told Bill, “I know you are going to gag on this, but they taught me that I should try to pray to whatever God I thought there was for the power to carry out these simple precepts.” (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 59) The third basic tells me that I should never shy away from the spiritual aspects of the program. This planted the seed in Bill’s mind, so that he would later try to find Sam Shoemaker’s Calvary Church where Ebby’s Oxford Group met. Of course by the time Bill got there he was drunk, and even made a scene, but they didn’t kick him out, embarrass him, or anything else. The fourth basic is to never talk down to an alcoholic, for we realize that they have an illness. In December of that year Bill checked into Towns Hospital and was never to take another drink.

Then, in May of 1935, Bill was in Akron at the Mayflower Hotel. The stock deal had gone bad and he was thinking of going in the bar and having a ginger ale. Then panic hit, and after a few phone calls he got hold of Henrietta Seiberling, who got in touch with Anne, Dr. Bob’s wife. The fifth basic is that I should immediately seek out an alcoholic when I feel in danger of taking that first drink. The next day, Bill and Bob met, and this was the beginning of Alcoholics Anonymous as we know it today. There again, it wasn’t that Dr. Bob wanted to get sober, it was that Bill had to carry the message so that he could stay sober. Bill says in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 70), “I knew that I needed this alcoholic as much as he needed me. *This was it.* And this mutual give-and-take is at the very heart of all of A.A.’s Twelfth Step work today. This was how to carry the message.”

Now that I know that I am responsible to go find the alcoholic to insure my own sobriety, what do I do? Do I just sit around in a meeting and wait for a newcomer to come in the door, or do I seek out acquaintances, hospitals, and jails? Do I judge the alcoholics by the way they look, or do I treat all alcoholics as sick

individuals? Do I just give them a Big Book and tell them to read the first 164 pages, or do I work with them and try to explain the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous? Do I try to find out all that I can about him or her, or do I center the conversation on myself? Do I visit with the family and explain Alcoholics Anonymous, or do I just suggest to them they need help too? Do I share only my experience, strength and hope, or do I tell them exactly how they are to work the program? Do I outline a program of action, explaining how a self-appraisal straightened out my past and I am now trying to be helpful to him or her? Do I continue to visit with him or her and help them work the Twelve Steps, or do I just let them go on their own? Do I explain our Twelve Traditions?

When I attend meetings, and it comes my turn to share, do I do so willingly, or just pass? Do I take part in business meetings, or do I leave it up to those who have more time than me? Do I contribute to the group, area, and G.S.O. so that Twelfth Step work can be done, or do I drag out that lone dollar and toss it in the basket? Do I make myself available to intergroup for Twelfth Step calls, or am I too busy or tired?

All these questions and many more could be asked of myself in making a Twelfth Step call. I must remember one simple fact. The only reason I am here is through the grace of God, and it is with the grace of God I must carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to the alcoholic who still suffers. May God bless you.

Bill Reinhart, Arkansas

TOOLS FOR TWELFTH STEPPING

Wednesday afternoon’s presentation/discussion session was moderated by Isadora Drayton, Southeast New York delegate.

The A.A. Member

In Alcoholics Anonymous we have our own language, our own jargon—such as, a Fourth, a Fifth, a Seventh, and Service. Now, I was raised in the Canadian shadow of Detroit, so I know what a Fifth is and have first-hand knowledge of many a Fifth. Early in my sobriety I heard somebody say they were active in service and that I should do the same. I thought I would like that. Here I was, new in A.A. and already being sent to the “stud farm.” As I understand it now, that is not that bad an analogy—to pass on to others the good that got me to where I am.

To most sober alcoholics the jargon of “Service” is a euphemism for a principle embodied in our Twelfth Step. Something that may not make immediate sense to us—didn’t to me. “Active in service.” We hear it, we echo it—but do we understand it? Do we practice it?

Chapter 7 of the Big Book (p. 89) starts out with: “Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics. It works when other activities fail. This is our *twelfth suggestion*: Carry this message to other alcoholics!”

I guess this is what we mean by Twelfth Step and service work: carrying this message to other alcoholics — give it away to keep it. Twelfth Step work must be important, it has a whole chapter of the Big Book, “Working With Others,” devoted to it.

Our Twelfth Step says: “Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics, and to practice these principles in all our affairs.” The principles of Alcoholics Anonymous are the principles of living. Page 106 of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* says: “The joy of living is the theme of A.A.’s Twelfth Step, and action is its key word. Here we turn outward toward our fellow alcoholics who are still in distress. Here we experience the kind of giving that asks no rewards.”

So Twelfth Step work is important to me, as an individual, to maintain my sobriety and to attain joy of living. But what does this have to do with the A.A. member?

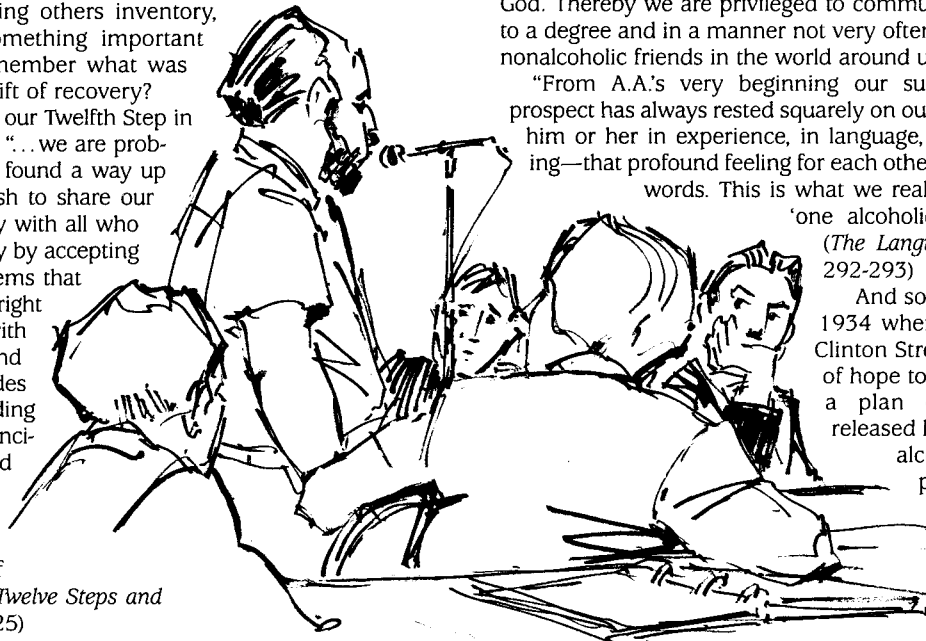
Who is a member of A.A.? Our Third Tradition and the Preamble answer this very clearly. "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking." The first paragraph, page 139, of the Twelve and Twelve says: "You are an A.A. member if you say so," and further on it reads, "We just want to be sure that you get the same great chance for sobriety that we've had." The last line of the Preamble comes the closest of all our literature in giving a basic duty of being a member—"...help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety."

I am no different than any other member of Alcoholics Anonymous. I have the same pluses and minuses as other alcoholics. How they affect me, control me, might be different though. When I first came to Alcoholics Anonymous, I did not want anyone—my neighbors, fellow workers or employees—to know I went to meetings of Alcoholics Anonymous. I was scared that neighbors, knowing that I went to A.A. meetings, might correctly deduce that I was responsible for those bags of empty liquor bottles in their flower beds, bushes and under their verandas. I was ashamed of being an alcoholic and a member of A.A. Why should I be ashamed? I had been given a gift, a solution to a physical allergy combined with a mental obsession—a seemingly hopeless state of mind and body. A condition that has baffled mankind from its beginnings. And all that was asked of me for this gift was to carry the message that there was hope of recovery.

If I did this, then there would be rewards—another day of sobriety, the joy of sharing with another. As I mentioned earlier, "Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics."

This work with another alcoholic can take many forms—from service work in all its varieties, to talking to a drunk, to listening at meetings, to giving reassurance and support, to making coffee. Should I be the only one to receive the rewards of sobriety? Or should others also have the rewards? Well, I need to overcome any selfishness I may have and strive to be a good example to others so they may want what I may have. I need to overcome my character defects—taking an easier and softer way. If some service or Twelfth Step work needs to be done, do I have the feeling of "let someone else do it, I'm too busy," feeling too sorry for myself, taking others inventory, procrastinating or something important like that. Or do I remember what was asked of me for the gift of recovery?

Bill W. summed up our Twelfth Step in such a neat, tidy way: "...we are problem people who have found a way up and out, and who wish to share our knowledge of that way with all who can use it. For it is only by accepting and solving our problems that we can begin to get right with ourselves and with the world about us, and with Him who presides over us all. Understanding is the key to right principles and attitudes, and right action is the key to good living; therefore the joy of good living is the theme of A.A.'s Twelfth Step." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 125)



It has been said that A.A. is not an "I" program but a "we" program. There is only one way we can stay sober: working with another drunk. And we need other recovering drunks so we can share our feelings, our trials and tribulations, as only another drunk can understand. We are all in this together. To carry the message of recovery so we in our own selfish way can stay sober.

I am not any different than any other alcoholic. I was given something that I thought was impossible. Something I thought I would never have—one day of sobriety. That to me was a priceless gift. But I learned there is a price: give it away to keep it. And I want to keep it.

Our journey of recovery is summed up in the penultimate paragraph on page 164 of the Big Book: "Give freely of what you find and join us. We shall be with you in the Fellowship of the Spirit, and you will surely meet some of us as you trudge the Road of Happy Destiny.

"May God bless you and keep you—until then."

Wilf Antheunis, Eastern Ontario

Sponsorship

When I received my "loving invitation" to present a talk on Sponsorship at this Conference, my knees got weak, my palms broke out in a sweat and my stomach dropped somewhere down around my ankles. All in the first nanosecond. I waited until the second nanosecond to call my sponsor. Then I set about the arduous task of writing the "perfect" paper. After several attempts, I realized that one of the very first lessons I had received in Alcoholic Anonymous is that I no longer have to try to be someone I'm not. In fact, a line from my meditation book reads: "If I love with my Spirit, I don't have to think so hard with my head." As soon as I stopped thinking, things began to get easier.

An excerpt from one of Bill Wilson's Grapevine articles, October 1959, reads: "Everyone must agree that we A.A.s are unbelievably fortunate people; fortunate that we have suffered so much; fortunate that we can know, understand and love each other so supremely well—these attributes and virtues are scarcely of the earned variety. Indeed, most of us are well aware that these are rare gifts which have their true origin in our kinship born of a common suffering and a common deliverance by the grace of God. Thereby we are privileged to communicate with each other to a degree and in a manner not very often surpassed among our nonalcoholic friends in the world around us.

"From A.A.'s very beginning our success with each new prospect has always rested squarely on our ability to identify with him or her in experience, in language, and especially in feeling—that profound feeling for each other that goes deeper than words. This is what we really mean when we say 'one alcoholic talking to another.'" (*The Language of the Heart*, pp. 292-293)

And so it began, in late fall of 1934 when Ebby arrived at 182 Clinton Street to bring a message of hope to his friend Bill. He had a plan of action that had released him from the throes of alcoholism, at least temporarily, and his main objective was to pass it on to others. In July 1953, Bill wrote: "Such was the sum of what

Ebby had extracted from his Oxford Group friends and had transmitted to me that day. While these simple ideas were not new, they certainly hit me like a ton of bricks. Today we understand just why that was—one alcoholic was talking to another as no one else can." (*ibid*, p. 197)

Even before the actual inception of Alcoholics Anonymous as we know it, sponsorship played a vital role in our recovery. No matter how desperate the situation, we have the innate ability to hear each other when no one else can reach us. Sponsorship is the bridge of hope that links the suffering alcoholic directly to the Steps and Traditions, the human contact that shows by example that this nebulous plan of action can actually have positive ramifications.

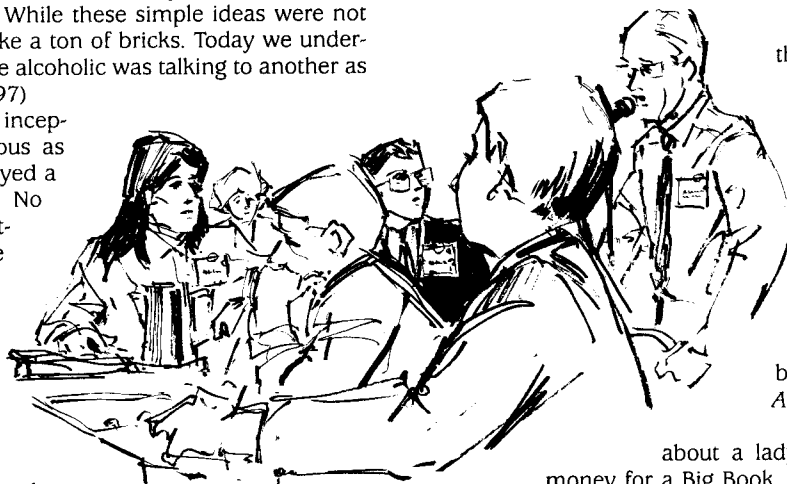
I chose my own sponsor because she wore her sobriety well. She understood things about life that I had no grasp or concept of—like how to have fun and how to laugh, how to make decisions, how to find a God that was acceptable and understandable. She had this intuitive knowledge of my fears, followed closely with a logical solution based on the Steps and Traditions. She believed that the Steps were to be worked, not just read about in a meeting. At the time, I wasn't quite sure whether this was good news or bad, but she certainly seemed to have something in her life that I didn't have in mine, so I became willing to at least try things her way. I had made a heart-to-heart contact with another human being, and I began to learn about things like honesty, trust, powerlessness and courage to change. I can thank my God today for her loving support and guidance, and for adding color to my black and white world.

Eventually, it became time for me to accept the responsibility of sponsoring others, to give back some of what I have been given. I thought at first that this meant I had to carry all of your burdens on top of my own, but thank goodness my ego got nipped in the bud—by my sponsor, of course. I thought God was giving me these women to sponsor because I had so much to teach them. As time has gone on, and ego and arrogance have gradually been replaced by serenity and humility, I realize now that these women have been placed in my life because they have so much to teach me, no matter where they are in their sobriety. I have been coerced into studying our literature much more than I normally would have, simply to keep ahead of their questions. I've had to learn to listen not only to what is being said, but very closely to what is *not* being said. I've had to accept my powerlessness to change another's action, and to accept another person's inaction or unwillingness. Many other gifts have been handed to me as I've traveled this Road of Happy Destiny, but none so precious as that of one alcoholic talking to another in the language of the heart. It is this express mutuality—that I need the other alcoholic as much as he or she needs me—that makes it so.

To summarize the entire process, as I myself never could, our literature states that "A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die." (*A.A. Service Manual*, p.57)

May God grant each of us the wisdom and ability to share the truth, one alcoholic to another.

Michaelene Fortner, Virginia



Literature

The theme of our Conference this year is "Our Twelfth Step Work" and one of our tools for this work is our literature. There are many examples of how our literature, particularly the Big Book, has played a major role in Twelfth Stepping members of our Fellowship.

"Remember that we deal with alcohol—cunning, baffling, powerful!" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, pp. 58-59)

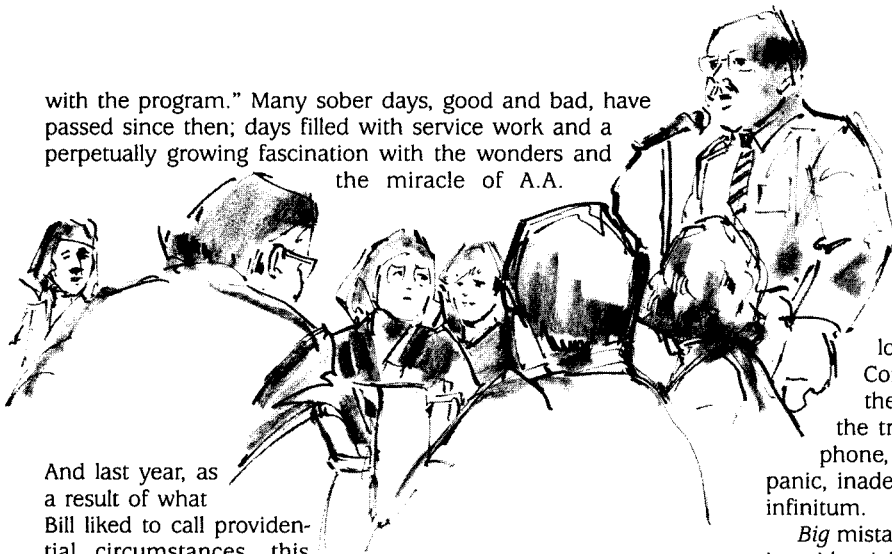
Recently, I heard a story about a lady who did not have enough money for a Big Book, and yet did not want to steal one from the group, believing that it would jinx her sobriety. So she went to the public library and stole one. Cunning. Another story is about a frustrated sponsor who was having a very difficult time with one of his sponsees. So, as a last resort the oldtimer attempted to pound the message into the top of the newcomer's head, literally. Baffling. About eight to ten years before my sobriety, a gentleman and his wife—along with the Big Book—held meetings week-to-week, month-to-month and year-to-year at my future home group. For a long time they were the only ones attending. So, even before my introduction to A.A., that Big Book was Twelfth Stepping me. Powerful. The A.A. literature has also been very patient. The Big Book, with the man and his wife who waited years for me, and some of our Conference-approved pamphlets have patiently lingered in waiting room literature racks, dust-covered and unused, till that moment of clarity; just as many issues of the Grapevine will wait patiently until they are read.

Very early in A.A. history Dr. Bob and Bill knew how important communication was for carrying the message. For example, in *The Language of the Heart*, p. 247, Bill W. said, "Our next great adventure in communication was the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*.... We knew we could communicate face-to-face. But it was very slow going. As we prepared the book we all wondered, 'Could the written word carry the message?' Could the book speak the language of the heart to the drunk who read it? We didn't know; we simply hoped. But now we do know." Yes, the sobriety of countless grateful alcoholics has proven the effectiveness of the Big Book.

As a Panel 47 delegate to the General Service Conference, I was honored and privileged to be assigned to the Literature Committee. The background information on the Fourth Edition sent to the delegates included the following from a letter Bill W. wrote to Bernard Smith, June 1954: "The story section of the Big Book is far more important than most of us think.... To increase the power and variety of this display to utmost should be, therefore, no routine or hurried job. The best will be none too good.... The main purpose of the revision is to bring the story section up to date, to portray more adequately a cross section of those who have found help.... Since the audience for the book is likely to be newcomers, anything from the point of view of context or style, that might offend or alienate those who are not familiar with the program should be carefully eliminated."

Several years ago this alcoholic sent an emphatic yet tactful letter to G.S.O. about concerns with one of the stories in the Big Book and an opinion that the story was outdated, stereotypical and thereby "might offend or alienate those who are not familiar

with the program." Many sober days, good and bad, have passed since then; days filled with service work and a perpetually growing fascination with the wonders and the miracle of A.A.



And last year, as a result of what Bill liked to call providential circumstances, this A.A. was fortunate enough to be a part of Big Book history by being a member of the Conference Committee that recommended to the General Service Conference the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, which resulted in a Conference Advisory Action. This Conference Action will result in changes to the story section of the Big Book and may include a change to the very story that resulted in that letter, written several years ago. It was no small accident that a Higher Power made itself evident through this event and perhaps to have this alcoholic's life coming full circle. Indeed, much more was revealed.

A.A. makes available 14 books, including four different formats of the Big Book and five different types of the Twelve and Twelve. There are also four booklets and 52 different pamphlets. Here is a sample of the different newcomers addressed by these pamphlets: Employee Assistance Programs, the Armed Services, the Gay/Lesbian, the Native American, women alcoholics, young people and older alcoholics. Other titles illustrate varying types of Twelfth Step work: "If You Are a Professional," "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," "A Newcomer Asks," "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," "Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A." and "The Twelve Steps Illustrated," for instance. The Big Book has been translated into 34 languages and additional translations are in the process, awaiting approval or funding. Our literature is being made available in over 40 countries around the world.

All of A.A.'s literature efforts embody the spirit of our Responsibility Declaration, and another standard that should guide all of A.A.'s deliberations comes from the Preface to the Third Edition: "All changes made over the years in the Big Book (A.A. members' fond nickname for this volume) have had the same purpose: to represent the current membership of Alcoholics Anonymous more accurately, and thereby to reach more alcoholics. If you have a drinking problem, we hope that you may pause in reading one of the forty-four personal stories and think: 'Yes, that happened to me'; or more important, 'Yes, I've felt like that'; or, most important, 'Yes, I believe this program can work for me, too.'" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. xii)

Hopefully, somewhere, someplace, right now as I am speaking, an alcoholic in the middle of his or her insanity may be having a moment of clarity, or perhaps a newcomer may be experiencing their spiritual awakening. Let us hope and pray that we never forget the still-suffering alcoholic and that we continue to offer this life-saving and life-sustaining work. May we never tire. Let us hope and pray that those not yet among us may come to understand the blessings of the Twelve Promises through our Twelfth Step work and our literature.

Rod Betonney, Utah

DIVERSITY OF TWELFTH STEP WORK

Friday morning the final presentation/discussion session of the Conference was moderated by John Koster, A.A.W.S. director

The Home Group

First of all, I would like to comment on Joanie's loving invitation to give a presentation during this Conference. Joanie, you may have been *delighted*, but the feeling was not immediately reciprocal; in fact, if the truth be known, I think I freaked. I ran to the telephone, called my sponsor, overwhelmed with feelings of panic, inadequacy, etc., which, of course, I shared with her ad infinitum.

Big mistake!! She really knows how to bring me back to reality with a jolt. Her exact words to me were, "You can write, you can talk, you have a home group, and you do Twelfth Step work. I believe that's what they want you to share. You also know that, like everything else in life, some will listen and some won't. *Do not* plan results—that's God's work; and, as I have patiently tried to tell you, you are not Him."

Boy, she really knows how to push my buttons; but her closing remark was the best: "By the way, don't call me until you have finished." The tough love that I received from my sponsor, who is a member of my home group, has resulted in the miracle of recovery that stands before you today.

Home, as defined by Webster's Dictionary, means many things: 1) a family place of residence: a) domicile, b) house; 2) the social unit of a family living together; 3) a congenial environment; 4) objective in various games (example: home plate); 5) an establishment providing residence and special care for disabled persons.

The home group is further defined in the Preface of *The Home Group: Heartbeat of A.A.*: "The home group is where recovery begins; it is where A.A. members grow up in sobriety by the time-honored process of trial and error, to discover that they can be loved, 'warts and all.' It is where they learn to put the needs of others, especially the needs of the group, ahead of their own desires. It is where they first have the opportunity to serve others, and where they learn of opportunities to serve beyond the group. It is where they begin to adopt the guiding principles of Alcoholics Anonymous as working realities in their own sober lives."

My North Shore Tuesday Afternoon Ladies 12 x 12 home group is all of the above and more. I would like to share with you a story of my early recovery, as an example of how my group practices the principles of Twelfth Step work. The death of my seventeen-year-old daughter, by a drunk driver, in 1977 brought me to the doors of A.A. I was accepted almost unconditionally. I was offered a way out, free for the taking, regardless of anything. I was given a place to go and the opportunity to grow.

Four years into my recovery, one of my younger daughters (unable to cope with the earlier death of her sister) committed suicide. I was totally devastated. I didn't want to face the world; my life force seemed to ebb out of me, and I became a lifeless shell of a human being. The ladies from my home group not only embraced me with love and understanding, but covered me with a cloak of compassion that carried me through the painful weeks of my grief.

I slowly started to heal. In telling you this, I am reminded of the poem "Footprints in the Sand." The ladies from my home group were just there; they sat with me, shopped, drove me to meetings, never leaving me alone unless I chose to be. They truly "carried me." I was encouraged to share my grief at meet-

ings as an example to others—that we need not drink during painful times of our lives, that there is a solution, and it is O.K. not to be O.K.

One day at our afternoon meeting, my group asked me to be their G.S.R. and represent them at the district meeting. I later found out that, as in all phases of my recovery, my sponsor had asked the group to do this.

The rest is history. I took to service work like a duck to water. I found a new source for my energy and enthusiasm in the various area committees, eventually becoming area chair, and now delegate. This metamorphosis would not have been possible without the love, support and encouragement of my home group and my sponsor.

In closing, I would like to summarize. Does my home group welcome and make newcomers feel accepted? Absolutely! Does my group emphasize sponsorship? You bet. Does my group support Twelfth Step work of the local central office? Absolutely! Not only with group contributions, but with volunteers for the telephones.

I would like to sincerely thank you for the opportunity to share this story about my Tuesday Afternoon Ladies 12 x 12 home group. They are the unsung heroines of my recovery, to whom I owe a tremendous debt of gratitude. I will continue to make payments on that debt, a day at a time, by being of service to the Fellowship at all levels, and by sharing my experience, strength and hope when asked.

The fellowship and love of this Conference will be engraved in my heart forever.

Laura Zeitlin, Chicago

The Service Structure

In the course of reading and rereading about the birth of the Conference, the Conference Charter and the essays on the Twelve Concepts, I was moved by Bill's deep and abiding concern for A.A.'s future. His primary motivation in designing the General Service Structure was to insure A.A.'s future growth and unity, as well as guarantee our ability to fulfill our primary purpose. One important element of this aim was to insure that A.A. would publish and manage its own literature. Bill saw this as essential to maintaining the integrity of A.A.'s message. Our Service Structure and the spiritual principles on which it is based are meant to provide an atmosphere of harmony, trust, and freedom for those of us who labor within it.

In creating this framework Bill borrowed from two models: First, from democracy he borrowed the idea of final responsibility and ultimate authority of the groups contained in Concept I; also the idea of elected representatives who would serve as the active voice and effective conscience of A.A. contained in Concept II; in Concepts III, IV and V Bill sets out the democratic ideals of the "Right of Decision," "Right of Participation" and the "Right of Appeal." These ideas are fundamentally democratic and spiritual in nature. They guarantee that A.A. will remain a society of peers and that all voices will be heard. Thus Bill hoped to keep A.A. safe from the tyranny of any majority or minority. These ideas are based squarely on the principles of liberty and trust. We are asked to trust each other, trust the Conference and the commit-

tee process and ultimately to trust in God as we understand Him.

Second, Bill borrowed extensively from the corporate business model. He recognized that as a practical matter and in order to achieve our spiritual aim, A.A. would have to operate in the business world. In Concepts VI through XII Bill sets out in great detail the idea of delegated responsibility together with equal authority. He states often in his essays that without these principles A.A.'s World Services would cease to function. More than anything Bill wanted A.A. to succeed.

Thus to me the Service Structure is about A.A. striking a balance as a society so that we can continue to carry our life-saving message. Knowing, as Bill did from his own personal experience, that we in A.A. are given to emotional extremes which could harm us in the future, he strove to put in place a system of checks and balances so that, hopefully, we would not go too far astray. The spiritual principles of trust, prudence, sacrifice, willingness and unity are the price of our survival.

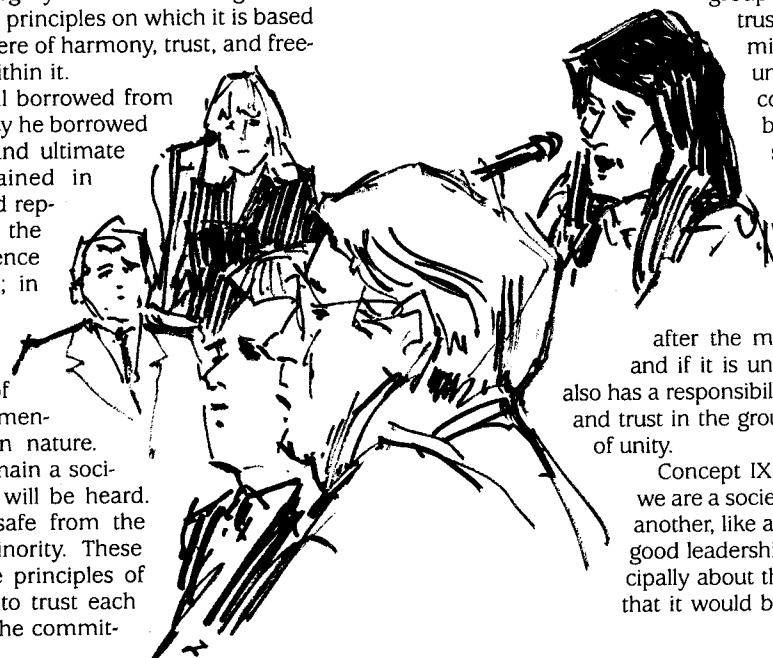
To see these principles in action we need only look at individual Concepts. Everyone seems to be aware of Concept I. The groups are the bosses. The inverted triangle with the groups at the top is our symbol. Authority is expressed as running from top to bottom. But if we read on we find that after bestowing all this power and ultimate authority on the groups, Concepts II through XI then substantially qualify this idea by explaining that as a practical matter the groups cannot manage A.A.'s World Services, because they can almost never be sufficiently informed nor, in many cases, have the required business expertise. Instead, the groups are asked to delegate their ultimate authority (but not their responsibility) to trusted servants who are always accountable to those they serve. This idea of delegating authority, of trusting our trusted servants, of sacrifice, is an essential element of our Structure. Without it A.A. World Services could not function.

Concept V, the "Right of Appeal" is a Concept that is often quoted. The minority voice is one of the most cherished ideals of A.A., because it protects us from the tyranny of the majority. A careful reading of Concept V reveals that here Bill is also confirming the reliability of the group conscience of the Conference because, in theory, it is informed and based on substantial unanimity. He calls the Conference a "small but qualified minority" (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 23) of leaders whose

group conscience should be trusted. Out of respect for the minority and concern for unity, the Conference often conducts lengthy debates before coming to a decision, sometimes even when there is a clear two-thirds majority on an issue. The minority is encouraged to speak out and indeed has a duty to do so. However,

after the minority has made its case and if it is unable to sway the group, it also has a responsibility to, at some point, let go and trust in the group conscience for the sake of unity.

Concept IX reminds us that although we are a society of equals who serve one another, like all societies, A.A. must have good leadership. Here Bill is talking principally about the trustees, for he believed that it would be the trustees who would,



of necessity, exercise A.A.'s primary leadership in World Service. Bill had great admiration for the trustees, both alcoholic and non-alcoholic, and felt that A.A. could not do without them. He cautions us in this Concept that our leaders need not be perfect but do need to be people of experience and vision who are able to take the long view. Here the quality of prudence is highly valued.

No discussion of the Service Structure would be complete without mention of the Conference Committee System, for this is where most of the work of A.A. is done. The trustees' committees deserve special mention because they carry the heaviest workload and must meet throughout the year in order to complete the work of the Conference. The committee system provides a way for A.A. to collectively focus on specific issues and questions of policy that it could never do otherwise. This deliberative process is vital to A.A.'s ability to operate effectively. We need to be careful that we do not inadvertently undermine this process. Perhaps we should examine the long-term impact on the committee system of the recent trend of widely distributing committee background material before the Conference committees have completed their deliberations. And perhaps we should ask ourselves: are we compromising this vital process?

Our Service Structure and its underlying spiritual principles provide us with both the means to survive as a movement, and the tools we need to continue to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. It is, I believe, a tremendous gift, and can best be understood as a totality, a kind of work of art, a thing of intellectual and spiritual beauty and part of the miracle of Alcoholics Anonymous. As a Fellowship we are truly blessed.

Tanya Every, Hawaii

Around the World

It is a great pleasure to serve our wonderful Fellowship as World Service delegate for U.S./Canada and to talk to you about Twelfth Step work around the world. A.A. has grown all over the globe, not by chance and not because of some executives deciding we should be in different countries, but because of A.A. members traveling abroad who started doing Twelfth Step work in the 1940s. Also, in 1946, an article on A.A. in *The Reader's Digest*, which was also printed in the foreign editions, brought calls for help to the New York service office from as far away as South Africa and New Zealand—who this year will be hosting the 15th World Service Meeting in October.

In 1950, Bill and Lois went to Europe to visit A.A.s in Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Holland, France, England and Ireland. When we think of what these countries have become and the countries that they are helping to start A.A., we have a wonderful example of Twelfth Step work around the world.

Bill realized how much the other countries needed support and decided to submit to the board the idea of a World Service Meeting, which would allow delegates from those countries that were starting a structure to share their experience. With the approval of the board, Bill sent out an invitation to about 15 countries who started a structure to participate in the First World Service Meeting at the Roosevelt Hotel, October 9-11, 1969. At the 14th World Service Meeting, in New York, in 1996 we had 42 delegates representing 26 countries.

Of course, this kind of meeting brings many delegates together to share and realize the need for this kind of Twelfth Step work. From the World Service Meetings began the idea of holding zonal meetings, which would allow countries within a sector to share together on the years when there is no World Service Meeting. And so, the Iberoamerican Service Meeting, was held for the first time in Bogota, Colombia in 1979. Seventeen dele-

gates from ten countries participated representing countries from South America. The meeting then became The Meeting of the Americas by including U.S./Canada in 1997, in which Dean Rinehart and I participated. Then came the idea of a European Service Meeting, which started in 1981 in Frankfurt, Germany, and they have kept this site because of its central location. They had the participation of 28 delegates from 14 countries, and the only non-European was Bob P. from G.S.O., who delivered the keynote address.

During the last years, the Asia/Oceania Service Meeting was created, in which countries like Japan, Australia, and New Zealand participate every two years. This Twelfth Step work has permitted A.A. to grow around the world in trying to follow our program with the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts. In all Twelfth Step work there is always a sponsor and a sponsee, and in the case of countries the same principle applies. Many countries look upon us for guidance and example.

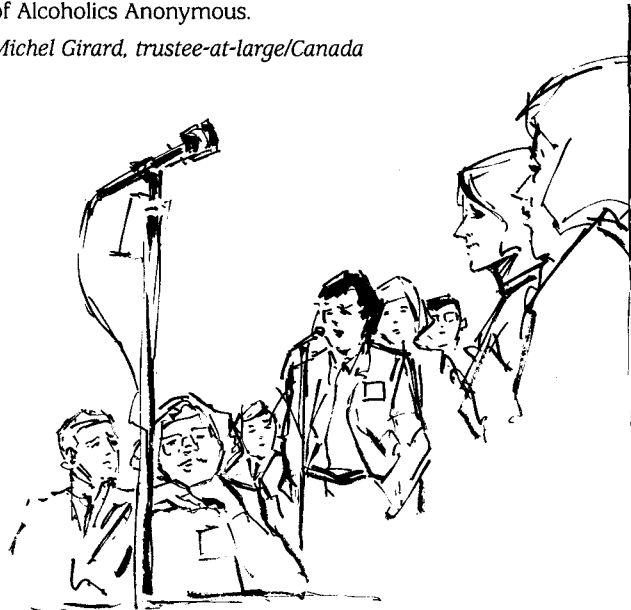
Publications are also a great part of the Twelfth Step work. Our literature catalog has 32 translations of the Big Book. Other G.S.O.s or A.A. service entities print 15 of those 32 translations and A.A.W.S. prints 17, and more are planned. We also publish the Twelve and Twelve, *Living Sober* and a variety of pamphlets in 20 languages. Twelfth Step work is also done by those A.A. members in other countries who translate our literature and send their manuscripts to our office for verification.

Of course, in many countries, the economic situation being what it is, we will support the printing of literature in their languages. This is Twelfth Step work being done with contributions that we get from the Fellowship; this is where money and spirituality meet to help the still-suffering alcoholic.

I would like to leave you with this last example of Twelfth Step work that I witnessed in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, when I participated in their 50th Anniversary last year. Each group member carries business cards of their group with the address and the meeting schedule. As you know, there are many poor people and, of course, few phones, so the way they do their Twelfth Step work is when they see a drunk sleeping or passed out on the sidewalk, they slip a few of those cards in their shirt, and when the drunk wakes up he finds the A.A. address in his shirt and sometimes shows up at the next meeting.

I want to thank you all for allowing me to live these wonderful experiences and I will always remain grateful to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Michel Girard, trustee-at-large/Canada



Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Raul Marin, our Southwest Regional trustee, died on March 5, 1998. We were all saddened by his death. Raul was a hardworking trustee who served the Southwest Region, the Grapevine, the General Service Board, and all of A.A. We are especially grateful for his service in improving the board's efforts to help carry the A.A. message to Spanish-speaking alcoholics everywhere.

Before touching briefly on several topics, I would like to say a few words in tribute to my predecessor. Jim Estelle is a dedicated and devoted servant of Alcoholics Anonymous. I appreciate his guidance and counsel and am delighted that he has agreed to continue serving as a trustee emeritus.

Since the last Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in the East Central, Northeast, West Central, and Southwest regions. We are fortunate that Raul was well enough to chair the Southwest Regional Forum and that he was able to experience the love of the A.A.s he served. In addition, we hosted Special Forums in Alaska and northern Quebec. In an effort to get wide participation in this vast and sparsely populated state, the Forum in Alaska took place in six-hour sessions at four sites: Ketchikan, Juneau, Anchorage, and Fairbanks. Six languages were represented at the Special Forum in Val d'Or, Quebec, which was planned to help reach the remote communities of northern Quebec. Carrying the message to the remote areas of Canada has been a labor of love for the delegates and trustees in Canada and Alaska, and G.S.O. has been grateful to participate in the effort.

The proposed Fourth Edition of the Big Book and what to do with a wet drunk were topics of considerable interest at Forums and wherever A.A.s gathered. The subcommittee charged with developing a Fourth Edition draft has been hard at work and has asked the Fellowship to provide stories by June 1, 1998. At Forums, we largely answered questions and let people know that a Fourth Edition would only be published

as a result of an informed group conscience of the Conference, not because the board or G.S.O. acting alone thought it was a good idea. In regard to wet drunks, Forums put a lot of A.A. experience in big rooms and gave people a chance to share with large numbers of alcoholics. There were also workshops on the topic at some Forums.

The board invited Conference committee chairmen to attend the January board meeting in New York, as we have for several years now. The board is grateful for the participation of these delegates. Their experience will allow the delegates to better serve their Conference committees, as well as helping the board prepare for the Conference.

On October 29 and 30, the board held a special session to discuss how it could better carry out our responsibilities. This meeting was a continuation of the special meeting of three years ago held in Park City, Utah. We are studying ways to make our board weekends, which have stretched to five or six days for some trustees, shorter and more productive. Overlong board weekends are expensive and tend to discourage some qualified trustee candidates from serving. While trusteeship will always require a large sacrifice of time and effort, we do not want to make the job so all consuming that able and qualified people feel they cannot serve without giving up the rest of their lives. A committee made up of Chuck Crist, MaryJane Roy, Richard Roughton, and Michel Girard is looking into how to restructure our board weekends to accomplish the same results more efficiently and in fewer days.

In response to a situation in Europe, at the November meeting the board held a special session to discuss the topic of protecting A.A.'s copyrights. The meeting was attended by A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, G.S.O. staff, and appointed members of trustees' committees. Trustees had previously been provided with extensive background material. Following thorough discussion, the trustees of the General Service Board voted unanimously to endorse the resolution of the A.A.W.S. Board to preserve and protect the copyrights held in trust for all of A.A. around the world, including taking legal action if necessary, recognizing that unchallenged infringement of our copyrighted literature would seriously affect the growth of A.A. in other countries.

It is important to recognize that the board is carrying out a legal and moral responsibility to protect the integrity of A.A. literature, to encourage the financial integrity of G.S.O.s everywhere, and to enable established service structures to maintain A.A. unity in their countries. We are not enforcing A.A. Traditions or proposing to punish anyone, something the board has no right to do, but we will carry out the trust we have been charged with. We all hope that the best solution to this situation comes to pass, which is that those parties infringing on A.A.'s copyrights stop doing so. I appointed Julian Rhinehart, Dean Rinehart, and Linda Chezem to work with G.S.O. management and A.A.W.S. in their efforts to resolve the situation in Europe and to help to carry out the board's oversight responsibility.

A.A.W.S. has kept the General Service Board well informed about the lack of unity on the board of *Publications Francaises*. Our efforts to help restore unity failed, and at the request of the *Publications Francaises* Board, A.A.W.S. acted to terminate the license it previously granted to *Publications Francaises*. G.S.O. management has been working diligently to insure that literature

and services continue without interruption to French-speaking A.A.s in Quebec, either by taking over the management of the office in Montreal and the assets and liabilities of *Publications Francaises* or by providing these services directly from G.S.O.

In December, we said goodbye to G.S.O. staff member Pat Rosenstiel and to our archivist Frank Mauser as they





retired. We welcomed Warren Stafford to the G.S.O. staff, Mary Pat Hester as circulation director of the Grapevine, and were pleased to see Judit Santon promoted to archivist from her position as assistant.

At the January board meeting, George Dorsey told the board that he wanted to retire and that he hoped this would be his last Conference as general manager. Following the procedures approved by the board last summer, I appointed a search committee to review candidates and recommend one or more to the board by the October board meeting. The search committee is composed of Elaine Johnson, chairman, Dean Rinehart, vice chairman, Art Knight, Garry McAuley, Richard Roughton, and MaryJane Roy. Immediately after the January board meeting, Elaine Johnson sent a letter to all Conference members and past trustees announcing the opening, outlining the job qualifications, and asking for applications to be submitted by the end of May. We hope to have a new general manager in place by the January board meeting. The new manager will overlap with George Dorsey as long as necessary.

George will be difficult to replace, and realistically we cannot hope to find someone with his unique mixture of skills. George has been an unbelievably hardworking general manager, has traveled heroically on our behalf, and will leave the office in excellent financial and operational shape. Most of all, we will miss his good judgment and advice on how to handle issues and questions that come before the board and the office.

As you review our financial results for 1997, you will notice a large decline in G.S.O.'s net loss. Our budget for 1998 calls for a change to positive net income for the year. Rather than refer to these as improvements to our financial health, I would point out that the losses we have experienced in the last three years have been carefully planned and described to the Fellowship in considerable detail and that we have been financially healthy all along. The losses were designed to take our Reserve Fund down to acceptable levels by cutting literature prices, not by spending more money. This deliberate loss phase is over, and it is time to stabilize the Reserve Fund. When we told the Conference in 1995 about the decision to induce losses by cutting literature prices, we said we thought we could keep the lower prices in effect for two to three years, and in fact we were able to keep them in place for almost three years. The Grapevine's finances improved as a result of good cost control and the effect of its 1996 price increase. Recall that the price increase was delayed for one year at the General Service Board's request to help lower the Reserve Fund.

The Grapevine has worked hard to lower the cost of producing La Vina, which improves its chance of success. We are pleased with the reception La Vina has received and with the participation its readers have shown by submitting articles.

As most of you know, I passed my responsibilities as treasurer of the General Service Board to Art Knight, a Class A trustee with a professional background in the field of business where he held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies.

International activity continues to hold a high priority with the board. We were happy to welcome Alejandro Marquez Cancino, G.S.O. manager, and Ramon Munoz Arellano, Class B trustee, of the General Service Board of Mexico as guests of the board at our August meeting. Michel Girard and Dean Rinehart, our trustees-at-large, served as delegates to the Tenth Meeting of the Americas in Guadalajara, Mexico in October. Michel attended the 35th A.A. Anniversary of French-speaking Switzerland in Louveraine in August. Julian Rhinehart represented the board at the Fifth Argentina International Convention and met with the country's General Service Board. Much of our work in carrying the message is directed to other countries and other cultures. We always have new translations projects underway. Last year, for example, we translated the Twelve Steps and *Living Sober* into Slavic and "44 Questions" into Amharic (Ethiopian) and we are currently working on the Big Book and *Living Sober* in Romanian, the Czech Twelve and Twelve and several other translations. By translating A.A. literature and sharing our experience with service, we can give newcomer countries a much faster start than they would get on their own. And the faster A.A. gets going, the sooner more alcoholics get sober. This type of work is "passing it on" at its best. One of the reasons it is important for us to maintain a strong Reserve Fund is that we never have to say no to an unexpected translation request or unplanned but needed international visit for financial reasons.

This Conference marks the end of my first year as chairman of the General Service Board. As I've participated in Regional Forums and talked with many of you in person or by phone, I'm more convinced than ever that we all want the same thing — to carry A.A.'s message to the alcoholic who still suffers. And I also realize more than ever how important our unity is to carrying out the Fifth Tradition. As our co-founders knew, only the Conference will permit us to work out our inevitable differences and carry the message in unity. I am grateful that you have allowed me to be part of that.

Gary Glynn, chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a New York not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors. A.A.W.S. has the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.) which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and other service literature. The board met nine times since the last Conference to hear G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on compliance with Conference and board recommendations; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; discuss publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A.s and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors; currently, four are trustees, including three regional or at-large trustees; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the services director, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, information services manager, human resources director, the archivist, the board secretary, and a Grapevine staff member. The board has welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which addresses the needs of all service assignments; Finance, which concerns salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; Publishing, which addresses reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole. During the past year, the following significant items are noted:

Services: During 1997, 2,452 new groups were registered, compared to 2,499 in 1996. The A.A.W.S. Services Committee completed work on the service piece "Memo to an A.A. Group Treasurer" and this item was sent to all Conference members and included with the June/July issue of *Box 4-5-9* and sent to all groups with their Quarterly Contribution letters. It was added to the G.S.R. kit sent to all new G.S.R.s. and included in the information packet of materials sent to A.A.s interested in starting new groups as well as in the New Group Handbook and the Self-Support packets. The service piece was also sent in bulk to central offices and intergroups.

The board approved financial assistance to Norway for printing the Norwegian A.A. *Comes of Age*, at a cost of \$13,400. This amount will be reimbursed to A.A.W.S. in semiannual installments. During 1997, \$15,189 in contributions from eight countries and several miscellaneous donations were received toward the International Literature Fund, and \$20,000 was applied toward overseas literature assistance costs. As of December 31, 1997, the Fund total was \$23,291.

During 1997, G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site was visited 214,603 times, representing "hits" in English, French and Spanish. The response vehicle (e-mail) for the Letter to Professionals on the A.A. Web Site was implemented.

In order to provide general information to the Fellowship regarding setting up web sites, the A.A.W.S. Services Committee reviewed a new service piece, "Ten Frequently Asked Questions About A.A. Web Sites." The Services Committee also accepted suggestions to add "A

Newcomer Asks," "A Message to Teenagers" and the annual Anonymity Letter to Media to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. The board approved a suggestion and recommended that G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site address be added to G.S.O.'s stationery, as well as to recovery pamphlets as they are reprinted.

A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in the following Regional Forums since the last Conference: East Central, in Moline, Iowa, May 30-June 1 (369 attendees); Northeast, in Tarrytown, New York, June 20-22 (563 attendees); Southwest, in Houston, Texas, December 5-7 (425 attendees); West Central, in St. Paul, Minnesota, September 5-7 (389 attendees). Special Forums were held in Alaska (consisting of one-day mini-Forums in Ketchikan, Juneau, Anchorage and Fairbanks) May 9 - 12 (totaling 183 attendees); and Val d'Or, Quebec, August 22-23 (331 attendees).

The 12th Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar was held in Columbus, Ohio, October 24-26, with 160 participants.

International: Preparations continued for the 15th World Service Meeting, to be held in Auckland, New Zealand, October 4-8, 1998. In October, staff member Richard Bush met with A.A.s in France, Poland, and the Netherlands and then attended the European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany, followed by a visit to the German G.S.O. in Munich.

The G.S.O. manager of Central Mexicana, Alejandro Marquez Cancino, and a member of the Board of A.A. in Mexico, Ramon Munoz Arellano, visited G.S.O. and attended the July General Service Board weekend.

During the past year, Julian Rhinehart and Richard Bush met with the Board of Trustees of A.A. in Argentina. Dean Rhinehart, Michel Girard and Danny Mooney visited G.S.O. in Mexico City and attended the Meeting of the Americas in Guadalajara.

Danny Mooney attended Brazil's 21st General Service Conference of A.A. in Sao Paulo, and the 14th Convention (50



years) in Rio de Janeiro. Danny also attended the Fifth General Service Conference in Asuncion, Paraguay.

George Dorsey and Danny Mooney attended a Spanish General Service Board meeting in Aviles, Spain. Staff member Joanie Moncrief and Vinnie McCarthy, Publications director, visited the A.A. Central Office in Prague, Czech Republic; and attended the 10th Jubilee Convention and board meetings in Moscow, Russia. An agreement was executed to permit the Russian General Service Board to reprint the current translation of the Russian Big Book.

Finance: The board received, approved and forwarded to the General Service Board, mid-year budget adjustments totaling \$81,000. These included the following items which resulted from 1997 General Service Conference recommendations: \$41,000 - Corrections Video; and \$40,000 - Public Information Announcements.

A brief summary of the financial results for 1997 follows: Gross sales for the year of \$9,221,300 were approximately \$111,000 less than budgeted and \$186,000 more than in 1996. Gross profit (sales less cost of manufacturing, royalties, shipping & warehousing) was \$4,244,400, approximately \$45,000 greater than budgeted and \$1,043,000 greater than in 1996. Contribution support for the year of \$3,854,600 was approximately \$175,000 (4.3%) under budget and \$58,000 (1.5%) less than 1996. Total revenue (gross profit from literature and contributions) was \$8,103,000, approximately \$130,500 under budget.

Total expenses for the year of \$8,347,900 were approximately \$105,400 under budget. The "people" expense category (salaries, payroll taxes, medical insurance and employee retirement) ended the year below budget, approximately \$180,000. Retirement expense for the year was approximately \$45,000 under budget. The principal reason for the under budget condition is that the actuarial valuation showed considerable improvement driven by the last few years of stock market gains.

For 1997, the statements reflect a loss of \$244,900 compared with a budgeted loss of \$219,900.

Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended the 1998 G.S.O. budget to the trustees' Finance Committee, calling for sales of \$9,574,800,

contributions of \$3,932,000, operating expenses of \$8,477,400, and a net income of \$237,910.

Publishing: We published the following items: "The A.A. Grapevine, Our Meeting in Print" (pamphlet); Treatment Facilities Handbook; Twelve Steps and *Living Sober* in Slovak; and "44 Questions" in Amharic (Ethiopian). Eight translations were still in progress at mid-March 1998.

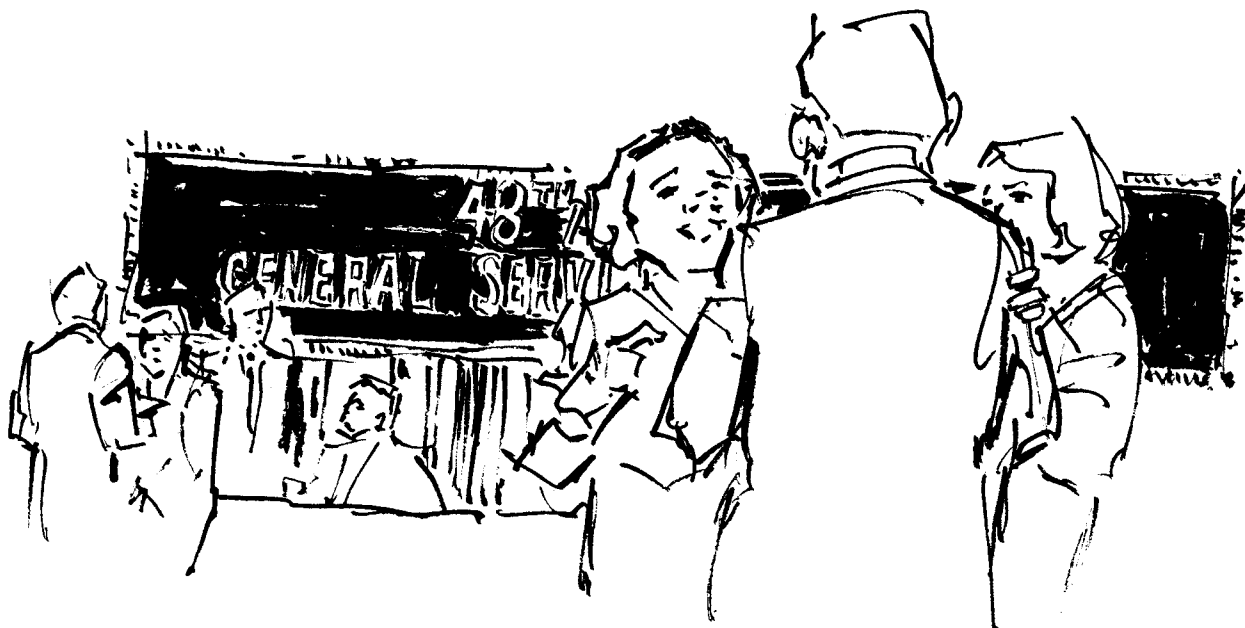
During 1997, the board granted permission/did not object to 221 requests to reprint from A.A. literature; 41 requests were denied.

Facsimile of First Edition of the Big Book by The Anonymous Press—The Anonymous Press (formerly "I.W.S., Inc.") notified us that they intended to publish a facsimile of the First Edition of the Big Book. (We no longer hold the copyright on this material in the U.S.) Following correspondence with The Anonymous Press, they agreed to print "Reproduction Published by the Anonymous Press" on the dust jacket, cover and title page. The title page will also contain the disclaimer utilized in their other publications.

Copyright Infringement in Europe —G.S.O. management provided the A.A.W.S. Board with substantial background concerning serious copyright violations—in several languages—by an individual in Germany. The same individual also indicated his intention to do the same regarding the Russian translation of the Big Book. The board passed the following resolution: "Resolved: That the A.A.W.S. Board recognizes its responsibility to preserve and protect the copyrights held in trust for all of A.A., both here in U.S./Canada, and throughout the world. The A.A.W.S. Board further recognizes that unchallenged infringement of our copyrighted literature seriously impacts the future growth of A.A. overseas."

Following adoption of this resolution, the board authorized management, working with the board's legal advisor, the chairpersons of the A.A.W.S. and General Service Boards, and such other persons as the respective chairs might assign, to take such appropriate action, including legal action, as may be necessary to meet the challenge. A.A.W.S. subsequently retained a German lawyer to advise us.

Publications Francaises —During the past year, A.A.W.S. has dealt with a situation concerning Publications Francaises, an



autonomous A.A. service board in Quebec that has been licensed to fulfill A.A.W.S.' responsibility to provide French-language literature to French-speaking groups in Canada. Issues concerning the Publications Francaises Board were brought to the attention of the A.A.W.S. Board as a result of two letters—one signed by three Quebec delegates and the Eastern Canada trustee and a second letter signed by members of the Management Committee—making conflicting requests concerning revocation of Publications Francaises' license.

The A.A.W.S. chairperson, the General Service Board treasurer and G.S.O. manager met with the Publications Francaises Board in an attempt to reach accord. However, by October 30, 1997, no progress was reported in resolving the issue between the Management Committee and the delegates and Eastern Canada trustee. Another letter had been received signed by three delegates and the Eastern Canada trustee, which again requested termination of the license. Following discussion, the board adopted a resolution to issue a notice of termination of the licensing agreement between A.A. World Services, Inc. and Les Publications Francaises A.A. du Quebec (1979) Inc., effective April, 1, 1998 (which was later extended by A.A.W.S. Board action to May 1, 1998).

The Board of Publications Francaises subsequently, unanimously, requested that A.A.W.S. take over the operations, assets and liabilities of that organization. A.A.W.S. immediately undertook a process of "due diligence" with respect to Publications Francaises which, by late March 1998, was near completion.

New Format Requests Approved — The Publishing Committee of A.A.W.S. forwarded reviewed incoming requests and recommended the following new formats of existing A.A. literature, which were approved: Big Book "Pioneer Stories" and *Living Sober* on audiocassette; and Twelve and Twelve on diskette for use on a P.C.

The following items were considered by the A.A.W.S. Publishing Committee but not forwarded to the board for approval: Large-print version of *The A.A. Service Manual*, combined with *Twelve Concepts for World Service* (this item is produced on an informal basis and was not approved to become a standard item of inventory); *Daily Reflections* on audio cassette (not deemed useful to individuals with impairments); Twelve Concepts Window Shades (posters can be produced locally with the permission of A.A.W.S.); Gift Edition of *Daily Reflections* (no demonstrated need for item in proposed format); General Service Structure chart (item appears in *The A.A. Service Manual* and can be reproduced easily, with permission of A.A.W.S.); Large-print versions of *A.A. Comes of Age*, *Pass It On*, and *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*; Twelve Concepts Essays (as they appear in *The A.A. Service Manual* and text from "Twelve Concepts Illustrated") on audiotape.

Fourth Edition of Big Book — Regarding the draft of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, approximately 300 stories were received for review by the trustees' Literature Committee.

New catalogs of English and Spanish literature were prepared for Fall 1997/Winter 1998.

Nominating: The A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee made the following recommendations to fill 1998 vacancies, which were approved by the board: Ronald J. Gauthier and Jan Polek were selected to serve as non-trustee directors starting in May 1998. A.A.W.S. non trustee director Jacqueline Johnston was elected to serve as a general service trustee, following the 1998

Conference.

In addition, Lois Fisher was elected as a director, replacing Susan Ulseth who rotated out of the G.S.O. staff coordinator position, due to staff rotation on October 1, 1997. All of the above recommendations were

forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

Other Board Actions: On May 15, 1997, the board, acting as a "committee of the whole," elected a slate of officers to terms expiring at the end of the April 1998 Conference. Beginning in May 1997, Garry McAuley replaced rotating regional trustee director Julian Rhinehart. The board requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee approve Jack L. Ostrem to replace MaryJane Roy as a regional trustee director following the 1998 Conference.

At year-end 1997, G.S.O. had 83 full-time positions, down from 103 at year-end 1991. The board welcomed new G.S.O. staff member Warren Stafford, on Correctional Facilities, replacing Pat Rosenstiel. Judit Santon was appointed G.S.O. archivist, replacing Frank Mauser.

The utilization of office space on the 10th and 11th floors at 475 Riverside Drive was reviewed and it appeared possible that G.S.O. could consolidate all operations on the 11th floor which would result in a savings of \$40,000-50,000 per year, or \$400,000-500,000 over the course of a ten-year lease. Construction costs required for the consolidation were being determined to ensure that they would be justified by the reduced rental expense.

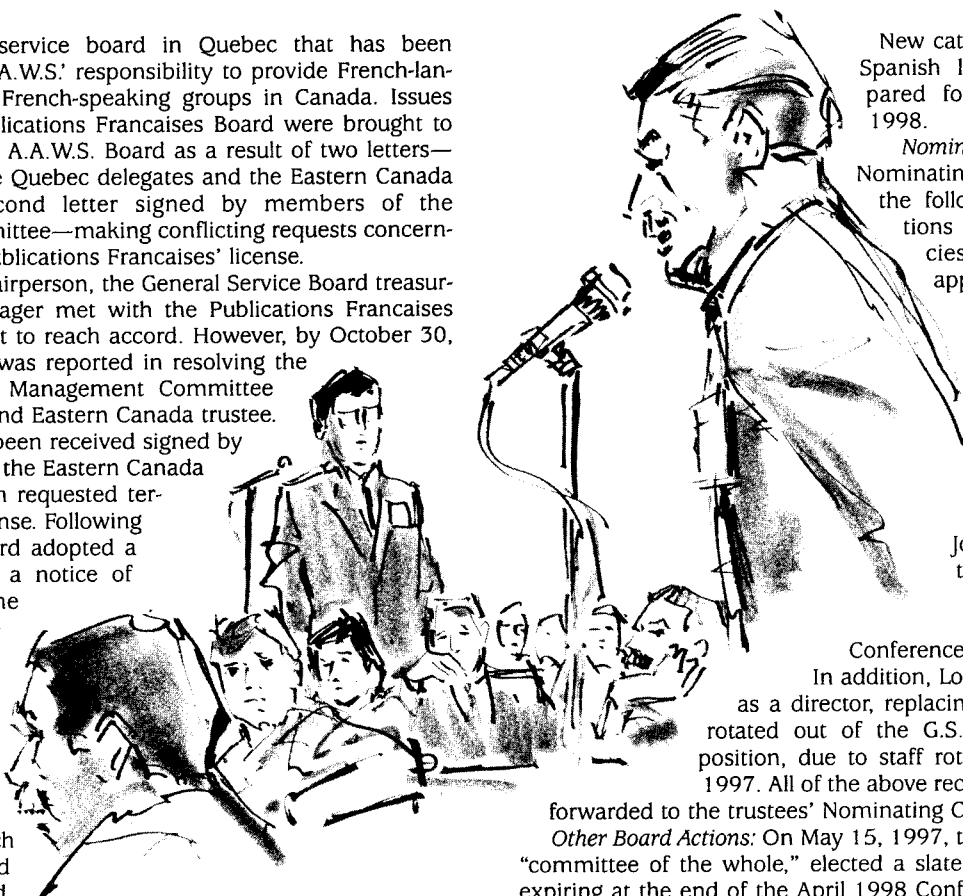
By the end of December 1997, G.S.O. had welcomed 1,264 visitors for the year.

MaryJane Roy, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: Our committee met three times since last year's Conference, and new committee members have been encouraged to visit the General Service Archives to learn the specifics of the collection.

The committee approved the final format of the Archives Guidelines, and the Guidelines were sent to all delegates, area archivists, and archives chairs. Planning for the reproduction of the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" continued in 1997. We



will be able to use most of the documents from the current version, and only a few additional shots are to be added to reflect the changes since the original production, e.g., current office location. It was agreed that for practical reasons, such as the inherent dangers of airmailing priceless, one-of-a-kind archival items, the actual work on this project will be undertaken in the New York area. The committee supported the acceptance of Dr. Silkworth's desk, which was offered to the G.S.O. Archives, since it was such a singular contribution, even though it is not within our general scope. The committee cautioned against setting any trend of accepting articles of this type in the future.

Robert Miller, D.D., chairperson

Archivist's report: The Archives' new room, providing additional storage in October 1997, was completely filled with our files by the end of the year. Thus the formerly crowded primary storage area has been somewhat relieved. Our scanning operation proceeds at a steady pace. Currently, we manage to scan 400-500 pages a day. We have processed approximately 70,000 documents (last year we reported 38,500 around this time).

We have started the preliminary planning of a bibliographic database application for the Archives' holdings, which will allow us to locate all relevant documents for a request more effectively. The nature and the purpose of this new application will be distinctly different from the purposes of the scanner. Many area archives have developed such systems already; it seems, it is time to catch up with them.

We received an outstanding amount of requests for groups' histories in 1997, and an increasing number of areas have provided updates for our permanent files, as well.

Judit Santon, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1997 Conference. We reviewed 1997 Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 48th General Service Conference, "Our Twelfth Step Work." We also reviewed the Conference Evaluation Questionnaires. An Agenda Planning Subcommittee reviewed the Questionnaire summary and we agreed to stay with the time frame used during the 1997 Conference and to begin the work of the Conference on Monday, April 20, 1998. The committee also approved the subcommittee's suggestions that: 1) spouses or partners of rotating trustees be invited to attend the Closing Brunch because that event is the culmination of many years of service, where rotating people speak as trustees for the last time; 2) we request chairpersons of each board to give *summaries only* of board reports at the Conference because these reports are printed in the Conference Manual; 3) the secretary respectfully request all presenters to submit their talks in the length suggested in the invitation, and to plan to stay within the time frame allotted during each presentation; and 4) accepted a delegate's suggestion for one "casual-dress day" during the 1998 Conference.

We also reviewed proposed topics submitted for the 1998 Conference, and forwarded subjects to the appropriate trustees' or Conference committee. We also discussed 1995 Advisory Action 20 on future growth of the Conference, and referred the subject to the General Service Board. We approved Workshop questions, and reviewed an updated Conference agenda, including presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda Committee, and approved by the 1997 Conference. The Conference Agenda Committee's agenda was reviewed and approved.

The committee agreed to change item 6 in the "Scope" of the Composition, Scope and Procedure to better describe the responsibility of the committee to respond to topics suggested for consideration by a Conference.

William Bungay, chairperson



Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year, and the Conference coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator's desk is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 92 areas throughout the U.S. and Canada.

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area committees for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referral to a Conference committee. The Conference secretary is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Joanie Moncrief

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The work of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community embodies A.A.'s primary purpose, and is guided by actions of the General Service Conference and the General Service Board. The committee focus is to assist local C.P.C. committees in providing A.A. information to professionals who may come into contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their work.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Following is a list of work over the past year:

- The Literature Review Subcommittee continued work on the draft pamphlet combining "If You Are A Professional," "A.A. In Your Community," and "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs." The committee decided "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" would not be included and a draft of a revised pamphlet to replace "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" was forwarded to the 1998 Conference C.P.C. Committee.
- A draft of a pamphlet to replace the existing pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" was forwarded to the 1998 Conference Committee for review.
- A summary report of responses from the 1997 C.P.C. chairpersons' questionnaire, "C.P.C. Service Work and Cooperation with Professional Schools" was reviewed. The committee agreed to send summary results to area, district and central offices/intergroups, C.P.C. committees and also forward the information to Publications for inclusion in a future issue of *Box 4-5-9*.

- The committee considered adding information to the C.P.C. Workbook and A.A. Guidelines on introducing A.A. to students of professional schools and agreed to forward suggested additions to the 1998 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community for review.

In addition, the committee agreed to forward a request to the 1998 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community to discuss the idea of A.A. members taking students of professional schools to A.A. meetings.

- We discussed two pamphlets submitted by two area committees entitled "So You've Been Told to Go to A.A." and agreed that the development of both pamphlets is best left to local autonomy.
- We continued discussion of C.P.C. input in the development of future Membership Surveys and moved to forward this topic to the 1998 Conference C.P.C. Committee.
- The committee reviewed and approved the updated list of C.P.C. exhibits scheduled for national meetings of professional associations; 25 exhibits were coordinated for 1997. We also reviewed the number of requests from professionals for additional information about A.A. via the e-mail response form located in the letter to the professional on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site and continue to look for additional ways the A.A. Web Site may be utilized in C.P.C. service work. The chairperson of the committee emphasized that "requests from professionals around the world have indicated a need for A.A. literature in as many languages as possible."

John N. Chappel, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the C.P.C. assignment is to provide information about A.A. and establish good communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work. These professionals include physicians, nurses, attorneys, correctional personnel, the clergy, social workers, counselors, employers, educators, and those working in the field of alcoholism. The staff member on this assignment maintains communication with C.P.C. committee chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons are sent a welcome letter



and receive the C.P.C. Kit containing the C.P.C. Workbook, Guidelines, History and Actions, A.A. pamphlets and Literature Catalog, Box 4-5-9, and a current issue of *About A.A.* Upon request we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience and providing C.P.C. material. Currently there are over 350 area, district and central office/intergroup C.P.C. committees. We receive minutes from several of these committees and encourage all to share their experience for possible inclusion in Box 4-5-9.

In the past year the C.P.C. staff member has responded to over a thousand inquiries; 650 of these requests followed visits to our A.A. Web Site. We often provide a link to the local C.P.C. committees which demonstrate how valuable C.P.C. service is on all fronts. By now, most of these professionals can share that not only does A.A. respond in a friendly manner and provide literature about A.A., but many are in contact with A.A. members providing local information about A.A. in their community. C.P.C. committees can also share that they have accumulated much experience through cooperating with these professionals in ways that preserve the spirit of A.A.'s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

Twenty-five exhibits were coordinated for national professional meetings for 1997 and staffed by local C.P.C. committees. Twenty-eight invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees for local professional events. In addition, we furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees. Exhibits continued to be an effective tool in carrying the message to professionals and often result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as requests to receive issues of our publication *About A.A.* Currently more than 18,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Meetings with students from Cornell University Medical Center continue to be set up throughout the year at G.S.O. The students are provided with literature about A.A., see the video "Hope: Alcoholic Anonymous," and have a brief introduction to the A.A. program, concluding with a tour of G.S.O. Following each visit the students thank us for the opportunity to know A.A. as a resource in their future professions.

Adrienne Brown

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to those alcoholics confined in correctional institutions. Since the 1997 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times to implement Advisory Actions of the Conference and develop its recommendations to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for their consideration.

Following through with Conference recommendations, the committee completed a final version of the video on carrying the message behind the walls, and efforts were made to address the eight concerns outlined in the 1997 Conference Advisory Action. At the January 1998 meeting, the committee unanimously recommended that the final version of the video be forwarded to the 1998 Conference Committee for their consideration. The cost of the completed project was approximately \$66,400.

The committee reviewed additional considerations of the 1997 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities and made the following recommendations and/or took the following actions:

- The committee recommended that the proposed additions to the Correctional Facilities Workbook on youth detention centers

and short-term facilities be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for approval.

- A subcommittee was formed to review the current A.A. corrections literature and to distribute a questionnaire to Correctional Facilities chair people in order to determine whether there is a need for additional C.F. literature. Following a review of the current literature for Correctional Facilities, the subcommittee did not find a need to make changes in the existing literature or to develop additional literature at this time. However, based upon the subcommittee's review of the results of the questionnaire sent to C.F. chairpersons and C.F. committee members in all areas, it was determined that there is a need to begin the process of soliciting additional stories for the purpose of updating *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, "Memo to an Inmate," and "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell." A new subcommittee has been formed to begin work on this task.

- The committee recommended that two examples of informational letters from the General Service Office to wardens and correctional professionals, together with background information and suggestions from the committee, be forwarded to the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for their consideration.

Discussions were held regarding the following topics:

- The committee discussed requests for reissuing the Correctional Facilities directory and saw no need to reissue the directory at this time.
- The committee began discussions regarding an A.A. member's suggestion that the General Service Office be used to coordinate prerelease contact linkages for U.S./Canada. The discussion will resume when the committee meets in August 1998.

Carl Budd, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in correctional institutions. Over 600 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local C.F. committees.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support in this effort from experienced A.A.s with whom they can share strength, hope and experience. There is an on-going need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. We have available an attractive service piece about our CCS (F-26) which we include in new group packages and can be ordered for group literature stands. The number of inmate requests for correspondence contacts are submitted at a 4:1 ratio when compared with the number of outside A.A.s submitting their names to the CCS. Yet, whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of F-26 service pieces, there has been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside.

Development of the video and the continuing effort by G.S.O. staff to capture the interest of A.A.s throughout North America in order to increase their participation in the Correctional Correspondence Service, represent a small part of the correctional facilities assignment's continuing effort to facilitate the Fellowship's Twelfth Step effort regarding the alcoholic inmate.

Warren Stafford

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY COMMITTEE

Trustees' committee: At last year's Conference your controller reviewed the proposed budget for 1997 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a loss from operations of \$220,000. This followed substantial, but planned, losses in both 1995 and 1996 that helped to lower the Reserve Fund balance. Today I can report that actual results for 1997 were very close to budget and that we have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund balance, which now stands at just nine months.

As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. I am disappointed to have to report that contributions in 1997 were lower than both those received in 1996 and the amount we had hoped to receive for 1997. Contributions were \$58,000, or 1.5%, lower than 1996 and \$175,000 (4.3%) less than our budget. Since 1996 was the highest level of contributions of the prior four years, perhaps we were overly optimistic that a positive trend had started. In any case, during 1997, \$3,854,600 in contributions were received from 24,400 groups. That, for comparison, represents 44.5% of the 56,300 groups registered with G.S.O., and is lower than the 44.9% that contributed in 1996.

Net sales of literature were \$8,898,300. This was \$117,500 less than budgeted, but \$638,000, or 7.7%, greater than the previous year. Keep in mind that some literature prices were adjusted upward in May 1997, following two years of lower prices and increased discounts. In fact, the number of actual pieces of literature sold declined about 4% below the 1996 level. Printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were all less than budgeted and less than the prior year, so gross profit from literature sales increased. Gross profit of \$4,244,600 was \$45,000 greater than budgeted and \$1,043,000 more than realized in 1996. As a result, total G.S.O. revenue was \$8,103,000. Total revenue was \$130,500, or 1.5%, less than originally budgeted, but \$985,400, or 13.8%, greater than 1996. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 1997 were \$8,347,900. This is \$105,400 less than budget, and essentially "flat" to the previous year. Therefore, compared to the budget, the modest reduction in revenues was significantly offset by the reduced expenses, resulting in an operating loss of \$244,900 for the year, compared to a budgeted loss of \$219,900.

In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. It now stands at 9 months, which is a little lower than it should be in normal times. Our projections indicate that the Reserve Fund will be in the 9 month range at the end of 1998. At \$7,363,835, the Reserve Fund amounts to \$131 per listed A.A. group. Some of the discounts that were increased in 1994 were rolled back to 1994 levels on August 1, 1996 and, as Gary Glynn described in this report last year, price adjustments were required in May of 1997 for us to continue our current level of services. Since 1990, our unit sales of books have declined at an average rate of 4.5% per year. We are now selling one-quarter fewer books (actually 27% fewer, even with additional formats and titles) than we were selling in 1990. Despite excellent cost control — our operating and shipping expenses were actually lower in 1997 than they were in 1991 when we last raised prices — we simply had to raise prices if we are to continue to provide the Fellowship with the current level of services. No further price increases are anticipated for the next year.

We cannot ignore the reality of the continuing decline in unit

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1998¹

	Groups	Members
United States	50,997	1,166,079
Canada	5,277	102,499
Correctional facilities ²	2,399	62,129
Internationalists		108
Lone members		312
Total	58,673	1,331,127
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	38,895	636,306
Grand Total	97,568	1,967,433

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups registered with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 43 countries that have autonomous general service offices. Annually we attempt to contact G.S.O.s outside of US/Canada and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use previous year's figures.

literature sales; therefore, the 1998 G.S.O. budget assumes a further 4.0% decline. Perhaps, if as a result of this Conference and in keeping with its theme — more Twelfth Step work is done, the use of our literature will again increase. More optimistically, this year's budget includes a 2.0% increase in contributions. Additionally, the budget envisions a slight, \$130,000 (1.5%), increase in operating expenses. While personnel costs are estimated to be essentially the same as 1997, expenses projected for such items as the new G.S.O. video brochure, the World Service Meeting Report and reprinting the Conference Advisory Actions raise program printing costs. Additionally, "other literature assistance" (which is assistance to A.A. in other countries in translating and printing A.A. literature), increases significantly with many items carried over from 1997 and new requests expected in 1998. Finally, the net cost (total cost less delegate countries' fees) of the World Service Meeting in New Zealand is reflected in this year's budget. Based on these primary assumptions — a 4.0% decrease in literature unit sales; a 2.0% increase in contributions; a \$130,000 increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 1998 is for a modest excess of revenue over expense of \$237,900. In other words, following three consecutive years of losses, the Reserve Fund is at the point where it is prudent to anticipate a slightly better than break-even year.

In 1997, we spent \$5,944,000 on services to the Fellowship, essentially even with the \$5,925,000 spent in 1996. Contributions provided 65% of this, 31% came from net literature sales support and the balance 4% came from the Reserve Fund. Services spending amounted to \$106 per listed A.A. group, exactly even with 1996, while contributions were \$68 per group. The 1997 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contribu-

tions processing; and French services), 40.4 %; C.P.C., 4.5%; Public Information, 4.1%; Treatment Facilities, 1.5%; Correctional Facilities, 4.6%; Loners, Internationalists and Overseas Services, 8.5%; the General Service Conference, 12.0%; Regional Forums, 5.6%; Archives, 6.4%; trustees' and directors' activities, 8.3%; Spanish Services, 4%; and .1% to cover the preliminary expenses of the World Service Meeting.

At the Grapevine, magazine income rose \$76,000 over last year because of the price increase that took effect on new subscriptions beginning April 1, 1996. Circulation was somewhat lower. Average circulation during 1997 was 120,679 compared with 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$980,200, which was \$126,000 higher than last year and \$49,000 higher than budget as a result of direct production costs being considerably lower than budgeted. Weak sales of some books and tapes caused Other Publishing Income to decline, both compared with last year and budget. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income was \$30,000 lower than last year and \$22,000 under budget. Total income, including interest income, was \$1,334,500, \$134,500 greater than last year and \$30,000 more than budgeted. Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,417,100. This was \$29,000 higher than last year and \$52,000 over budget. Much of this increase is attributable to unanticipated one-time costs related to the early retirement of Grapevine personnel and professional fees related to personnel matters. The Grapevine reported a loss of \$82,600, \$22,000 greater than budgeted, but \$106,000 less than in 1996.

The Grapevine's 1998 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a \$69,000 increase in magazine income to \$1,758,800, compared with 1997, and an increase of \$97,000 in magazine gross profit. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$42,000, interest income should remain approximate-

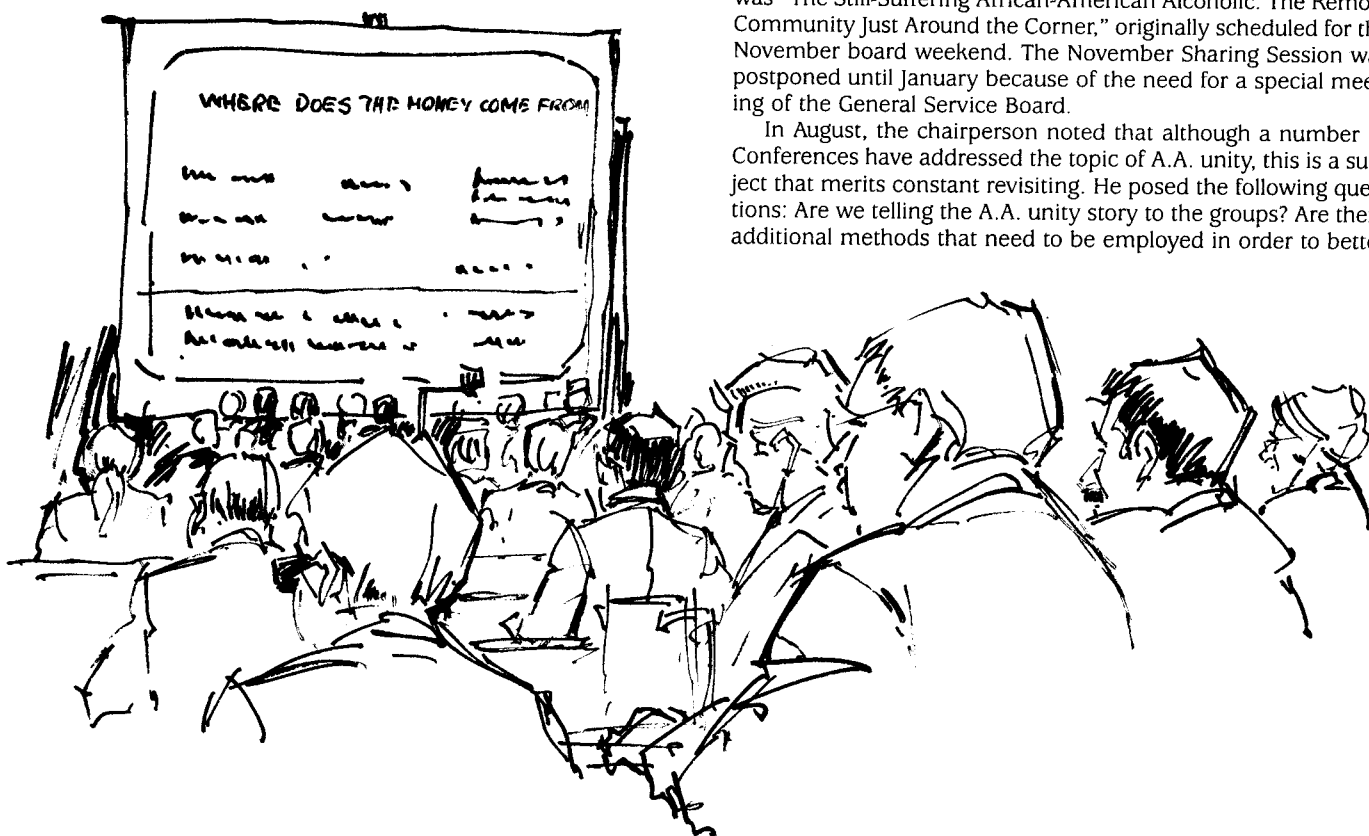
ly the same and costs and expenses are projected to increase by \$67,000. The net effect is a budgeted decline in net loss, from \$82,560 in 1997 to \$10,170 in 1998. With savings realized during January 1998, the Grapevine hopes to break even for 1998. As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 1997 average circulation of close to 8,400. Personally speaking, La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see continued growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past two and one-half years. During 1997, subscription income was \$62,000 and direct costs of publishing were \$65,000, resulting in a \$3,000 loss. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$99,000. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project was \$102,000 for the year. The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost effective basis. For 1998, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to decline to \$78,400 and circulation is projected to show a modest increase to 9,500. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr., chairperson

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: There have been two General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference. In August 1997 the topic was "A.A. Unity — Today and Tomorrow" and in January 1998 the topic was "The Still-Suffering African-American Alcoholic: The Remote Community Just Around the Corner," originally scheduled for the November board weekend. The November Sharing Session was postponed until January because of the need for a special meeting of the General Service Board.

In August, the chairperson noted that although a number of Conferences have addressed the topic of A.A. unity, this is a subject that merits constant revisiting. He posed the following questions: Are we telling the A.A. unity story to the groups? Are there additional methods that need to be employed in order to better



relate what A.A. unity means to our Fellowship in the fullest practical and spiritual sense? He shared that he learned about the fabric of unity by traveling to A.A. functions with his sponsor when he was new.

The first presenter, G.S.O. staff member Richard Bush, conveyed why the concept of unity became so important to the Fellowship. Sharing a historical perspective and recalling his own experience, Richard noted that what we are as a society is the core of unity. We stick together as a Fellowship of alcoholics in action, for neither magic nor miracles happen if we remain alone.

The second presenter, Greg Tobin, Grapevine director, shared ideas on "Unity — Tomorrow's Legacy" and talked about ways A.A.s might be more effective in fostering unity through communication, sponsorship, prayer and the home group.

The presentations prompted discussion on how we, as trusted servants, could continue to foster unity and the tools needed to remain a healthy society of alcoholics in action. Some of the ideas put forth were: Continue to talk to each other; reach out through new communication tools such as the Internet; examine what you say in committee work — be clear, concise and accurate; search for answers in the Twelve Traditions; trust, be inclusive and be open; understand that a group has a right to be wrong; communicate A.A.'s primary purpose; work and serve for the good of all of A.A.; use the 1996 Membership Survey to convey that we still have a long way to go to reach all alcoholics who need help; protect our Fellowship; the Twelve Traditions are non-negotiable; start new groups; convey to the new member that A.A. unity goes far beyond the group. Our unity is like a chain in *that it is only as strong as our weakest link. Unity will always exist as long as we have love and tolerance of others and live our Traditions.*

At the January Sharing Session, the chairman shared that in his travels he is not seeing significant numbers of African-Americans in meetings and that prompted him to suggest a sharing session on the topic, "The African-American Community: The Remote Community Just Around the Corner."

Elaine Johnson, Class A trustee, and Tony Hurley, an appointed member of the trustees' Public Information Committee, made presentations. Both noted the lack of black participation in A.A. at all levels. The presentations sparked a full discussion on the topic which ranged from sharing experience about how African-American participation had been encouraged in some areas to expressions of discomfort in talking about this subject, which suggested to the participants who expressed those feelings that their discomfort might indicate a need to take an inventory of our activity and interactions.

It was noted that without diversity, there is no unity. It is a matter of consciousness-raising and becoming more aware. Issues of inclusion have long been issues in this country, so it is only natural that they would extend into Alcoholics Anonymous. Our Fellowship is faced with the same problems that society has faced for several centuries. As we get to know one another, we may then avoid stereotypes, so it is important to encourage people who select meeting speakers to be more diverse in their selection so that we may all get to know one another better. There is nothing wrong with pointed, focused efforts to get more diversity on the board, in the office, and in the service structure. It is important to make a commitment to inclusion and diversity and the board can lead by example.

Several observed that the presentations and the sharing had provided some possible solutions with regard to how our Fellowship can more effectively carry the A.A. message to the African-American community. The C.P.C. and Public Information committees have existing channels in their local communities.

Various committees can extend the hand of A.A. to African-American institutions. This means establishing contacts with churches, professional organizations, the black media and employers serving large black populations.

This also means that each of us can take our own inventories and ask ourselves if we are welcoming new African-American alcoholics into our home groups and sponsoring them into the service structure when they have been sober awhile. A predominant sense throughout the sharing session was summed up clearly by one participant who shared that people tend to feel more welcome if they see others like themselves in a meeting or at a convention or serving the Fellowship.

Tom Maguire, chairperson

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature into other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal service meetings. The committee is a primary link between the international A.A. community and the General Service Board of Trustees.

The World Service Meeting is a biennial meeting of delegates from countries with an organized service structure. Michel Girard, trustee-at-large/Canada, and Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S., will represent this General Service Board at the 15th World Service Meeting, October 4-8, in Auckland, New Zealand. The theme of the 1998 World Service Meeting will be "Service — Basic to Personal Recovery and A.A. Unity." George Dorsey will be presiding at the event and Richard Bush will serve as WSM coordinator. Other G.S.O. staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Valerie O'Neill, Eva Sanchez and Adrienne Brown. John Kirwin will be in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities and planning for the event. Trevor Gillies, a former WSM delegate from New Zealand, is chairing the host committee.

The 1998 Literature Assistance budget of \$142,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of service material. Some examples: Pamphlet reprints in Hungarian, Slovak, Russian and Czech; *Living Sober* and the Twelve and Twelve in Turkish; Lithuanian *As Bill Sees It*; Czech Twelve and Twelve; Romanian *Living Sober* and the Big Book; and the Croatian Big Book. Included in the budget are expenses for shipping and distribution, manuscript checking and miscellaneous service material. This service is partially underwritten by contributions of U.S./Canada groups, as well as support from the International Literature Fund of contributions from A.A. groups around the world.

Travel and Communication—In the past couple of years, we have experienced a large increase in overseas correspondence. During 1997, translations of routine correspondence cost \$30,000, compared to \$24,000 in 1996 and \$15,000 in 1995.

Through invitations from A.A.s in other lands, trustees and staff have traveled to Cuba, Mexico, Argentina, Dominican Republic, Brazil, Switzerland, Germany, Russia, Paraguay, El Salvador, Czech Republic, Spain, New Zealand, Poland, France, Holland and Norway since the past Conference.

Returning from the trip to G.S.O. Tuesday, Cesar Borri (Puerto Rico) and Phil Von Schaaf (Tennessee) waited for the 109 subway train for an hour and a half. They had been told to take the 1 or 9 train!

Interim Service Meetings: The United States and Canada were represented at three zonal service meetings, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In 1997, George Dorsey attended the Asia-Oceania Meeting in Auckland, New Zealand; Michel Girard and Dean Rinehart were delegates to the Meeting of the Americas in Guadalajara, Mexico, and were accompanied by Danny Mooney; and Richard Bush was at the European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany.

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Michel Girard, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives requests for help from alcoholics in the depths of misery that we all understand; letters from new groups asking for literature and the reassurance of identification and shared experience; from professionals seeking information on how A.A. works; and from members staffing a new office that is struggling to stay afloat. Each request is answered with a letter, often accompanied by A.A. literature. Where there is a nearby office, we share the location and telephone number. The emphasis is on our faith that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The staff member on the International desk benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department, and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, to which he or she serves as secretary.

Some responsibilities on this assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new central offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into a foreign language. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of checking each translation against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 34 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.

Responsibilities in regard to translations include close cooperation with the Spanish Services staff member, who may first receive up-to-date details on A.A. in a country where Spanish is the primary language, and communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Service Meetings. Our board sends one or two representatives to the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting, the European Service Meeting and the Meeting of the Americas (formerly the Ibero-American Meeting).

Richard Bush

Several delegates were dumbstruck to see a man walking down Broadway with a boa constrictor wrapped around his body. New Yorkers didn't even notice!

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. The committee acts and makes recommendations in order to effect the broad purposes of the General Service Board, as those purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well-planned International Conventions.

The committee reviewed procedures for taping at International Conventions and recommended that A.A. members invited to speak at Internationals be presented with an option to be taped or to decline to be taped. The committee also discussed a request that A.A.W.S. be responsible for taping International Conventions and decided to take no action on this request.

The committee discussed a request for Financial Inducement Guidelines for International Convention Bid Presentations and tabled consideration of Guidelines for discussion closer to site selection for the 2010 International Convention.

We considered 16 final theme suggestions out of 253 proposed themes for the 2000 International Convention and recommended that the theme be "Pass It On — Into the 21st Century." The theme selected will support the objectives of this International Convention: To provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A.; to enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world; to let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee adopted the following policy regarding vendors of goods and services at the 2000 International Convention:

During the 2000 International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous from June 29 to July 2 in Minneapolis only those purveyors of goods and services that are part of or under contract to the convention management will be permitted to operate on any of the facilities or grounds that are assigned or under contract to the convention management.

Don Meurer, A.A.W.S. controller, gave the committee a brief report on the 2000 International Convention budget process. The final budget will be submitted to the committee in January 1999. The General Service Board accepted this committee's recommendation for a celebratory design for the 2000 International Convention logo pending determination that this design does not infringe on any other mark.

We discussed inviting 21 non-A.A. speakers to participate in the 2000 Convention program at A.A.'s expense and will seek approval from the 1998 General Service Conference to continue this custom. It was agreed to include a booth in Minneapolis to provide information about the Birthday Plan.

The committee reviewed and accepted the following broad categories for the 2000 International Convention: Workshops; Panels; Regional Meetings; Topic Meetings; Marathons; Mini-marathons; Special Interest Meetings; Special Needs Meetings, and Special Language Meetings.

The committee discussed the December 5, 1997 Minority Report addressed to the General Service Board regarding financial incentives in 1995 (San Diego) and in 2000 (Minneapolis) and agreed to forward this Minority Report to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

A.A. Regional Forums—Four regions have held Forums since the last Conference: East Central, Northeast, West Central and Southwest. All were lively and well-attended with substantive sharing on important A.A. topics. A Special Forum was held in Alaska

at four sites: Ketchikan, Juneau, Anchorage and Fairbanks. Another Special Forum was held in Val D'Or, Quebec.

The following Forums and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 1999 General Service Conference:

1998		
June 12-14	Western Canada	Winnipeg, Manitoba
July 10-12	Pacific	Sacramento, California
August 15-16	Special Forum	Helena and Miles City, Montana
September 25-27	Eastern Canada	St. John's, Newfoundland
December 4-6	Southeast	Daytona Beach, Florida

The trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums will discuss Regional and Special Forums at the August Board Weekend: usefulness, current format and suggestions for improvement.

Garry McAuley, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Conventions—This assignment involves coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. These Conventions provide a wonderful opportunity for individual A.A. members to serve, celebrate and share sobriety. Very preliminary plans are already underway for the International Convention in 2000 to be held June 29-July 2 in Minneapolis, Minnesota. Preparations and logistics are being studied to plan for three stadium meetings, celebratory dances, and accommodating approximately 250 workshops, panels, regional alkathons, topic meetings and marathons which will require about 1,000 speakers and moderators. Research has started regarding procedures for housing and registration. The advances in computer technology and access to the Internet worldwide will offer opportunities to incorporate the Internet as a communications tool.

In 1997, the International Convention coordinator was responsible for gathering theme suggestions for the 2000 International Convention based on an article requesting suggestions in the April/May 1997 issue of *Box* 4-5-9. The coordinator worked with the convention manager and an outside design firm to present several design choices to the trustees' committee for selection of a logo for the 2000 International Convention. Consistent planning and preparation continues so that the 2000 International Convention, hopefully, will provide the same experience that A.A. members found in past International Conventions — a milestone A.A. event filled with gratitude and the language of the heart in a welcoming, friendly A.A. setting.

Valerie O'Neill

Regional Forums—The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The

responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing a comprehensive report of the Forum to all who attend.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact tailoring each agenda to local needs. One Special Forum is planned for 1998 - August 15-16 in Helena and Miles City, Montana.

The staff member on Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees. Under the present structure the staff member on the Regional Forums assignment is also responsible for Service Material.

Susan Ulseth

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: Following is a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 1997 General Service Conference.

Projects Completed — A section from Warranty Six, in the Twelfth Concept, page 73, of the *A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* was added to the section of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet on page 15 under "What is an A.A. group?" (As a housekeeping note, the text of this section will be bulleted, as outlined in the Advisory Action at the next printing of the pamphlet).

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee — The following recommendations and suggestions were forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee: (1) The video, *Your A.A. General Service Office, The Grapevine, and the General Service Structure*, along with the accompanying service piece; (2) an area request to reinstate the Six Points of an A.A. group to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, and the committee recommended that the pamphlet remain as is; (3) a series of suggested changes in *Living Sober*, for consideration.

Ongoing Projects — **Progress report on a possible Fourth Edition Big Book:** The subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book has had six meetings. The main goal of these meetings, thus far, has been to formulate a *process* to develop a deliberate and responsible procedure for preparation of a possible Fourth Edition Big Book. The subcommittee has used a sharing model to do their work, focusing their round robin discussions on three general topics: (1) to identify stories that may be nominated for possible replacement in the Third Edition; (2) to identify new stories that may be nominated for possible inclusion in a Fourth Edition; (3) to discuss various suggestions related to the publication of a Fourth Edition that had been forwarded to the trustees' Literature Committee by the Fellowship.

The overreaching consideration of the subcommittee is identifying stories that will reach out to the newcomer and that focus on the solution. How it was, how the individual got to A.A., and what it is like now are the basic criteria used in examining stories both

old and new. They are looking for as complete a sharing of experience, strength and hope as possible. The spiritual awakening of each author is considered a vital ingredient in the subcommittee's review of stories. Page 29 of the Big Book and Bill's writings on the subject of developing stories for the First and Second Editions are consistently invoked as guidelines.

Over 200 new stories from A.A. members have been submitted for possible inclusion in a Fourth Edition of the Big Book. The name and address of each author is recorded by a staff assistant who then assigns a number to the story which is then forwarded to the subcommittee members. Every story is carefully read, and then read again. There is also a continual reading of the stories in the Third Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

The subcommittee is conscious of the magnitude of its responsibility to the Fellowship as it moves deliberately ahead to develop this proposed publication. The members of the subcommittee are approaching consensus on certain aspects of the project; however, it is very important to emphasize that no decisions of any kind have been made. In a unanimous resolution, the trustees' Literature Committee moved that members of its committee not submit their stories for possible inclusion in the Fourth Edition of the Big Book.

A subcommittee was formed to develop a book of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions; however, it has not as yet begun its work as decisions related to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, have not as yet been made.

Additional trustee's Literature Committee Considerations — (1) The committee discussed a request that the next printing of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be changed to include the *Twelve Concepts for World Service*. The committee concluded that, in addition to the estimated high cost of revising all the various formats and translations of this item, such an inclusion would lessen the value of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* as a recovery piece. Also, from an historical perspective, it was noted that, during his lifetime, Bill W. never suggested that this material be combined. (2) A concern was discussed that the Concepts Checklist was being used as a vehicle to promote "subscriptions to Box 4-5-9 and the Grapevine by stating, Does my home group subscribe to Box 4-5-9? The Grapevine? Do I?" The committee concluded that the questions in the Concepts Checklist have more to do with communication and information than promotion. (3) Considered a request to develop a pamphlet entitled: "A.A. is Not A Religion," and noted that the 1996 Conference Committee considered this request in their deliberations and made *no recommendation*. In the absence of any similar requests, the trustees' Literature Committee concluded that the "no recommendation" stance of the 1996 Conference Committee stood. (4) A request that the Traditions Play be submitted for Conference approval was discussed, and the committee noted that Conference approval of this play would inhibit a local area from tailoring this piece to its own needs and situations. (5) Considered an area request to produce a pamphlet, "The Twelve Step Call: A Brief Guide," and felt that this subject was well covered in Chapter 7 "Working with Others," of *Alcoholics Anonymous*. (6) Considered adding some information to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet on A.A.'s position regarding religion and on prescribed medication, and concluded that the subject matter had nothing to do with the functioning, formatting or organization of an A.A. group. The committee also expressed concern about overwriting the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group." (7) A request was made to develop a group-oriented Traditions Check List, and the committee requested that the writer be asked to submit a preliminary piece for consideration. (8) An area request to remove Dr. Bob's story ("Dr. Bob's Nightmare") from the story section and add it to the Fourth Edition as an

additional chapter to the current main text of 164 pages, of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, increasing the number of chapters from 11 to 12, was referred to the Subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book. (9) Discussed developing a service piece on identification at A.A. meetings and declined to take any action on this matter. (10) Discussed a proposal for an A.A. history book, and declined to take any action on this matter. (11) Discussed whether "Suggestions For Leading a Beginners Meeting" was "Conference-approved." Research indicated that this piece of literature was listed as "Conference-approved" in 1971, and there was a 1966 Conference Action to prepare the guide and place it on the order form. A memo was forwarded to the Publications Department requesting that, at the next printing, the words "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature" be reinstated. (12) A suggestion that consideration be given to the concept of downsizing some of A.A.'s literature or withdrawing approval of some literature was discussed and the member's concerns were noted; this correspondence will be kept on file for consideration as literature comes up for review and reprinting. (13) Discussed a request for a separate book for women and took no action. The writer's concerns will be addressed in preparation for the choice of stories for the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and the letter will be added to the material which will be part of the background used in the decision-making process by the Subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book.

The trustees' Literature Committee has had a full agenda throughout the year. The members of this committee and its various subcommittees have worked diligently and with focused consideration on each item submitted for their attention. Some committee members will be rotating on, and the stewardship of this important committee will have new minds and new spirits to help guide it. Others will remain to bring continuity and a depth of experience to share with these new members. All of the efforts of this committee are to serve the Fellowship and assist in keeping the doors of A.A. wide open for all who might seek out our message of hope.

Julian Rhinehart, chairman

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the literature desk serves as editor of Box 4-5-9 published in English, French and Spanish. Work is ongoing all year for ideas for Box 4-5-9 articles, and the calendar of events is kept up to date daily. The staff member works closely with the editor of the Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. through Box 4-5-9.

Doug Richardson

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are about 327 Loners in 85 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s, known as Internationalists, number about 110 with an additional 44 Port Contacts. Eight Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 180 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober by reading A.A. literature and by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer or Internationalist. Each also receives a directory of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists, complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting-By-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly meeting-in-print which shares excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members. To share group activities and personal experience with the Loners, Homers and Internationalists are Loner Sponsors — A.A.s who do attend meetings regularly. There are over 652 Loner Sponsors.

A.A.'s message of hope continues to be carried around the world through traveling A.A. members, through our literature, and now through e-mail.

Internationalist Anthony N. writes: "I received a package from G.S.O. a couple of days ago and a tremor of excitement ran through me. This was a moment where I can only describe as 'being alive.' This package came at an appropriate time also. I've been out to sea for two weeks now and the writing of this letter and finding sober people to talk to has not been easy. There are at least three other sober men on board. I have had the opportunity to talk with two of them. I just shared the information in this package with one of them a few moments ago. I discovered with that sharing that we will be able to help each other out. Even though I have less sobriety time than him, I have been overseas before (some of the best drunk memories I have). This time, we go sober, together. My goal is to get a letter or phone call out to the ports we know we're visiting next summer. You see, I deploy on a six-month Westpac next May. I am grateful for what we have in A.A. I never realized how many Loners, Internationalists and Homers were out there. I definitely feel that I am a part of something bigger than me."

Since January 1997, we have received sharing from Ghana, India, Australia, Chile, Germany, Greece, Angola, Nepal, Philippines, Senegal, Finland, Kenya, Indonesia, Thailand, Ethiopia, Tanzania and Japan. "I just want to say thank you to all you impressive LIMs. I don't have words to express my admiration for your moral effort and, above all, your excellent Meeting-by-Mail." So shares Loner Gulelat T. from Dire-Dawa, Ethiopia. "I am a Loner and letters are the main source of my meetings. I thank you for your constant help with LIM that keeps me on the path of recovery. And I thank you for your valuable service and the interest you have taken in me."

Much gratitude goes to Loner Sponsors who share regularly. From Dublin, Ireland, Loner Sponsor Paul M. reminds us: "Another day, another year in sobriety, one day at a time. God does not ask much of us, but that we be mindful of our brothers and sisters. We tend to think only of ourselves a lot of the time. Last November 11, I heard 'Lest We Forget' everywhere I went. Yes, lest we forget those men and women who fought in the two World Wars for our freedom and peace. Then, there are our older A.A. members who carried the A.A. message to us. Now old and infirm, perhaps they are housebound due to illness or some physical incapacity and unable to attend that regular A.A. meeting. And I say, 'Lest We Forget Them.' Where would you

and I be today? Think a moment, these oldtimers are our life-savers. They carried the message to us and we found a new life. They heard, they listened and they passed it on. From *As Bill Sees It*, page 29, 'Gratitude should go forward rather than backward.' In other words, if you carry the message to still others, you will be making the best possible repayment for the help given you. To all our older members at home or in hospitals throughout the world today, thank you and may God bless you all."

It is a privilege to work on the LIM assignment and to coordinate support and service to so many A.A. members who show courage and commitment to Alcoholics Anonymous under difficult circumstances on a daily basis.

Valerie O'Neill

NOMINATING

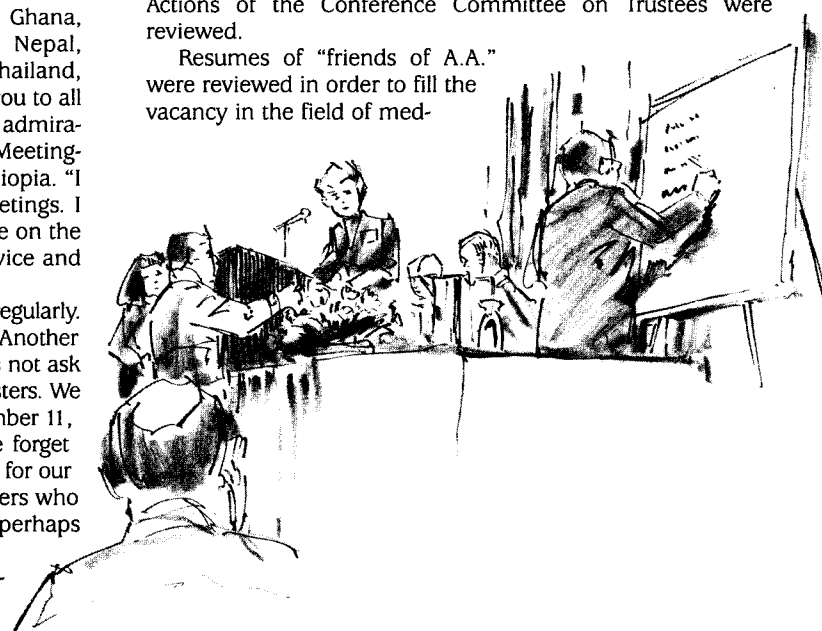
Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and revised the Composition to read, "The chairperson appoints or asks the committee to elect a trustee member as vice chairperson," replacing, "At the July meeting, the committee will elect a trustee member to serve as vice chairperson."

- The revised Nominating Committee Procedures, of the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, were reviewed and approved by the General Service Board. The second paragraph of Nominating Procedure #8 ("Procedures for Hiring New General Service Staff Members") was modified to read as follows: "A letter is sent out to all current Conference members, and an article is placed in *Box 4-5-9*, when time permits, announcing the opening and briefly describing the necessary skills for the job."

The committee discussed a suggestion to include information about the additional duties required of the Eastern Canada regional trustee in the May letter from the secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee to area delegates and area committee officers in Eastern Canada when an Eastern Canada regional trustee is to be elected. It was the consensus that it be noted that the Eastern Canada regional trustee is asked to serve on the French Publications board and the board of *La Vigne*, in addition to their regular responsibilities.

The 1998 calendar of events was accepted, a budget was forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee, and the Advisory Actions of the Conference Committee on Trustees were reviewed.

Resumes of "friends of A.A." were reviewed in order to fill the vacancy in the field of med-



icine that will occur with Dr. John N. Chappel's rotation in 1998. The committee noticed the total absence of women on the list of M.D. candidates and expressed overall concern that, as a Fellowship, we needed to be mindful of attracting women and people of color to serve the Fellowship when vacancies occur. With that in mind, the committee recommended that, when vacancy announcement letters are sent to the Fellowship, there be a note ("N.B.") at the bottom of each letter stating: "At its August 1997 meeting, the trustees' Nominating Committee expressed overall concern that, as a Fellowship, we need to be mindful of attracting women and people of color to serve the Fellowship when any vacancies occur, recognizing that diversity is a key factor in the unity of the Fellowship."

Four "friends of A.A." were interviewed during the January/February 1998 board weekend and the committee recommended to the General Service Board that George E. Vaillant, M.D., serve as a Class A trustee, following the 1998 General Service Conference.

The committee discussed inviting "friends of A.A." to serve as appointed committee members of trustees' committees. The discussion led to much broader sharing on the role of appointed committee members, including the future needs of trustees' committees that have appointed committee members (Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information, Treatment Facilities, and Literature). Also considered was the realization that it was of utmost importance to seek more detailed information directly from the committees on which appointed committee members serve before addressing the original topic regarding "friends of A.A." serving as appointed committee members.

The trustees' Nominating Committee developed a questionnaire pertaining to the role of appointed committee members, which was sent to the trustees' committees concerned, and the questionnaire results will be returned to the Nominating Committee for further discussion. The staff secretary researched Conference Advisory Actions pertaining to appointed committee members and submitted a written report on the history of appointed committee members to the trustees' Nominating Committee. The committee tabled discussion of the role of the appointed committee member on trustees' committees until the August 1998 meeting.

The committee recommended approval of Calvin L. James to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Board*: Jack L. Ostrem, East Central regional trustee, replacing MaryJane Roy; Jacqueline Johnston to serve as general service trustee, replacing interim trustee director Michel Girard who is currently filling this position; Ronald J. Gauthier and Jan Polek to serve as nontrustee directors, replacing Jacqueline Johnston and Gerard Ouellette. *A.A. Grapevine Board*: Betty Stevens, Southeast regional trustee, replacing Raul A. Marin.

The proposed slates of General Service board members, officers of the Board, A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 1998 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1998 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Only in New York

Ken Knowles ran into two people from his home town, Kodiak, Alaska, at the top of the Empire State Building.

Class A

Linda L. Chezern	Robert O. Miller, D.D.
Gary A. Glynn	Peter Roach
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Arthur L. Knight, Jr.	

Class B

Carl Budd	Tom Maguire
Jim Clough	Jack L. Ostrem
Chuck Crist	Dean Rinehart
Michel Girard	Richard Roughton
Marne Hill	MaryJane Roy
Jacqueline Johnston	Betty Stevens
Garry McAuley	

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board to be presented to the 1998 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Gary A. Glynn
<i>First Vice-Chairperson</i>	Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
<i>Second Vice-Chairperson</i>	Peter Roach
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
<i>Secretary</i>	MaryJane Roy
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Lois Fisher

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1998 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

George Dorsey	Garry McAuley
Lois Fisher	Jack L. Ostrem
Ronald J. Gauthier	Jan Polek
Jacqueline Johnston	Richard Roughton
John C. Koster	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1998 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Carl Budd	Betty Stevens
Chuck Crist	Ray Stiver
David V. Every	Ames Sweet
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	Gregory Tobin
Tom Maguire	

In response to a discussion by the General Service Board with regard to the future growth of the Conference, the trustees' Nominating Committee recommended that: a) After January 1, 1999, requests for new delegate areas be evaluated on an individual basis, taking into consideration conditions within both the requesting area and Alcoholics Anonymous (U.S./Canada); b) the possible need for regional realignment be evaluated by following the existing "Suggested Guidelines for Changing Regional Boundaries" and that regional trustees should work together as a group to further discuss the process.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.,
chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films

about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the A.A. Membership Survey; carrying A.A.'s message through electronic media as well as public media.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Much of the work of this committee was done through a sub-committee and the Public Information staff coordinator in the office. Following is a list of work over the past year:

- A follow-up to the 1997 Conference recommendation, the A.A. Membership Survey pamphlet and one-way Membership Survey display were updated to reflect the findings from the 1996 A.A. Membership Survey. The committee also noted the editorial change to the words "Composition of Members" to "Composition of Membership" to be made in future A.A. Membership Survey pamphlets.
- A production company was selected to produce a minimum of three television Public Service Announcements emphasizing membership of young people, membership of minorities and generic A.A. information as recommended by the 1997 Conference. The committee met three times with the producer and discussed at length concepts of P.S.A.s, reviewed the storyboards and rough cuts of three proposed P.S.A.s, in addition to a fourth P.S.A.
- An extensive study was conducted and a report was prepared on updating, where necessary, all television and radio Public Service Announcements including consideration of cultural references, availability in French and Spanish, as well as researching formats compatible with current technology.
- Following the 1997 Conference recommendation, the Public Information Kit and Workbook have been designated service material rather than "A.A. Conference-approved literature." A list of Contents was added to the Public Information Kit as suggested by the Conference P.I. Committee.
- Reviewed and approved the annual media Anonymity Letter to be mailed to media professionals in February 1998.
- Discussed anonymity breaks on the internet and agreed that these would be handled using the same procedure as anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio and film by forwarding anonymity-break information to the appropriate area delegate if the area is identified.
- Reviewed P.I. expenses for 1996 and 1997 and the proposed 1998 budget of \$33,834 was forwarded to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The following items have been referred for consideration to the 1998 Conference P.I. Committee:

- Approval of the 1998 Membership Survey to be conducted by area on a random basis, as was done in the 1996 Membership Survey.
- Review of report on updating, where necessary, all television and radio P.S.A.s including cultural references, availability in French and Spanish, as well as formats compatible with current technology.
- Review and approval of four proposed television Public Service Announcements.
- Consider request to eliminate question #4 on race from the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire with the committee's recommendation that the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire remain as was approved by the 1997 General Service Conference.

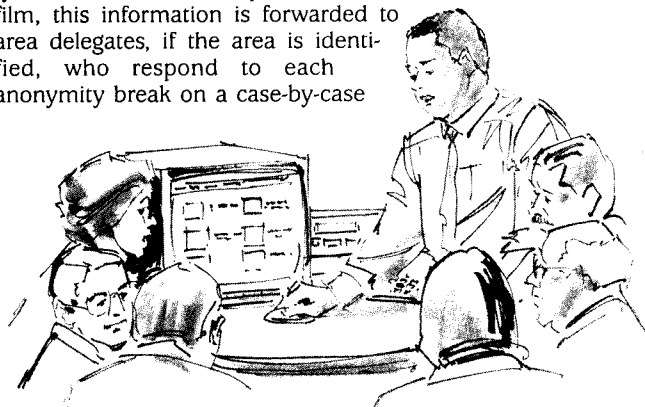
Jack Ostrem, vice-chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message of recovery from alcoholism to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, schools and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site on the Internet. Throughout the year the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. It is an essential part of Public Information work here at G.S.O. to be a resource for the collected A.A. experience and sharing of Public Information committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. Three or four times a year, the staff member communicates with approximately 500 P.I. committee chairpeople at the area, district, intergroup/central office and group level. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do, and providing accurate information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous. This past year the P.I. staff person participated on two radio shows to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous: CBS — WQYK in Clearwater, Florida, for a one and a half hour call-in talk show; and discussed A.A.'s June 10th Anniversary on FMQ 90, Green Bay, Wisconsin.

All new Public Information chairpeople are sent a "welcome" letter and receive the A.A. Guidelines on Public Information; P.I. Discount Package list; Box 4-5-9, as well as current P.I. information. They also receive the Public Information Kit. The current "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display, reflecting the findings from the 1996 Membership Survey, are also made available to P.I. committees. To further provide "shared experience" the A.A. Guidelines on Public Information have been updated and include three new sections: P.I. Committee Sharing, Informing the Fellowship, and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. The service piece "Suggestions for Working with Your Local Television and Radio Stations to Help Carry the Message," to encourage and help committees set up P.S.A. contacts at local TV and radio stations, in addition to the P.S.A. scripts and a video cassette (suitable for home VCRs) containing all our P.S.A.s, are also made available to P.I. committees who are interested in distributing radio and TV P.S.A.s as part of their P.I. Twelfth Step service work.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of local health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide A.A. literature for these events. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with local P.I. committees, so that there can be a local group conscience decision about how A.A. can best participate in these events and to establish communication between the community event organizers and the local A.A. committees.

When the P.I. desk receives information regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio or film, this information is forwarded to area delegates, if the area is identified, who respond to each anonymity break on a case-by-case



basis. In the past twelve months, approximately 55 articles were forwarded to area delegates. Anonymity breaks on the Internet are handled in the same manner. In January, all new Conference delegates were sent a letter explaining our procedures for forwarding anonymity break information to local delegates.

The annual media Anonymity Letter, with a return postcard for those who wish additional information, was mailed in February as follows (categories include mailing to both the U.S. and Canada): daily newspapers, 1,641; weekly newspapers with circulation of 7,000 +, 4,186; AM and FM radio stations broadcasting at 5kws in top 20 markets, 660; TV stations (all new stations, networks and cable) and all wire services, 758; all black publications, 238; all Hispanic publications, 181; the total mailing was 7,664.

We responded to requests from newspaper, magazine and TV professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism and referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to the appropriate source. We also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on any controversial issues in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. Alcoholics Anonymous is unique in that Public Information often succeeds when we do *not* get media attention.

Eva Sanchez

SERVICE MATERIAL

Staff report: To assist groups, G.S.O. provides service material to the Fellowship, based on an indicated need, to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items in detail. Examples of service material include: Regional Forum Reports; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; Special Needs items, such as information about A.A. literature in Braille and audio cassettes and special literature for deaf alcoholics.

Current ongoing projects involving Service Material:

- Involved with coordination and production of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member on Service Material/Regional Forums works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.
- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, and G.S.R. Kits.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in San Mateo, California, October 9-11, 1998.
- Liaison with special needs committees working to make A.A. more accessible to all alcoholics.

Susan Ulseth

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Throughout the years, G.S.O. has provided services in several languages, including Spanish. But it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated. In our general service structure there are more than 40,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members. They meet in 1,500 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff person, who does not rotate, coordinates and interfaces with the rest of the

staff assignments and assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All these groups that register with the G.S.O. in New York receive the Group Handbook, and every G.S.R. its corresponding kit in Spanish. D.C.M.s also receive their service kit in Spanish, and each group receives a copy of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure, and continue to grow. Many service pieces are now available in Spanish, among them the General Service Board's *Quarterly Report*, with highlights of its activities, as well as the A.A.W.S. monthly report.

The Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish is immediately available upon completion of our Conference, and a list of preliminary and final Conference Agenda items is distributed in Spanish to all delegates and alternate delegates.

The staff member on this assignment works closely with the two in-house translators, assisting, developing, updating and revising literature, pamphlets, and so on. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. All correspondence in Spanish from U.S.A./Canada comes to the Spanish Services desk and the Spanish Services coordinator also helps answer correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments, especially by the International desk. The Spanish Services staff member may attend regional meetings, such as the Meeting of the Americas, World Service Meetings, Regional Forums, and many other activities in the Spanish-speaking world of A.A.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Ten staff members, who rotate assignments every two years, provide services to A.A. groups and members. In addition to the responsibility of a functional assignment, such as Public Information or coordinating the General Service Conference, the staff communicates with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, as well as with A.A.s in other countries. Communication is in the form of letters, telephone calls, faxes and, in recent years, electronic mail. In 1997, G.S.O. staff received approximately 18,000 pieces of mail. The staff works as a team in two units to ensure that all staff assignments are adequately covered when someone is away from the office or involved with a project that requires extra time. Unit A consists of Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities/Loners, and Literature. Unit B includes the coordinators of the General Service Conference, Regional Forums/Service Material, Spanish Services, the staff member who serves A.A. internationally and coordinates the World Service Meeting, and the Staff Coordinator. Weekly staff meetings are chaired by the staff coordinator. Discussion centers on problems that require direction from the group conscience as well as additional and improved ways of providing service to A.A. groups and members. The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, and workshops, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. During 1997, staff members attended a total of 99 assemblies, Regional Forums, conventions, workshops and round-ups in the U.S. and Canada. These weekend events provide an opportunity to communicate about G.S.O. services, to meet A.A.s throughout the U.S. and Canada, and to receive information

that may be shared with other groups. In addition, the staff member on the International assignment and the Spanish Services coordinator participated in A.A. events in a total of 13 countries. In 1997, one staff member accepted an early retirement offer which created a vacancy. A letter was sent to trustees, directors and delegates announcing the vacancy and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information was also posted in Box 4-5-9. A G.S.O. staff member must have a minimum of six years of sobriety. Business experience, communication skills, and A.A. service experience are among the criteria used in the selection process. Several hundred applications on file, and an additional 40 received in response to the current vacancy, were reviewed prior to filling the vacancy. The staff coordinator is responsible for training new staff members.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials and preparing the minutes of the General Service Board meetings. She also serves as secretary of the board's Sharing Session and as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, a summary of the boards' activities.

The staff coordinator serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and is a voting member of the General Service Conference. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is also a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

In the past year, almost 1,300 visitors from around the world came to G.S.O. Each had the opportunity to tour the General Service and Grapevine offices and to learn about the services to the Fellowship. Visiting members and guests are welcome at the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays.

Lois Fisher

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities is to "...further the acceptance of A.A. in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, and similar facilities, and to bring additional help to alcoholics under treatment there." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S124.) Consequently, the way in which the A.A. message is finally heard by alcoholics in treatment facilities is a matter of concern, attention and development by the committee.

Since the 1997 General Service Conference, our committee has met three times. At the July meeting, the new soft-cover Treatment Facilities Handbook and the updated Treatment Facilities Workbook were circulated. We discussed and reviewed the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap," and decided that minor changes be left to the discretion of staff and publications.

The committee reviewed 1997 and 1998 G.S.O. A.A. Web Site activity reports, noting the inclusion of the number of e-mail response forms received from professionals, and approved, with minor changes, the message to professionals which appears in the Web Site.

The committee also discussed the importance of Bridging the Gap between treatment and A.A. through A.A. members serving as temporary contacts. An information packet consisting of the trustees' Treatment Facilities Subcommittee Report on "The Changing Landscape of Treatment Facilities," summary results of the 1996 Questionnaire and the June 1997 Grapevine was mailed to Treatment Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap chairpersons in September 1997.

The final draft of the Annual Letter to Treatment Facilities Professionals was approved to be mailed with an information sheet and the 1996 Membership Survey pamphlet to treatment facilities administrators in U.S./Canada. A copy of this letter was

mailed to over 300 Treatment Facility committee chairpeople in November 1997. Also in November, a questionnaire regarding experience with carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals was sent to 350 Treatment Facilities/Hospitals and Institutions and Bridge the Gap committee chairpeople. We received 25 responses from 21 areas. The committee discussed the responses and agreed to forward a summary of these responses to the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee to consider adding sharing about this experience to the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

Local Treatment Facilities Committees are now carrying meetings into other noncorrectional institutional environments, e.g., shelters, nursing homes, hospices, half-way houses and not just limiting their scope to "treatment facilities." The trustees' committee continues to provide support for this special Twelfth Step service.

Peter Roach, chairperson

Staff report: The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to provide service material to assist the service work of local A.A. members who wish to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics in treatment. We now have about 92 area Treatment Facilities chairpersons, 183 district Treatment Facilities chairpersons, and 73 "Other" Treatment Facilities chairpersons. We try to keep an up-to-date list of the chairs of these committees and to provide them with considerable information and literature. In order to carry the message "inside," the A.A. member often meets with the administrators and personnel in many different kinds of treatment settings. He or she must become familiar with the rules and regulations of the facility and be willing to comply with them. As an oldtimer once said, "If we can't get in, we can't carry the message!" The local A.A. member also offers to provide information about A.A. groups in the patient's hometown and encourages active participation upon leaving the facility. This is called "bridging the gap" or A.A. Temporary Contact. If a treatment center wants A.A. and Temporary Contact information, the presenter makes clear the purpose of A.A. The video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" is often shown to treatment center staff as well as to patients and continues to be a useful tool. Helping a newcomer just out of treatment get settled into a regular home group is the essence of Twelfth Step work.

The Treatment Facilities Workbook is a comprehensive guide about carrying the message "inside." It contains shared experience, suggestions, general information, A.A. Guidelines and literature. Treatment Facilities chairpersons receive Box 4-5-9, *About A.A.* and a list of the 92 chairs in the U.S. and Canada in order to share current treatment facilities experience. All chairs have copies of the U.S./Canada Directory of intergroups and central offices for referral purposes.

Inquiries come to the Treatment Facilities desk via letter, telephone, fax and e-mail, from three sources: (1) newly sober alcoholics in treatment facilities, (2) local A.A.s who have become or are interested in becoming active on treatment facilities committees, and (3) treatment facilities administrators or personnel requesting information about A.A. and assistance in setting up meetings. Much information and treatment facilities sharing is provided by area treatment facilities committees' meeting minutes and reports sent to G.S.O.

In addition, another major staff activity entails serving as secretary to both trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities. The staff member also gathers material for occasional treatment facilities articles in Box 4-5-9.

Valerie O'Neill

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The twelve-month span of time since the 47th General Service Conference has been an active and challenging one for the A.A. Grapevine Board and staff. One new nontrustee director came aboard, our Spanish magazine La Viña passed its first birthday, a new Conference-approved pamphlet about the Grapevine was published by A.A.W.S., we hired a new circulation director, and our controller/business administrator took an early retirement. In addition, due to the condition of his health, Raul Marin decided not to serve as chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and Chuck Crist was elected to serve an additional one-year term as chairperson in his place. On the technological front, after a long period of planning, the Grapevine established a presence on the Internet with our new Grapevine Web Site (<http://www.aagrapevine.org>) which is linked to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site and provides basic information about the Grapevine magazine and the Grapevine operation. On the service front, a number of Grapevine board and staff members have participated in A.A. events throughout the Fellowship in both English and Spanish and have conducted some brainstorming sessions at service meetings to better understand how we can most effectively address the needs of the Fellowship.

Finance — Year-End Results: For the year ended December 31, 1997 the Grapevine showed a combined loss on operations of \$184,700, made up of an \$82,560 loss for the Grapevine and a \$102,140 loss for La Viña. The Grapevine loss on operations was \$22,300 higher than budgeted, but included unanticipated one-time costs of over \$110,000 related to the early retirement of Grapevine personnel and professional fees related to other unanticipated personnel matters. La Viña ended the year \$17,320 ahead of budget. Combined, the overall loss on operations was over budget by \$4,980 but showed an improvement of \$141,810 from the actual combined loss incurred in 1996.

1998 Budget: In January, the board approved and forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee a budget for 1998 which anticipates a loss of \$10,170. The budget was based on annual circulation for the Grapevine of 122,000 and takes into account the full effects on magazine income of the 1996 subscription price increase and the publication of two new related items in 1998 (*Best of the Grapevine, Volume 3* and a set of cassette tapes on the topic of Young People and Oldtimers in AA).

For La Viña, based on circulation of 9,500, a loss of \$78,352 is anticipated for 1998. This is \$23,782 better than the actual loss incurred in 1997.

Revised La Viña Business Plan and Three-Year Projections: Throughout the past year, the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee have been evaluating the progress of La Viña and monitoring the financial realities facing this new endeavor. In July, the board reviewed an updated business plan for La Viña, prepared by management, and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance Committee. This plan outlined what steps

had been taken through La Viña's first year, assessed La Viña's current position, and projected key elements which would be necessary for the magazine to continue growing. In addition, in October, the board reviewed a series of three-year financial projections for La Viña, and after a detailed analysis of nine different scenarios forwarded the "most likely" set of projections to the trustees' Finance Committee. Both the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee recognized that the projected three-year losses were significant and that the Grapevine Board and staff would have to continue their efforts to bring these losses down. The La Viña budget for 1998 showed real movement in this direction, bringing the budgeted loss down ahead of schedule to the level originally projected for the year 2000. Based on this development, the board will revisit the three-year projections and revise them accordingly for presentation to the trustees' Finance Committee in July 1998.

Overall, from an editorial standpoint, La Viña has been well-received throughout the United States and Canada and around the world, yet we need to continue getting the word out about La Viña and emphasizing the need for support of the magazine by the Spanish-speaking A.A. community.

Restructuring of Circulation Department: In June, based on a recommendation from the Grapevine's ad hoc Circulation Task Force, management provided the board with a plan for restructuring the circulation department. Central to this plan was the hiring of a circulation director, whose primary focus would be the administration of all circulation programs and development of ongoing plans to increase readership and enhance service to existing subscribers. After a Fellowship-wide search, Mary Pat Hester was hired in December and began working at the Grapevine three days a week. She has extensive professional experience in the field of circulation management and, as a former D.C.M., has a good understanding of the A.A. service structure. She is responsible for all matters relating to Grapevine and La Viña circulation, and has oversight responsibility for the GvR network. A secondary position of circulation coordinator was also created, and this was filled by Jeff Monasch, a nonalcoholic employee who was promoted from the position of customer service clerk.

Update on 1997 Conference Actions: In June and July, in response to the 1997 Advisory Action that "the Grapevine use mailing lists to provide introductory information about the Grapevine and La Viña to correctional facilities and treatment facilities," a series of special mailings were put together by the Grapevine staff. Over this two-month period, 8,250 correctional facilities were contacted with an informational letter and a return card to use if they wanted to see a sample copy of either magazine. Of these contacts, nearly six percent requested a

sample copy of either Grapevine or La

Viña, and additional subscription infor-

mation was sent at that time. On the

treatment facilities side, of the 9,500

facilities contacted, we had a ten

percent response rate. So far, this

effort has not had a major impact

on circulation, though from the

perspective of increased aware-

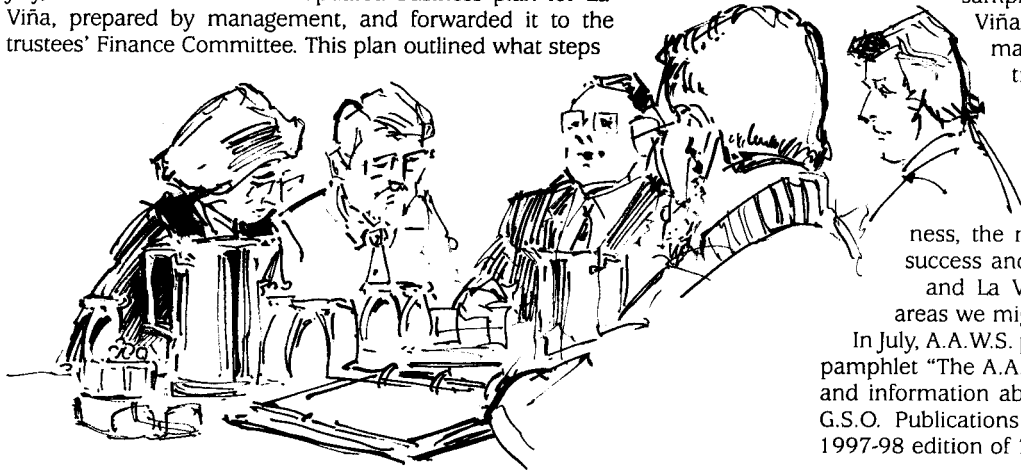
ness, the mailings have been a considerable

success and information about the Grapevine

and La Viña has now been extended into

areas we might not have been reaching before.

In July, A.A.W.S. published the Conference-approved pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print," and information about La Viña was forwarded to the G.S.O. Publications Department for inclusion in the 1997-98 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*.



Editorial: Over the last year, the Grapevine has focused on a number of different issues, among them: A.A. in Prison, A.A. in Treatment Facilities, a report on Alaska's 50th Birthday, A.A. and Minorities, Working with Wet Drunks, the Twelve Traditions (a year-long series), a report on the 40th International Convention of Young People in A.A., and a feature called "My Best Day Sober." Also, in the July 1997 issue, which was devoted to A.A. in Prison, we included an informational flyer prepared by G.S.O. on the Corrections Correspondence Service.

Best of the Grapevine, Volume 3 and New Tapes: Following the suggestion of the 1996 Conference Grapevine Committee, the board approved publication of a third volume of *Best of the Grapevine*, and with the help of the Editorial Advisory Board, Grapevine staff began putting the book together toward the end of the summer. The book will contain over 65 articles selected from the last ten years of magazine publication and will be divided up into ten different segments. The set of audio cassettes also suggested by the 1996 Conference Grapevine Committee on the topic of Young People and OldTimers in A.A. should be available sometime around mid-year.

Overseas Publishing Requests: In June, the board granted permission to the General Service Office of Colombia to reprint and distribute *El Lenguaje del Corazón*, and in order to facilitate this effort we provided our translation to them on computer disks. The book was published early in 1998 and the Colombians are appreciative of our help in making the works of Bill W. available. In addition, the General Service Office in Japan has received permission to translate and distribute the Traditions Checklist and are currently translating the booklet, *Best of Bill*. G.S.O. Poland has been given permission to distribute their translation of the A.A. Preamble and has also asked permission to translate *The Language of the Heart*, *Best of the Grapevine*, and selected magazine articles. G.S.O. Sweden has also requested permission to translate *The Language of the Heart* and will send sample chapters for our review as the translation progresses.

Canadian Circulation: In January 1997, recognizing a gradual fall-off of Grapevine circulation in Canada, the board asked Eastern Canada regional trustee Bill Bungay to serve as a special advisor to the Grapevine Board regarding magazine circulation in Canada. Bill attended a number of board meetings and contacted A.A. members throughout the service structure in Canada. In October he gave a report to the board which highlighted the problems of magazine pricing for Canadian subscribers, the relatively low involvement level of GvRs in Canadian groups, and the need for more articles from Canadian A.A. members. It was his sense that though it might take time to reverse the declining trend of subscriptions in Canada, if we continue talking about it and working together it can be done.

French Publications: In December, in concert with A.A.W.S., the Grapevine issued a notice of cancellation to the board of the French Publications Service for the three Grapevine books they were publishing in French: *The Language of the Heart*, *The Home Group*, and *Best of Bill*. This notice was to be effective April 1, 1998; however, as a result of ongoing discussions with the board, the effective date of cancellation of the license to produce and distribute these works was extended to May 1, 1998.

Office Space: As noted in the report of the 1996 Ad Hoc Site-Review Committee, which was presented to the 1997 General Service Conference, plans have begun for reconfiguration of office space at G.S.O. and the Grapevine, and the executive editor has consulted with the architect engaged by the General Service Board regarding how the Grapevine might best utilize its current space. While some construction may be necessary, it is hoped that such reconfiguration will fit with Grapevine's current needs and also allow for future growth.

Service Activity: The Grapevine has participated in six Regional Forums in the last year: a Pacific Region Special Forum in Alaska; the East Central Forum in Moline, Illinois; the Northeast Forum in Tarrytown, New York; an Eastern Canada Special Forum in Val D'or, Quebec; the West Central Forum in St. Paul, Minnesota; and the Southwest Forum in Houston, Texas. The Grapevine also participated in the 12th Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar in Columbus, Ohio, along with representatives from the General Service Office and A.A.W.S. In addition, Jaime Manrique, the editor of Spanish Resources, participated in the 25th Hispanic Convention held in Boston, Massachusetts; Cynthia Keyworth, senior editor, and Ken Chaya, art director, attended the 40th ICY-PAA in Colorado; Ames Sweet, executive editor, and Mara Hennessey, executive secretary, traveled to Montreal to meet with members of the board of our French counterpart *La Vigne* to discuss matters of common concern; circulation director, Mary Pat Hester, participated at both NERAASA and PRAASA, and led roundtable discussions about the Grapevine.

Other Board Business: At the April meeting, the board requested a transfer of \$42,300 from the General Service Board Reserve Fund to the Grapevine operating account to cover expended losses incurred for *La Viña* in 1996; that the \$81,000 interest earned but not yet received for 1996 be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund as a partial investment increase to fund the unfulfilled subscription liability; and that additional cash from the operating account in the amount of \$26,000 be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund to bring funding of the unfulfilled subscription liability to an appropriate level.

The board also reviewed information about the new office insurance plan negotiated by G.S.O. and Grapevine management which went into effect on July 1; approved an amendment to the Grapevine retirement plan; approved the "General Service Office/Grapevine Severance Plan" document; granted permission on an experimental basis to an area in the East Central region to reproduce on audiocassette tape selections from the Grapevine on a monthly basis for distribution by the special needs committee; made an early retirement offer to the Grapevine controller/business administrator; cut the price of *El Lenguaje del Corazón* to \$6.00 in order to reduce excessive inventory; reviewed a number of requests for Grapevine materials in other formats; discussed the possibility of establishing standing board subcommittees; conducted a conference call with the members of the 1998 Grapevine Conference Committee in order to facilitate the flow of communication between the committee and the board; had a joint meeting with the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board to discuss matters of mutual concern; and invited members from *Plenitud*, our Mexican counterpart, to attend the July 1998 board meeting as observers.

Chuck Crist, chairperson

Staff report: In June 1997, the A.A. Grapevine celebrated 53 years of continuous publication. The magazine's primary mission is to publish a magazine that shares the experience, strength, and hope of a wide variety of individual A.A. members in the U.S. and Canada and around the world, and expresses current thinking in the Fellowship on matters affecting recovery, unity, and service. In addition, the Grapevine publishes anthologies and audio cassette tapes based directly on the magazine. The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is an autonomous corporation whose executive editor has oversight responsibility as chief executive and reports directly to the Grapevine Corporate Board. A nonalcoholic controller/business administrator manages financial and accounting functions. There

are four major areas of operations: editorial, circulation, accounting/bookkeeping, and shipping.

The editorial department, managed by the executive editor, consists of a senior editor, Spanish resources editor, executive secretary, and an editorial assistant. The department produces the monthly Grapevine magazine, the bimonthly Spanish-language magazine *La Viña*, all related materials (anthologies, audio cassette tapes, etc.), flyers and order forms, and related GvR materials, pamphlets and workbooks about the Grapevine, and the annual wall calendar and pocket planner. Virtually all materials are designed in-house, using the Grapevine's desktop publishing capability. The department also answers all editorial queries and processes several hundred manuscript submissions every month. The year 1998 will see the publication of *Best of the Grapevine III* and the production of a set of audio cassette tapes, "Youth Enjoying Sobriety" and "Old-Timers Corner."

The bookkeeping department opens and distributes all incoming mail. Manuscripts, letters to the editor, calendar of events items, reprint requests, and matters requiring the editors' attention go to the editorial department. Both cash and credit card orders, for subscriptions and related materials, are sorted into categories for processing. The administrative unit of bookkeeping maintains employee payroll and administers employee benefit programs. The controller, as part of this unit, is responsible for the safeguarding of all corporate assets. He maintains control over all books of accounts, prepares statements of financial operations, and prepares the annual budgets.

The shipping department arranges for inventory transfers to and from warehouse distribution centers in Kansas City, Kansas, and Oakville, Ontario, Canada. It also ships and packs smaller orders of books, tapes, magazines, and other materials from the office, including complimentary materials to GvRs.

In 1997, the Grapevine's circulation department was restructured and a new position, that of circulation director, was created; this was filled in December by Mary Pat Hester, who has a strong publishing background and extensive experience in circulation and subscription management. The job of the circulation director is to improve services to our subscribers, to make the GvR network more effective, and to increase circulation in ways consistent with the Traditions and with the goal of carrying the A.A. message. Specifically, Mary Pat will develop and implement ongoing plans for increasing magazine circulation; manage all subscriber data and administer all circulation programs for the Grapevine and *La Viña*; ensure timely delivery of magazines; oversee the GvR network; and develop more effective communication resources throughout the Fellowship.

At the end of 1997, the Grapevine began developing plans to launch a Web Site, with editorial assistant Paul Murphy acting as project manager. The Web Site will be a way for the Grapevine to reach the growing number of A.A.s who are online. It will be separate from the Web Site maintained by A.A.W.S. and its purpose will be to increase awareness of the A.A. Grapevine, to encourage subscriptions, to give information about our related materials, and to solicit material for the magazine. The Web Site will offer a brief description of the magazine; give monthly previews about the upcoming issue; highlight one special item every month; provide an order form that can be downloaded, filled out, and mailed in; describe how to become a Grapevine representative; give the background on the Preamble and the Serenity Prayer; and list the current Calendar of Events. In addition, there will be a hyperlink to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. Paul will work with other members of the editorial department and with the Grapevine's art director to maintain and update the site, both in terms of content and graphics, on a monthly basis.

Cynthia Keyworth, senior editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1998	APRIL 1997	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,176	1,169	7
Alaska	626	562	64
Arizona	1,732	1,742	— 10
Arkansas	641	681	— 40
California	11,496	11,921	— 425
Colorado	1,789	1,792	— 3
Connecticut	1,987	1,975	12
Delaware	464	488	— 24
District of Columbia	234	250	— 16
Florida	5,978	6,159	— 181
Georgia	2,625	2,783	— 158
Hawaii	539	497	42
Idaho	575	547	28
Illinois	4,565	4,940	— 375
Indiana	1,748	1,823	— 75
Iowa	1,381	1,409	— 28
Kansas	1,436	1,489	— 53
Kentucky	1,032	1,111	— 79
Louisiana	1,132	1,089	43
Maine	756	772	— 16
Maryland	1,630	1,687	— 57
Massachusetts	3,467	3,716	— 249
Michigan	3,656	3,693	— 37
Minnesota	2,831	2,953	— 122
Mississippi	720	736	— 16
Missouri	1,978	2,041	— 63
Montana	616	654	— 38
Nebraska	1,094	1,210	— 116
Nevada	685	660	25
New Hampshire	753	764	— 11
New Jersey	3,023	3,319	— 296
New Mexico	649	684	— 35
New York	7,345	7,687	— 342
North Carolina	2,711	2,733	— 22
North Dakota	427	474	— 47
Ohio	3,329	3,522	— 193
Oklahoma	1,327	1,323	4
Oregon	1,364	1,365	— 1
Pennsylvania	5,009	5,203	— 194
Rhode Island	454	529	— 75
South Carolina	1,247	1,294	— 47
South Dakota	446	498	— 52
Tennessee	1,475	1,548	— 73
Texas	5,085	5,302	— 217
Utah	610	646	— 36
Vermont	378	425	— 47
Virginia	2,486	2,552	— 66
Washington	3,251	3,324	— 73
West Virginia	455	516	— 61
Wisconsin	2,827	2,853	— 26
Wyoming	304	339	— 35
Puerto Rico	68	69	— 1
U.S. Possessions	82	93	— 11
Subtotal U.S.	103,694	107,611	(3,917)
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	979	1,131	— 152
British Columbia/Ykn	1,289	1,346	— 57
Manitoba	437	459	— 22
New Brunswick/PEI	346	465	— 119
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	591	651	— 60
Ontario	3,288	3,503	— 215
Quebec	269	329	— 60
Saskatchewan	575	660	— 85
Subtotal Canadian	7,774	8,544	— (770)
FOREIGN			
	1,628	1,668	— 40
Grand Total	113,096	117,823	— (4,727)

(exclusive of monthly orders)

Literature Distributed - 1997

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	437,914
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	380,471
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	20,073
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	95,468
Daily Reflections	135,131
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	186,400
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	20,487
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	155,868
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	10,489
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	40,973
A.A. Comes of Age	14,412
As Bill Sees It	50,786
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	25,056
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	13,426
"Pass It On"	14,066
Total	1,601,020

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	31,043
Living Sober	155,183
Came to Believe	78,412
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	24,399
Total	289,037

Pamphlets

A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs	13,763
A.A. and the Armed Services	8,562
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	30,674
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	31,578
A.A. for the Native North American	18,104
A.A. for the Woman	130,783
The A.A. Group	100,390
A.A. in Your Community	56,198
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	26,462
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	29,338
The A.A. Membership Survey	88,569
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	111,317
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	35,019
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	13,821
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	130,987
Circles of Love and Service	40,949
Bridging the Gap	22,492
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	24,796
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	17,396
Do You Think You're Different?	134,887
44 Questions	258,704
G.S.R.	49,768
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	18,833
How A.A. Members Cooperate	18,680
How It Works	72,044
If You Are a Professional	39,012
Inside A.A.	47,306
Is A.A. for You?	364,326
Is A.A. for Me?	102,674
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	96,670
It Happened to Alice	59,668
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	51,137
The Jack Alexander Article	32,153

Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	14,611
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	85,420
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	54,876
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	45,511
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	11,160
A Newcomer Asks	305,666
Problems Other Than Alcohol	129,601
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	265,391
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,349
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	23,161
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	83,385
Twelve Tradition Flyer	7,105
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	46,710
This Is A.A.	280,981
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	18,693
Time to Start Living	67,984
Time to Start Living (large print)	7,087
Too Young?	98,446
Understanding Anonymity	64,727
What Happened to Joe	63,478
Young People and A.A.	131,184
Total	4,101,526

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	491,355
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	73,902
Wallet cards-Anonymity	54,736
Anonymity Display Card	3,781
Parchment-scrolls	3,152
Placards	466
C.P.C. Workbook	1,479
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,322
P.I. Workbook	1,696
Treatment Facilities Workbook	399
Treatment Facility Handbook	866
Big Book on computer disk	861
A.A. Guidelines	75,894
Group Handbook	2,717
Wire Racks	1,889
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	2,180
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	4,811
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	420
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,249
TV Public Service Announcement	205
Radio Public Service Announcements	288
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,923
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,752
Fact Files	3,048
Table Top Display 12 & 12	457
Total	731,848
Grand Total	6,723,431

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	26,285
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	4,429
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	5,369

Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	6,873
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,983
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,924
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	3,356
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	6,959
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	15,024
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	3,152
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	23,324
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	8,233
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	5,694
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	4,731
Total	120,336

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	15,929
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	23,795
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	31,637
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	70,969
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	6,778
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	5,408
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	4,757
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	3,623
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,473
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,308
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	12,169
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	8,346
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	11,543
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	3,543
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	9,354
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	9,204
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	5,422
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	5,715
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	5,063
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	12,215
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	2,646
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	8,298
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	4,311
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	9,373
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	5,201
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,598
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,618
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	4,097
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	

(The Clergy Asks)	2,885
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,548
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	8,622
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	4,737
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	2,345
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	7,620
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,249
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	2,261
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	9,519
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	2,850
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	4,187
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,011
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	2,147
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,491
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,965
Total	348,830

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	8,524
Parchments, Spanish	419
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	15,541
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	548
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	679
Total	25,711
Grand Total	438,055

FRENCH

Books

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	3,603
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	2,684
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	2,359
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,191
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	2,046
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	1,655
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	416
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	3,602
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	4,898
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	1,946
Total	24,400

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,385
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,457
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	2,571
Total	6,413

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	13,197
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	2,351
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	15,905
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	949
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	312
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	345
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,043
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	263
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	216
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,017
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	556
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	285
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	2,219
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	603
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	434
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	469
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,591
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,231
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	783
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,387
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	367
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	701
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,259
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	371
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	412
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	761
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	333
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	3,072
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	908
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	781
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	452
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	836
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	2,550
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A.	

(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	415
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,598
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,327
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	262
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	2,320
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	914
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	632
Sondage de 1992 sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,695
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,343
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	2,620
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	815
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	4,904
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	913
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	192
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,516
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	450
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	234
Total	83,109

Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total	3,446
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Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	72
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	80
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,564
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	112
Cassettes	80
Notre Methode (How It Works)	9,332
Manuel de Groupe	83
Manuel de l'Information Publique	27
Manuel des Centres de Detention	15
Manuel de la CMP	1
Messages d'Interet Publique (Radio P.S.A.)	5
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	12,908
Slogans (serie de 5) (Five A.A. Slogans)	180
Suggestions Reunions Debutants (Guide for Leading Beginners Meetings)	109
Manuel des Centres de Traitement	13
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	589
Total	25,170
Grand Total	142,538



Area Service Highlights

Alaska: Area 2 consists of 237 groups and 3,000 members served by 12 districts, nine of which are active, in an area of 656,000 square miles. We hold two assemblies and either a state roundup or election assembly each year. Since 80% of our population lives within 125 miles of Anchorage, our challenge is to carry the message to all who want it. We were privileged to have a Special Forum held in Ketchikan, Juneau, Anchorage and Fairbanks over four days in May 1997. In Anchorage in September we celebrated 50 years of A.A. in Alaska, with over 650 present. A group in Kotzebue is interested in activating a long-dormant district on the North Slope. Anchorage and Fairbanks are each dealing with an inactive district, which hampers the flow of information to the groups. We are attempting to increase service involvement with a committee system that mirrors the Conference committees. E-mail and teleconferencing have been a godsend to an area that stretches the limits of travel, but so far nothing has replaced the face-to-face sharing that comes with one alcoholic helping another. Our goal is to foster unity and recovery through an effective service structure. — *Ken Knowles*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: One of the many rewarding events in our area over the past few years is watching our area committee system grow. As each two-year term goes by we "bridge the gap" more among G.S.O., the area, the district and the home groups. Each year Conference agenda items are discussed at our area assembly. Area 78 has two D.C.M. meetings in January and May, as well as area assemblies in March and September. Both assemblies include sharing sessions, at which questions from the Conference theme and suggestions from the floor are taken. At all assembly and D.C.M. meetings we update information on our committees and officers. Group information for our directories is also a main concern, and is kept up-to-date. Our past delegates are helpful in obtaining this vital information. We are also fortunate that our Western Canada Regional trustee comes from Area 78, and takes part in our district and assembly meetings, keeping us informed about day-to-day activities at G.S.O. — *Jim Tallman*

Arizona: Area 3 includes the state of Arizona and parts of California, and has approximately 800 registered groups. Our area is geographically divided up among 15 counties. Within the counties there are 57 districts, two of which are Spanish-speaking. Our area structure mirrors that of the Conference in many ways. All groups and districts are encouraged to participate in the panel system at our assemblies. We have four assemblies a year, two one-day, and two three-day. The challenges we continue to face are those of language, culture and geographical differences. Many districts have formed Remote Communities committees. This past year, a portion of Chapter 5, as well as our A.A. Preamble, were completed on audiotape, in the Navajo language—a two-years project. Recently we have voted to have a Spanish-speaking panel for the Spanish-speaking districts; we have included in our structure a Literature coordinator; our C.F. committee has made an unrelenting effort to have a contact or committee in every location where there is a correctional facility; and P.I. and C.P.C. committees have come alive throughout the area. Area 3 continues to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Karl Mehrhof*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 9 celebrates its 40th Anniversary in April 1998. We hold three assemblies each year; in odd-numbered years, we have a 4th assembly, for elections. We host a pre-Conference Workshop in early April, a Foro in July and a Servathon in November. The Foro is a unifying event co-hosted by an English-speaking and Spanish-speaking district, discusses matters affecting all areas of A.A. The Servathon includes presentations and discussions of different types of service experi-

ence. Our Archives committee hosts an Open House in March, and an A.A. Heritage day in September. We have 12 standing committees. In January of even-numbered years, we elect an English-speaking and Spanish-speaking co-chair for each committee, with the exception of Archives, Finance, H&I and Grapevine. Participation by G.S.R.s at the area assemblies is low; we took an area inventory and increased visits to all districts and coordinate committees by the area officers. Participation in committee work is also inconsistent, but two successes from our standing committees have been the production of a pamphlet directed at those who are ordered to attend A.A., and a general service handbook. One striking characteristic of the participation in area service work is the profound commitment of those who do get involved. — *Nick Murray*

California (Northern Interior): Area 7 encompasses most of the Great Central Valley of California, and the slopes of the several mountain ranges that define the borders of both the valley and the area. Of the five delegate areas in California we are geographically the largest and numerically the smallest, with about 700 groups. This relative smallness is one of our strengths: we represent a cross-section of the Fellowship, and our size allows us to work with the idea of least possible organization and greatest direct participation by the groups in our 29 districts. We hold four assemblies each year, three of which are now multi-day, eight area committee meetings in the months when there is no assembly, and numerous district activities on the remaining weekends. We rotate our assemblies through the districts by a bidding process, which has strengthened participation. We've seen that holding an assembly at either the northern or southern extreme of our area (about a 500 mile difference) has no real effect on attendance. Our assemblies are guided by the G.S.R.s, and our area committee by the D.C.M.s. This July we will have the privilege of hosting the Pacific Regional Forum in Sacramento. — *John Gehrman*

California (San Diego/Imperial): Area 8 consists of 824 groups in 22 districts, three of which are Spanish-speaking; and has 11 standing committees. The area assembly meets five times every year, and the area committee and the standing committees meet monthly. The committees are staffed by G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s, and mirror the Conference. Our newest committee is Contact Service, which bridges the gap for A.A.s being released from institutions. The Archives committee hosts an annual Roots meeting, the Grapevine committee hosts a Grapevine celebration, and we join with other service entities in our area for a Unity Day on A.A.'s birthday. The districts are active, and hold workshops and panel discussions throughout the year. We meet with Areas 5 and 9 in a D.C.M. sharing session annually. We do not have a prudent reserve, but an annual budget maintained by an operating account. Each quarter, funds in excess of 50 percent of our annual budget are forwarded to G.S.O. Our immediate goals are to increase communication and participation among our groups and districts to carry the message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Sallye Martinez*

Delaware: Area 12 has 193 registered groups, 2,879 members, 13 districts and three intergroups, all of which help to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. We have four area committee meetings yearly, 30 days before each area assembly, in Dover, which is centrally located. Our state convention is a three-day weekend event held at Rehoboth Beach, usually in May. Our area is trying to reach communities lacking effective A.A. Our area standing committees are C.P.C., P.I., Grapevine, Literature, Archives, C.F. and T.F., our three intergroups handle all institutional commitments. We have been holding mini-assemblies to help

D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s get more involved in the structure of A.A. We believe that we need to know the *A.A. Service Manual* in order to be informed. Our goal as an area committee is to have all 13 districts involved in service. — *Dave Madison*

Georgia: Area 16 has 48 districts, covering the entire state of Georgia. We have 755 groups, 40 institutional groups and approximately 17,300 members. Our area assembly is held at a central location three times a year. We had 701 in attendance at the January assembly, with all 48 districts represented. We have five very active standing committees: P.I./C.P.C., T.F., C.F., Archives and Grapevine. Our prepaid state convention rotates around the state, and is held the third weekend in October. We have a state office, with two paid employees, that distributes literature, maintains records and publishes a bimonthly newsletter and an annual state directory; the office enhances communication and unity among our groups. We have seven geographical regions, and each conducts a cluster forum during the year, with presentations based on our Conference theme. These forums are another means of carrying the message to the A.A. members in the far corners of our state. — *Jerry Honeycutt*

Idaho: Area 18 encompasses all of Southern Idaho, parts of Eastern Oregon, Western Wyoming and Jackpot, Nevada. We have 10 districts in our area, and approximately 190 groups. We hold three area business meetings each year, and two area assembly/conventions every year, usually in May and October. This past March we hosted the Pacific Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (PRAASA) in Boise. Some 14 areas were represented from throughout the Pacific Region. Our area Archives continues to be outstanding, and is growing. We recently established an area Finance committee to oversee area expenses. This committee is chaired by our immediate past delegate, and includes the area treasurer, alternate delegate and D.C.M.s from Western and Eastern Idaho. The main focus of area, districts and groups in Area 18 is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Carl Oseen*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 has 24 districts and 1,100 groups, with 22,000 attending meetings. Our area service structure guidelines provide for an effective committee system to focus our efforts on our primary purpose. We conduct area business through four committees and four assemblies each year, and host an annual spring service conference weekend in March, and an annual Big Book conference in October. We have seven service committees: Answering Service, C.F., C.P.C., Grapevine, Literature, P.I. and T.F. There are two appointed service positions, archives and our area newsletter "Concepts." We have a workshop in March, at which the service committee chairpeople arrive at the area conscience on the final Conference agenda items. Our state conference is rotated among the three delegate areas in Illinois. This August, Area 20 will be hosting the 25th annual state conference. We are self-supporting, and have forwarded our excess funds over prudent reserve at year end, about 20 percent of our annual operating budget, to G.S.O. We are participants in the November Birthday Plan. We held three workshops this year to develop a sense of common purpose and togetherness. — *Jerry Pelan*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 serves over 650 groups in 26 districts. In the past two years we have conducted an area inventory, rewritten our area structure and modified our committee system. Although we are going through growing pains under the new structure, we have already seen an increase in participation and committee activity. In 1997 our committees hosted nine workshops in the areas of Treatment and C.P.C. Our area/intergroup

liaison hosted three workshops, enhancing communication with our five intergroups, and our P.I. committee kept active with several ongoing projects. Our Literature, Grapevine, and Archives committees traveled over 4,000 miles carrying their displays to areas functions. We alternate with Area 22 in hosting the annual convention, and this year we will host the 45th Indiana State Convention, in conjunction with the 20th East Central Regional Conference. Our challenge is to iron out the wrinkles in our new structure and committee system, focusing on better ways to more effectively serve our groups, and carry the A.A. message of hope to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Sue Felgenauer*

Kansas: Area 25 has approximately 380 groups, divided into 30 districts. In January and July we have full area assemblies, and in April and October we have area committee meetings. Along with conducting our area business, we have service workshops at each assembly and committee meeting. Our area is making significant strides to better carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. We have added a Literature committee to our standing committees, and are considering a Special Needs committee. Each D.C.M. in the area is assigned to a particular committee; and each committee works closely with its district and group counterparts. We submit bids and hold an outstanding Kansas Area Conference annually. We have had an ad-hoc Archives committee that has helped to define our archival responsibilities. Our Twelfth Step ad-hoc committee has developed a pamphlet that will be presented to the Conference Literature Committee for consideration. — *Carol Rohloff*

Kentucky: The state of Kentucky, parts of southern Indiana and a few groups from Metropolis Illinois make up Area 26. We have 32 districts and approximately 850 groups. Three area committee meetings and one area assembly are held each year. Our meetings are unique in that we meet on Saturday at noon, hold workshops until 5:00 p.m. and come back for an eating meeting Saturday night. On Sunday we hold our business meeting until noon. About three or four years ago we started holding committee meetings on Saturday for one hour, in an attempt to get more G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s involved in committee work; it has worked well, and we have seen a large increase in attendance. Presently, we are looking into the possibility of adding the position of registrar to our structure. We already have three or four people maintaining databases of group information and contacts, and believe having a registrar would help us to consolidate and be more efficient with names and addresses. — *Jim Skees*

Maine: Area 28 covers a large geographical area that includes a portion of New Brunswick, Canada. It has approximately 8,000 members, and 477 groups divided into 20 districts. We hold two service assemblies a year; four area committee meetings, and pre- and post-Conference forums. We have 14 standing committees, the most recent being the Special Needs committee. We host at least two one-day service workshops called Love and Service Days, with district, standing committees and area officers participating. We take time to enjoy life with three round-ups a year, one hosted by the area, and two by districts. There are two central service offices, in Portland and in Bangor. Because of the shape and size of our area some members have to travel up to eight hours to attend our assemblies. Despite this reality, it is not uncommon to have 25% of the groups represented. This active, well informed group wants to know what is going on in A.A. and how to serve the Fellowship better. — *Elaine Owen*

Manitoba: Area 80 has 14 districts representing 155 groups. We have split the province into east and west to cut travel time and

cost and combined P.I. and C.P.C., hospital and T.F. and C.F. committees on an east and west basis. It has always been a problem for northern groups to travel the long distances to the more populated south; Manitoba covers 251,000 square miles. Recently, area officers and some D.C.M.s travelled north as a mini-assembly. The costs were minimal, and it was a very successful event. We have begun to implement the committee structure into our service structure, which mirrors that of the Conference. Manitoba has four service assemblies each year, two in the rural part of the province, and two in city locations. We have a central office for the province, located in Winnipeg. Manitoba looks forward to hosting the Regional Forum for Western Canada this June. — *Gord Sytnick*

Maryland: Area 29 has 902 registered groups in 47 districts, and is served by ten intergroups. Our area is diverse geographically, economically and culturally. We stretch from Atlantic Coast beach resorts to high-density, multicultural urban areas, and to the more remote Cumberland Mountains locales. We have five assemblies and four committee meetings annually. Meeting locations are rotated throughout the area in an effort to attract greater participation. Our standing committees include Archives, C.P.C., C.F., Finance, Grapevine, Literature, P.I., Registrar, T.F., Workshop and two Convention committees. In order to generate more enthusiasm for area service, we have developed a process of delegate preparation, which includes regional group cluster meetings to discuss specific Conference agenda items, followed by a weekend Mini-Conference/Assembly at which we discuss and present all views to our delegate. — *Peggy Trapp*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31 has approximately 250 registered groups, in six districts. Our service structure includes an active area committee, 12 D.C.M.s, the chairpersons of the Archives, C.P.C., Grapevine, P.I., Round Up, T.F. and Western Massachusetts Young People's Conference committees, as well as representatives from the Institutions committee and the intergroup. The service committees meet monthly, and a spring and fall assembly is held each year. Last spring the area held its first mini-conference. Members who signed up in advance became "delegate for a day" to discuss and vote on agenda items from five of the Conference committees. The Institutions committee has 70 institution meetings each week. The Western Massachusetts and Berkshire Intergroups provide telephone services, meeting lists, books and pamphlets. We cooperate with Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) to put on the annual Massachusetts state convention. An effort is being made to involve our Hispanic groups in our service structure. Our challenge continues to be to get and keep members informed and involved in our vital Twelfth-Step work. — *Billie Bozone*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 covers about 20,266 square miles, roughly the western half of the lower peninsula, and the eastern tip of the upper peninsula. We have 15 districts, 466 groups, including a number of Spanish-speaking groups and about 9,100 members. The area assembly meets the third Sunday of every month at various districts. We have eight standing committees. C.F., T.F., P.I./C.P.C., Grapevine, Literature, Directories, Special Needs and Archives. The committees give reports at every assembly, which are included in the minutes mailed to G.S.R.s. The Archives committee didn't exist until late 1990, and has come a long way. The archivists are four of our past delegates. Archival materials are available to be shown at most area conventions, district workshops, mini-conventions and special group functions. Area 34 devotes one assembly to a service workshop, that is announced with flyers and in the minutes, to encourage interested persons to come and get a better idea of the service structure. The challenge, as always, is to get the dis-

tricts more involved and keeping principles before personalities. — *Leon DeLong*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 consists of 535 groups, in 19 districts. The districts are divided into four zones, and we rotate our two assemblies and our workshop throughout the area. At each assembly we hold a G.S.R. orientation and D.C.M. and G.S.R. sharing sessions. Our four area committee meetings bring the officers, committee chairs and D.C.M.s together to discuss area business. Our action committees consist of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., T.F., Literature, Grapevine and Archives. These committees are dedicated to carrying the message, whether its distributing literature and Grapevines to the local detox, putting on meetings in treatment centers or correctional facilities, setting up P.I. lunches, talking to doctors or lawyers or displaying our archives. We have a group records secretary, a *Northern Light* newsletter editor and an archivist. We participate in the annual West Central Regional Conference and the biannual West Central Regional Forum. — *Susie Ardolf*

Mississippi: Area 37 has 231 registered groups and 24 districts that are divided into five geographical zones. We have four service assemblies a year. Our area has nine standing committees: P.I., C.P.C., C.F., T.F., Literature, Archives, Finance, Newsletter and Grapevine. Our next assembly will discuss establishing a convention committee. Our Intergroups are active, and we have several central offices which help the surrounding groups with information and literature. We hold four area workshops each year, and a state convention which rotates through the five zones; round-ups are also very popular. Our Archives, C.P.C. and C.F. committees have traveling displays that have been in many districts. The C.F. committee has started a Bridging the Gap telephone list for A.A.s returning to society. C.P.C. has given a panel presentation to administrators of prisons. Unity in Area 37 has become evident, with the area officers asking, How can we help? — *Darla Branton*

Montana: Area 40 has 292 groups in 15 districts, with an estimated membership of 4,500. Our challenge continues to be reaching remote communities, and expanding our communications to reach every member within our 146,000 square miles. Our assemblies are held biannually in the spring and fall, and we usually have about 33% of groups and 90 to 100% of districts represented. We have a committee system that parallels the Conference, which has enabled us to handle area business more effectively, leaving more time for discussion of Conference agenda items. We are planning to add a G.S.R. school, and a committee system workshop to our scheduled activities. August 15-16, Area 40 will host a Special Forum in Helena, and Miles City. We have a Bridging the Gap program for treatment facilities statewide, with one for corrections in the works. Next month, the Montana state prison will host its fifth conference, allowing up to 200 A.A. members to come in and share a day of recovery with over 100 prisoners. Displays for Archives, Grapevine, A.A. literature, and P.I. are available for all area events. — *Eric Donaldson*

Nebraska: Area 41's newest tool for extending the hand of A.A. is our toll free hotline, 1-888-AA-OFF-NEB. While the hotline focuses on recovery, our new web page, www.area41.org, not only provides an area-wide meeting list, but supports unity through posting flyers of upcoming events, and printing the area newsletter. This undertaking required much discussion and input from our groups, as well as study of the Traditions. We activated this web page last September, but some members remained unconvinced of its need. At our November assembly this doubt evaporated as a D.C.M. told of a newcomer who had found his way to a particularly obscure meet-

ing place, explaining that he had found it on the internet. Our commitment to service has remained strong. The position of registrar has enhanced support to our 30 districts and 696 groups. The web page has a link to the registrar, so that he can keep G.S.O., the *Area 41 Where & When* and the on-line meeting list current. Our 12 service committees have shown dramatic growth, with the inclusion of actively involved D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. All Three Legacies of our wonderful Fellowship are vigorous in Area 41. — *Ken Brueggemann*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Area 81 comprises 13 districts and 216 groups, of which 35 are French-speaking. There are nine districts in New Brunswick and four on Prince Edward Island. The two Provinces are now connected by the Confederation Bridge. Prince Edward Island has an efficient inter-group office. We hold area workshops in January and in June, area meetings in March and September and area assemblies in May and October. At the March meeting, prior to Conference, our delegate is given a consensus on any issues he or she may address; and at our May assembly, our delegate gives a report from Conference. We have active committees, especially in P.I., T.F., C.F. and Grapevine. Our telephone answering services are very busy with substantial members to service them. We have an area Archives committee, backed up by district committees which are available to all district and area functions. Our area is unified, with responsible committee people serving to carry the message. We have our financial difficulties, not unlike other areas, but our Higher Power keeps coming through to ensure that we fulfill our obligations to the best of our ability. — *Jim West*

New Hampshire: Area 43 has 650 groups, which hold 750 meetings per week throughout New Hampshire. The area is divided into 15 districts, and ranges from the Atlantic coast, to Vermont and up to the Canadian border. Several of the districts are centered around urban areas, while others are rural. The assembly meets quarterly and rotates throughout the area. Besides being a gathering spot for service activities, our central service office acts as a clearing house of literature, selling in excess of \$70,000 worth. Over the past year we have replaced our old computers with updated machines, and created a custom software package designed to make management and maintenance of information more efficient. We are preparing a web page on the internet. Over the past year, we concluded work on an area service handbook. Area 43 has nine standing committees: Treatment, P.I./C.P.C., C.F., Literature and Grapevine, Finance, Service Office, Archives, Handbook and Functions. Our annual convention is held in June in North Conway, which sits peacefully in the lovely White Mountains. — *Wayne Coull*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 has 646 groups, of which 524 are currently registered with G.S.O. We are structured into four sections, each subdivided into 31 districts, including one Spanish-speaking. We meet four times a year for area committee meetings, where we are apprised of the progress of our 13 standing committees. We also meet four times a year in assembly. Biannually we hold an election assembly. We work closely with our three intergroups, and host an annual Day of Sharing for the area and intergroups to promote unity. Our 34th annual Area General Service Convention this year will have more than 2,000 participants. We utilize this forum to put on a Traditions/Concepts skit, a valuable tool in informing members of the Conference process. Our C.F. and T.F. committees attracted nine other committees from throughout the Northeast region to participate in our annual Inter-Area Conference last year. Our challenge as an area committee is to continue to enthusiastically carry the message of hope to those in Area 45 that haven't yet heard about the dynamic Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Robbie Walker*

New Mexico: Area 46 consists of approximately 121,600 square miles bordered by the same boundaries as New Mexico. Our area has 350 groups divided into 16 districts. We have three assemblies each year. Each district is allowed to bid on the next year's assembly. Our state convention is held in June, and is also awarded to a district by a bid process. We have seven standing active committees that mirror the Conference committees—P.I., C.P.C., T.F., C.F., Archives, Grapevine and Convention Liaison. Each of these committees is given time on the first morning of each assembly to hold a committee meeting with all of the assembly members who wish to attend. A change was made to the C.F. committee at our December 1997 assembly, when we voted to combine men and women's correctional facilities under one chairperson. Our area is spread out over a remotely populated state, and carrying the message can sometimes be difficult, but because of a dedicated area committee, 16 active D.C.M.s, and enthusiastic groups, Area 46 continues to carry the message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Jeff Osuch*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Early in 1939, alcoholics Anonymous was introduced to the Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire Area in Glens Falls, New York, a small town south of Lake George Village. In 1998 we have about 12,000 members in 800 groups, divided into 17 districts. Redistricting is an ongoing process; our two largest districts are working out details at present. We have area events taking place eight months of the year, rotating around different regions of the area. Additionally, our area convention is usually held the last weekend in October, this year in beautiful Lake Placid. Area assemblies are held in May and October. An area inventory day is being considered. The establishment of a Functions Committee and the adoption of a new election procedure a few years ago has been successful in establishing a new trust and level of understanding among the A.A. members, their groups, districts and the area. The H/M/B Area wishes to thank the General Service Office and staff for their help, beyond the call of duty, during the recent passing of our delegate. What a wonderful Fellowship we have. — *Charlie Contro*

New York (Western): Area 50 spans seven counties, encompassing 23 districts, approximately 350 groups (nine in northeastern Pennsylvania), and 3,500 members. There is one central office and three intergroups, around which only 10 districts are truly active. These districts host a spring and fall day of sharing, and workshops for new G.S.R.s. Of the six assembly meetings each year, four are central and two are in the southern and eastern parts of our area. Each year we join with the three other areas of N.Y. State to plan our state convention. An annual informational workshop for all service committees is held in similar fashion. A spring convention (service oriented) is held each year for the area. Seven service committees meet separately each month. P.I. and C.P.C. committees work with schools, health fairs and professional groups, while C.F. committees run seven meetings, and T.F. committees run 12 meetings in area facilities. The Grapevine committee is just becoming active, and our Archives committee has grown. This year an ad hoc Budget committee was formed to bring about the first formal budget of the assembly. — *Marcia Walker*

North Dakota: It has been an exciting time in Area 52. After several years of adjusting to a new committee system, we are now reaping the benefits. Our 13 D.C.M.s and 165 G.S.R.s are assigned to committees on a two-year basis. It has created a healthy environment for our assemblies, and we hope that it will attract more group participation. We have also devised an area handbook, laying out our area service structure, duties of our trusted servants, guidelines for our six area committees, and a brief guide to assembly procedures. We are experimenting with an Area 52 Service

Conference, and our first effort proved very interesting. We have made significant progress in carrying the message to those in our prison system, with closed meetings in our maximum and minimum security sites, and open meetings every two weeks in the minimum security units. There is now an A.A. group in the main prison, and both a men's and a women's group in the minimum security section. The men's minimum security group is even allowed to attend outside meetings. And, most importantly, these fellow A.A. members are joining us upon their release to help us carry the message of sobriety. — *Loyd Gerstner*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeast): Area 55 has 15 districts and about 280 groups. We elect area officers and an alternate delegate in November, D.C.M.s in December. The alternate delegate rotates into the delegate's position, and the delegate appoints committee chairpersons. We are in the process of redistricting, and are trying to establish boundary lines that separate our area from areas to the north, south and east. Our greatest challenge is getting rural districts active in the assembly. We have tried holding assembly meetings in rural districts but have had little progress. We have D.C.M. meetings quarterly, and the assembly meets eight times a year. We have inherited two committees (Special Needs and P.I.) from a local intergroup, and their duties have been combined with existing committees. Our area sponsors an annual Mini-Conference, which we pattern on the General Service Conference. We invite past delegates, a G.S.O. staff person, and the regional trustee to participate. We have the privilege in 1998, of hosting the 42nd Ohio State Convention, and expect to have over 1,000 people registered. We also have two workshops planned with a local intergroup to further our ongoing efforts of cooperation in carrying A.A.'s message of love and service. — *Ron Schudel*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 consists of 29 districts, reporting 530 groups in the 16 counties we serve. We have 12 assemblies annually, and an early spring mini-conference to discuss upcoming Conference agenda items. This year we have three new officers and five new standing committee chairpersons, who bring new experience and ideas to further our efforts in increasing unity and communications to the groups. Two intergroups operate within our boundaries, and have active liaison representatives at the area level. The area is going back to basics, concentrating on making districts more active, beginning with working with the G.S.R.s to elect D.C.M.s where there are vacancies. The Grapevine committee continues to update the GvR list, and together with the Literature committee, maintains a complete display of what each has to offer. Recently, we rotated the Archives committee chair to our immediate past delegate. The P.I./C.P.C. committee continues to look for new avenues to further inform professionals; the C.F. committee keeps the link between inmate and outside contacts, while working with facilities professionals. A new feature at our assemblies is to have a G.S.R. give a presentation on one of the Twelve Concepts. — *Rick Swaney*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has a fully functioning area committee which meets three times a year, together with a two-day assembly held in Spring and Fall. The first day is filled with education and training, while Sunday is reserved for business and planning. Our 23 districts have good G.S.R.s, and fully functioning district P.I./C.P.C., T.F. and C.F. committees to carry our message of hope and recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic. Because of the efforts of a good number of dedicated trusted servants, over the last 20 years especially, we have been able to see a pattern of stability and continuity develop in our area structure. Of our 10 sub-committee chairs there are nine who were D.C.M.s last term. In addition, of 23 D.C.M.s, there are two holdovers because they had

not served a full term, while in the remaining 21 districts 17 alternate D.C.M.s who stood for election chose to go on in service. We can be grateful to those who pioneered our area's general service efforts, and proud of the newer people who have stepped forward to continue its growth. — *Vic Booth*

Oregon: Area 58 currently has 740 registered groups in 33 active districts. We have active area committees for P.I., C.P.C., T.F., C.F., Hospitals, Archives, Grapevine and a Newsletter. We have four assemblies a year: a general assembly, at which we elect officers and vote on our annual budget (currently about \$50,000) in September; a quarterly, at which new officers and committee chairs convene in November; a pre-Conference quarterly in February; and a post-Conference quarterly in May. We conduct business meetings at all four assemblies, with G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee chairs and area officers voting. Our assemblies move about Oregon from district to district on a bid basis. We find this beneficial in carrying the message to the different regions of our very diverse state. All area officers and committee chairs are available for service workshops, and we travel a lot. The area also financially supports our area officers to Pacific regional meetings and we try to take an active role in these meetings. As an area we are very grateful for the loving support of our groups, and they are grateful for the help and communications of their trusted servants. — *Mark Simonson*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 is divided into 9 districts, with 120 groups and an estimated 1,200 members. Our area office operates with an assistant manager and an office clerk. Our area meets each month, with our 9 district chairs, the committees chairs and the assistant office manager. This year the area received 591 Twelfth Step calls, 49 calls for information and 73 calls from treatment facilities and institutions. Our newly elected officers are especially focused on our Fifth Tradition and trying to increase our literature distribution, so that every member has at least the basic literature. We are also encouraging our P.I. committee to be proactive with their services; and we are increasing our communication with our districts, groups and members for the benefit of the unity of A.A. as a whole. — *Cesar O. Borri*

Quebec (Northwest): Area 90 has 8,000 members, 425 groups and 26 districts. There are 25 groups in correctional centers. Most of the groups are French-speaking; the other languages are English, Spanish and Native. Since the Remote Communities Service Committee has been formed and following the Special Forum in Val D'or (Quebec) a great deal of work has been done for the Native people, from as far as the Hudson Bay coast and the Ungava Bay coast. A meeting at the correctional center in the south of the area has led to the translation of A.A. literature into the Inuktitut language. We presently have a member from a Cree community who has shown an interest in becoming a D.C.M. Area 90 is reviewing the possibility of creating a new district, which would be composed with groups of North Native people. Before the Conference, we have a full day of sharing on the Conference theme, and a weekend of workshops on Conference committees. For the first time in our history, the area has known serious money difficulties. The groups have taken at heart the importance of being self-supporting, and their contributions have permitted us to continue our Twelfth Step work. — *Monique Noel*

Quebec (Southwest): Our area has approximately 15,000 members in close to 600 groups in 30 districts, which include 23 French-speaking, six English and one Hispanic. Where there is membership involvement, we provide services in French and English. To manage area business, the steering committee meets once a

month. To ensure communications with our groups, the area committee holds eight area meetings and three assemblies. The Welcome Assembly in January is to introduce new servants to the various area committees, and the services offered by G.S.O., with emphasis on service sponsorship. In March, the Delegate's Assembly invites discussion of the Conference theme. The October Election Assembly elects the new area committee servants. The area committee structure comprises 10 committees, as well as the Youth Convention's Provincial Organizing committee. To encourage members to serve in their various functions, monthly seminars on service are held. Over 300 trusted servants of the area attend these weekends focused on the sharing of our Three Legacies. Despite room for improvement, we are addressing the challenge of the Seventh Tradition by tabling budget estimates better in line with our real needs. — *Robert Lalonde*

Rhode Island: Area 61 has approximately 500 groups in eight districts. Area assemblies are held four times a year, with a service workshop preceding each one. In the months in which assemblies do not take place, our eight districts take turns hosting an all group service meeting. At these D.C.M.s and area committee members share about service committees, and how service has enhanced their sobriety. The C.F. committee puts on 27 meetings each week at prisons and training schools; P.I. works with media, and books speakers into schools. C.P.C. works with medical students and other professionals, Archives is taping longtimers, and has just finished working on the organization and preservation of materials; Grapevine does "Pass the Book"; and T.F. is implementing Bridging the Gap. We hold a one-day roundup and an annual state convention. In addition we have monthly area committee meetings, which permit the exchange of up-to-date information. Group concerns head the agenda. We need to generate more enthusiasm and involvement, and have decided to try a pot luck dinner to give D.C.M.s a chance to exchange information, ideas and problems. — *Sandy Koerner*

Saskatchewan: Our area comprises the entire geographic area of the province of Saskatchewan, some 251,700 square miles. We are the fifth largest province in the Canadian Federation, with a population of approximately 1,000,000. We have 320 groups with 4,200 members, in 21 districts. Our area assembly pays the expenses of D.C.M.s and area officers to attend the annual January area committee meeting, as well as the two area assemblies. This insures full participation, regardless of geographic or financial circumstances of the districts, and enhances our unity and effectiveness as an area. We have a fledgling but very active Archives committee, and an area Corrections coordinator. D.C.M.s serve as contacts with the T.F., P.I., C.P.C., Grapevine and Literature committees at G.S.O. These D.C.M.s provide information at area committee meetings and assemblies. We also have a district development fund, which is an annual budgeted amount for districts to use to increase awareness of general service. Whenever this fund has been accessed, the results have been positive. Area 91 is engaged in a constant and ongoing effort to try to carry this message of general service. — *Tom Kraemer*

South Carolina: Area 62 has 345 groups, 23 districts, and an estimated active membership of over 6,300. We have had approximately a 78% increase in new members, a 34% increase in the number of new groups and a 155% increase in the development of new districts during the past ten years. Our area assemblies are conducted three times a year over a two-day weekend period, with respective meetings held and reports presented by our D.C.M.s, standing committees and area officers. A workshop is conducted in conjunction with each assembly. The

focus of future workshops include area inventories to evaluate how well we are fulfilling our primary purpose, and to examine the emphasis being given our Traditions. Most of the progress that has occurred over the years in our area has been brought about because of the dedication and commitment of our service-minded members to make our message available to the alcoholic who still suffers. As the new century approaches, the challenge we face in Area 62 is to continue this process. We commit ourselves to our Fellowship's Declaration of Unity and, as individual members, we continue to adhere to the words "I am responsible." — *Marshall Lynn*

South Dakota: Area 63 covers the entire state and consists of 163 groups and 15 districts. We hold four area assemblies annually, utilizing six standing committees. D.C.M.s are assigned a committee by lottery. We have breakout sessions at each area assembly. Our committee chairs are very active, and serve as voting members of the assembly. Our archives, institutions, literature and P.I. displays are taken to various locations throughout the state. Our committee chairs work closely with group and district representatives. With their combined efforts, many state and local institutions are provided with speakers, literature and books. P.I./C.P.C. luncheons have been well attended. We have recently started a four times a year area newsletter. A district has been formed in our reservation area, as part of our commitment to reach the still-suffering alcoholic among the Native American population. Our continued focus is to make service work attractive, provide information to allow for an informed group conscience and promote unity among our Fellowship. We also strive for progress towards greater G.S.R. participation, enabling us to maximize our efforts of carrying the message. — *Lisa Reich*

Tennessee: Area 64 covers the entire state of Tennessee, with 493 groups and 38 districts. Four assemblies are held yearly, with an average attendance of 320, and we host a convention throughout the state to promote local service participation. Funding is provided by the area for P.I., C.P.C., T.F., C.F., archives, Grapevine, and Conventions committees. Standing committees conduct two to three regional workshops, and most have portable displays. C.P.C. and P.I. work on the Governor's Conference for a Safe and Drug-Free Tennessee. Funding was provided to T.F. and C.F. chairs to attend the Bridging the Gap conference. Archives is searching for a permanent facility, and an area ad-hoc committee is studying the feasibility of a permanent Archivist. All standing committee chairs and area officers are funded to attend the assemblies, Southeast Forum, state convention, SE delegates meeting, and SE conference. Assemblies run from Friday evening through Sunday morning, and include workshops, committee sharing and business sessions, area committee meeting, G.S.R. orientation, and a D.C.M./G.S.R. discussion session. The delegate informs D.C.M.s on G.S.O. and A.A.W.S. items, and the alternate delegate conducts a G.S.R. instructional session. — *Phil Von Schaaf*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66 is served by nine districts (one Hispanic), with approximately 250 groups containing approximately 7,000 members. We are a sparsely populated, geographically large area. Our assemblies rotate to various towns and cities four times each year, and are free-standing, weekend events with workshops. We had a very successful and honest inventory to try to bring more interest to service work; and we are now more closely following Tradition Twelve. We have joined the ranks of nonsmoking assemblies and our past delegates always have a voice in our assemblies, but no longer cast a vote. We are looking forward to hosting the next Southwest regional A.A. service assembly in October of this year, and the Southwest Regional

our January 1998 quarterly included all districts and many members. We look forward to continuing our Twelfth Step work. — *Ginger Bell*

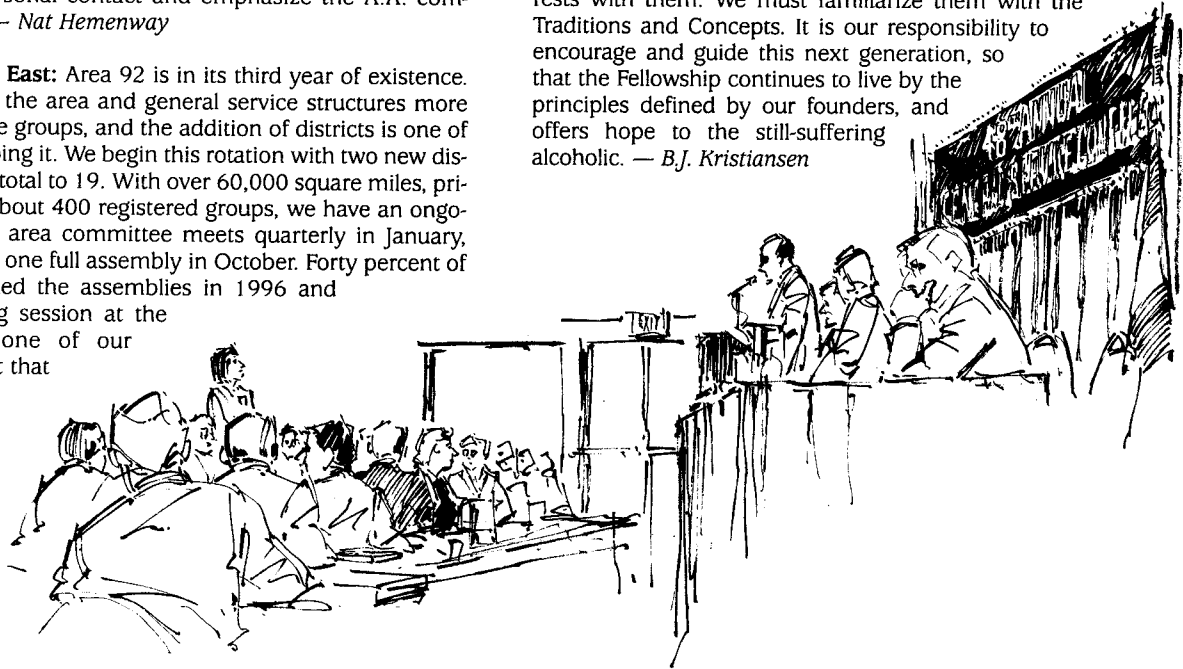
Texas (Southwest): Area 68 has 479 registered groups and 32 districts, including five with Spanish-speaking groups. We encourage Spanish-speaking members to participate, and provide translation equipment for area assemblies and district service workshops. We hold four two-day assemblies each year, two workshops and two voting conferences, that are rotated throughout the area. The Archives, Bilingual, C.F., P.I./C.P.C., Grapevine, Newsletter and T.F. committees are very active. The committee chairs conduct workshops at the summer and winter assemblies. The Archives, P.I./C.P.C. and Grapevine Committees have portable displays. The alternate chair coordinates district workshops, and is the intergroup liaison; and the alternate delegate serves as literature chairperson. Our area is blessed with the support of past delegates. Members recently anonymously donated two used computers for the secretary and treasurer. Funds were also donated by A.A. members for two microphones for area functions. We have a lot of work ahead of us, including getting more people involved in general service, but the active members are ready to meet the task. — *Roger Lambert*

Vermont: Area 70 presently serves 230 registered groups in 11 districts. We have four area assemblies, seven committee meetings, a one-day pre-Conference sharing session, an area service workshop, and a state convention. Our area will host the Northeast Regional convention in November. Before each area assembly, district and area committee chairs hold meetings that G.S.R.s are encouraged to attend. Our area budget is tight. As a result, we are trying new methods of doing things in order to cut back on extravagant expenditures. While encouraging contributions, we are also attempting to enhance the effectiveness of the area committee to carry the message inside our state. The delegate and alternate delegate are busy traveling to districts to make personal contact and emphasize the A.A. communication line. — *Nat Hemenway*

Washington State East: Area 92 is in its third year of existence. Our goal is to link the area and general service structures more closely to the home groups, and the addition of districts is one of the ways we are doing it. We begin this rotation with two new districts, bringing the total to 19. With over 60,000 square miles, primarily rural, and about 400 registered groups, we have an ongoing challenge. The area committee meets quarterly in January, April and July, with one full assembly in October. Forty percent of our G.S.R.s attended the assemblies in 1996 and 1997. In a sharing session at the 1997 assembly, one of our G.S.R.s pointed out that our area is such that smaller localities have not been given the gift of service through handling assemblies and quarterlies; service has been given back to the grass roots. Participation at

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has over 600 groups, spread across 24 districts. We hold two assemblies and two conferences a year, and at least four service seminars. Last year, our standing committees met prior to the spring assembly to review Conference agenda items. The spring's assembly was devoted to discussion of their reports. This was a great aid in conveying our area's informed group conscience to the delegate. We have voted to hold a Unity conference with the Southern Wisconsin area beginning in the year 2001. Our service structure continues to grow and expand. One of our districts recently split into three, because it was too large to service the groups adequately. Our area committee has the responsibility for developing the agenda for our assemblies. Before each assembly, we hold a short orientation session for our new G.S.R.s. We are encouraging our D.C.M.s and any interested G.S.R.s to serve on our standing committees. We remain committed to finding new ways to involve more people and to improve communication, so we can better carry the message to each other and the still-suffering alcoholic. — *John Carroll*

Wyoming: Despite our small population, or perhaps because if it, Area 76 has a thriving and enthusiastic service structure. We are once again filling area committees with members, and there are many fresh faces at the assemblies. We look forward to deputizing them to service when they volunteer through our traditional A.A. system of trusted servant recruitment. The area committee chairs are busy learning the ropes of their new responsibilities, since we all rotate together in our area. As a result, our first assembly of the year has been described as "the blind trying to lead the stubborn." Overall, Area 76 is healthy. Just as we all are experiencing, we are losing our oldtimers as the years slip by. Fortunately, however, there appears to be an increase in the number of newcomers at meetings. Many of them are working the Steps, and utilizing everything that our Fellowship has to offer; our future in Wyoming rests with them. We must familiarize them with the Traditions and Concepts. It is our responsibility to encourage and guide this next generation, so that the Fellowship continues to live by the principles defined by our founders, and offers hope to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *B.J. Kristiansen*



Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the questions remain the same for the 49th General Service Conference Evaluation Form.
- The committee considered the Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to revise the sections on Composition and Scope to better reflect current practice, and to also update the language in the Procedure section.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a form to be sent out each September 1st to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topics.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the draft for a pamphlet developed to replace the existing pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" and agreed there is no need for the new material at this time.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and requested the suggested addition to the C.P.C. Workbook regarding working with students of professional schools be implemented at the next printing.
- The committee encourages A.A. members to bring students of professional schools to their open A.A. meetings.
- The committee discussed C.P.C. participation in the development of future Membership Surveys, and agreed to take no action at this time.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES:

- The committee suggests that a new section, entitled "Carrying the Message into Youth Detention Centers and Short-Term Facilities," be added to the contents section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook and that the new section follow the section "How to do Correctional Facilities Work."
- The committee reviewed the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' report on literature review and saw no need for action at this time.
- The committee suggested that an informational letter from the General Service Office to correctional professionals be further developed as a one-page document and brought back to the 1999 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities, along with projected costs of production and distribution.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the Correctional Facilities Workbook be designated as service material rather than A.A. Conference-approved literature and decided it should remain A. A. Conference-approved.

FINANCE

- The committee unanimously suggested that Birthday Plan envelopes continue to be sent to delegates annually.

- The committee unanimously suggested G.S.O. develop a method for measuring the use of Birthday envelopes and report the results to the delegates.
- The committee had a wide ranging discussion of the principle of Self-Support, with special emphasis on how the topic relates to the Conference theme: "Our Twelfth Step Work."

Much of the discussion revolved around the importance of increasing participation of individuals and groups in all levels of service. Contributions are but one form of participation that make it possible for one alcoholic to carry the message to another. The committee unanimously agreed that delegates can play a key role in increasing self-support by:

- a) Promoting the Birthday Plan, and
- b) Emphasizing Twelfth Step work made possible by contributions; for example, the work we do to provide translations of A.A. literature in foreign languages that then reach populations that have never before heard the A.A. message of recovery and hope.

The committee recognizes that Self-Support and the spiritual principle of sacrifice on which it is based must be continually communicated.

- The committee reviewed the action taken by the 1997 General Service Conference concerning the board policy that states:

Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined.

The 1997 General Service Conference voted not to change this policy. With substantial unanimity, the committee felt there was no need to reconsider this decision.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2000 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board their suggestion that one item be developed: a soft-cover anthology, tentatively called *AA Around the World*, comprised of Grapevine articles.
- The committee also wished to suggest to the Grapevine Corporate Board that an anthology of letters previously published in the Grapevine be considered for publication at a future date.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee discussed suggestions for future Regional Forums and encouraged the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums to consider the possibility of having more frequent and accessible Forums within a region.

LITERATURE

- The committee suggested that the service piece developed to accompany the video *Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure* be available as a separate item.
- The committee considered a request from an area that the six-point definition of an A.A. group be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, replacing the section from Warrant Six added by the

1997 General Service Conference, and concurred with the trustees' Literature Committee's conclusion that "The A.A. Group" pamphlet remain as is.

- The committee considered a request for Conference approval of a pamphlet submitted by an area, "The Twelfth Step Call: A Brief Guide," and applauded the intent and effort put into the development of this material, but took no action on this item. The consensus of the committee was that this was a local service piece, and that A.A. members should be encouraged to do Twelfth Step work through sponsorship, workshops, and the chapter, "Working With Others," in the Big Book.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee did their inventory and felt the committee is serving a vital purpose in accordance with its scope.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee discussed the 1997 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site activity and acknowledged the effectiveness of the A.A. Web Site as a valuable Public Information tool in carrying the message and providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee thoroughly review the contents of the A.A. Fact File.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed a review of the *A.A. Service Manual*, undertaken by the Publications Department of the General Service Office, suggested a number of editorial changes and requested that a completed second draft be prepared for consideration by the 1999 Conference Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee considered a proposal to change the format or to discontinue the group directories for the U.S. and Canada. The committee felt the directories should be continued and that there should be no changes in the format at this time.
- The committee considered a request to list an on-line intergroup as an intergroup on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. The committee took no action, reaffirming Advisory Action #32 of the 1997 General Service Conference that "intergroups serving on-line meetings be listed adjacent to on-line A.A. meetings in the section on International Correspondence." The committee felt that on-line intergroups have been placed in the appropriate place in the directories.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed creating a list of suggested goals for Treatment Facilities committees and requested that the committee secretary distribute a preliminary list of suggested goals for Treatment Facilities committees to all delegates and Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople on G.S.O.'s mailing list.
- The committee discussed Area Temporary Contact/Bridging the Gap efforts and shared on a wide range of experience and suggested that this experience be included in a future edition of *Box 4-5-9* and be added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

- The committee discussed Treatment Facilities Activity Reports from the Treatment Facilities coordinator to all Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople and asked that these reports also continue to be sent to area delegates. The committee requested that the committee secretary distribute the G.S.O. mailing list of Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople to all area delegates for their information, updating and review.

- The committee discussed the results of the November 1997 request to Treatment Facilities committees for sharing on carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals. The committee noted that these responses represented a wide variety of personal experience and the responses give a sense of what's happening across the United States and Canada. The committee discussed the continuing need to concentrate on this kind of sharing and exchange of information. These responses show committees at different levels of service experience. The responses appear to be an accurate inventory of the strengths and weaknesses in carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals.

- The committee requested that the summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire be condensed and rewritten for the Treatment Facilities Workbook and that this revised summary of responses be presented to the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for their review.

- The committee discussed the 1997 Policy/Admissions Committee's suggestion that each Conference committee inventory itself. As a result of this discussion and after a second review of this committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee agreed to revise the second paragraph of the Scope, "The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups in treatment facilities and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements" to read, "The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional institutional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements."

The committee also agreed that discussion of their agenda items covered all aspects of this committee's inventory.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the Treatment Facilities Workbook (three-ring binder) and Treatment Facilities Handbook with minor changes.
- The committee requested that a questionnaire be circulated to all delegates and Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople to request sharing on carrying the message into noncorrectional youth facilities and that a summary of responses be reviewed by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee and the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee consider developing a Treatment Facilities tabletop display for use by local Treatment Facilities committees.

TRUSTEES

- The committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee remove the following diversity statement from the four vacancy announcement letters for regional trustee, trustee-at-large, Class A trustee and appointed committee member:

Note: At its August 1997 meeting, the trustees' Nominating Committee expressed overall concern that, as a Fellowship, we need to be mindful of attracting women and people of color to serve the Fellowship when vacancies occur, recognizing that diversity is a key factor in the unity of the Fellowship.



While the committee recognizes the Fellowship's need to attract the most diverse and qualified trusted servants in the service structure to serve Alcoholics Anonymous, enumerating diversity in announcing vacancies is not within the spirit of A.A. unity.

- In taking the committee's inventory, it was felt that under the Composition section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure document, an attempt should be made to ensure that regions with small numbers of delegates avoid duplication on Conference committee assignments.

Under the Scope section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee expressed a desire to continue to review resumes of appointed committee members but questioned the purpose of the review.

The committee found the Procedure section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure to be acceptable as written.

- The committee discussed the demands of time and energy required to serve as a regional trustee and felt that this topic needed ongoing discussion. The committee noted with appreciation that the board was looking into restructuring the board weekends.

- With regard to future growth of the Conference, the committee thanked the trustees' Nominating Committee for their work on developing the process for requesting new delegate areas and regional realignment. This had been recommended by the trustees' Nominating Committee as follows:

- 1) After January 1, 1999, requests for new delegate areas be evaluated on an individual basis, taking into consideration conditions within both the requesting area and Alcoholics Anonymous (U.S./Canada).

- 2) The possible need for regional realignment be evaluated by following the existing "Suggested Guidelines for Changing Regional Boundaries" and that regional trustees should work together as a group to further discuss the process.

- The committee encouraged the trustees' Nominating Committee to continue to examine the role of appointed committee

members on trustees' committees. The committee would like to receive feedback for future committee discussions.

Committee Recommendations Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

LITERATURE

- That changes related to updating language in *Living Sober* be made.
- That changes related to medical and/or health information in *Living Sober* be made.
- That changes related to A.A.'s singleness of purpose in *Living Sober* be made.
- That the following insert be added to the booklet *Living Sober*, Chapter 29, "Different Kinds of A.A. Meetings" page 81, and placed after the text on Step Meetings:

"Cyberspace." With the increasing availability of the Internet, some of our members are having meetings in "cyberspace." Many of these members use this new medium to supplement their regular meetings, and some, due to either physical isolation or disability, cannot make regular meetings and find this new way of sharing to be an essential part of their sobriety.

Floor Actions Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

Floor Action #1:

That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. return the \$150,000 transportation subsidy received from the city of San Diego for the 1995 International Convention. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Floor Action #2:

That the entire book *Living Sober* be sent to a subcommittee for evaluation and possible revision. **(Not adopted)**

Floor Action #3:

That group contributions to the General Service Office be included in the directories, i.e., Eastern, Western and Canadian. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Tanya Every (Hawaii) and husband David (GV director) celebrated their 14th wedding anniversary Conference week—he gave her a jade ring and they sat together at lunch.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION**

December 31, 1997 (with comparative totals for 1996)

	<u>General Service Board of A.A.</u>			<u>A.A. World Services, Inc.</u>	<u>A.A. Grapevine, Inc.</u>	<u>Combined 1997</u>	<u>Combined 1996</u>
	<u>General Fund</u>	<u>Reserve Fund</u>	<u>Capital Projects Fund</u>				
ASSETS							
Cash	\$ 464,426	\$ 934,751		\$ 416,287	\$ 67,083	\$ 1,882,547	\$ 2,081,012
Accounts and interest receivable	435	111,120		276,349	32,225	420,129	373,063
Intercompany balances	(382,252)	(1,571,449)		400,805	1,552,896	-	-
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.				1,225,420	253,941	1,479,361	1,659,479
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.				204,701	64,049	268,750	173,662
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1998/2004 (1997 cost \$7,729,479; 1996 - \$7,225,735)		7,889,413				7,889,413	7,325,145
Fixed Assets							
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software (net of accumulated depreciation - 1997 -\$2,280,528; 1996 -\$2,026,114)			\$ 808,252			808,252	1,062,666
Deferred charges	183,117			53,010	85,117	321,244	272,832
Prepaid pension cost (Note 3)		354,754				354,754	-
Other assets				20,251		20,251	20,251
Total Assets	<u>265,726</u>	<u>7,718,589</u>	<u>808,252</u>	<u>2,596,823</u>	<u>2,055,311</u>	<u>13,444,701</u>	<u>12,968,110</u>
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable	195,963			480,440	140,113	816,516	530,130
Accrued royalties				154,421		154,421	161,020
Deferred income							
Orders and subscriptions	12,750			31,752	1,493,428	1,537,930	1,494,817
Accrued postretirement health benefit obligation (Note 5)		2,177,767				2,177,767	1,923,912
Total Liabilities	<u>208,713</u>	<u>2,177,767</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>666,613</u>	<u>1,633,541</u>	<u>4,686,634</u>	<u>4,109,879</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>5,540,822</u>	<u>808,252</u>	<u>1,930,210</u>	<u>421,770</u>	<u>8,758,067</u>	<u>8,858,231</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>265,726</u>	<u>7,718,589</u>	<u>808,252</u>	<u>2,596,823</u>	<u>2,055,311</u>	<u>13,444,701</u>	<u>12,968,110</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

COMBINED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 1997 (with comparative totals for 1996)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Combined 1997	Combined 1996
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund		English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 9,221,300	\$ 2,198,367	\$ 62,408	\$ 11,482,075	\$ 11,206,835
Less: Discounts				323,022	40,354	-	363,376	806,540
Net Sales				8,898,278	2,158,013	62,408	11,118,699	10,400,295
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(3,072,175)	(441,992)	(38,077)	(3,552,244)	(3,904,741)
Royalties on books				(751,780)	-	-	(751,780)	(762,446)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(829,915)	(465,891)	(27,081)	(1,322,887)	(1,424,741)
Gross Profit from Literature				4,244,408	1,250,130	(2,750)	5,491,788	4,308,367
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 3,854,627						3,854,627	3,912,718
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	1,410	\$ 482,995		2,536	84,380	-	571,321	379,919
Total Income	3,856,037	482,995		4,246,944	1,334,510	(2,750)	9,917,736	8,601,004
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	3,603,539			1,289,451	743,837	99,389	5,736,216	5,986,432
Supporting services	2,340,500	(100,899)	\$ 254,414	1,114,437	673,232	-	4,281,684	4,137,781
Total Expenses	5,944,039	(100,899)	254,414	2,403,888	1,417,069	99,389	10,017,900	10,124,213
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR BEFORE CUMULATIVE EFFECTS OF ACCOUNTING CHANGES	(2,088,002)	583,894	(254,414)	1,843,056	(82,559)	(102,139)	(100,164)	(1,523,209)
Fair value of investments (Note 2)								286,757
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,088,002)	583,894	(254,414)	1,843,056	(82,559)	(102,139)	(100,164)	(1,236,452)
INTERCOMPANY DONATIONS AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS	2,088,002	(539,851)	-	(1,868,002)	217,712	102,139	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	44,043	(254,414)	(24,946)	135,153	-	(100,164)	(1,236,452)
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	5,496,779	1,062,666	1,955,156	286,617	-	8,858,231	10,094,683
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	5,540,822	808,252	1,930,210	421,770	-	8,758,067	8,858,231

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

COMBINED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 1997 (with comparative totals for 1996)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	1997 Total	1996 Total
Salaries	\$ 569,440	\$ 685,259	\$ 115,098		\$ 82,362	\$ 806,859	\$ 371,847	\$ 57,131	\$ 1,852,169	\$ 4,540,165	\$ 4,517,966
Payroll taxes	44,051	51,356	7,680		5,876	59,023	27,016	4,797	139,372	339,171	370,940
Health and group insurance	124,368	90,101	12,525		9,380	120,026	58,127	17,994	366,904	799,425	823,429
Retirement expense (Note 3)	27,345	31,219	4,734		4,098	36,228	19,309	960	131,858	255,751	342,558
Other program printing	245,034	43,258	42,073	\$595	6,598	0			118	337,676	339,380
Mailing labor	131,064	6,082	686		5,849	3,084			879	147,644	116,278
Postage and express	219,722	63,782	17,966		20,897	10,073	18,695		29,805	380,940	377,203
Writers fees	50,009	70,243	6,310		2,835	0			0	129,397	126,897
Foreign literature assistance		64,887							0	64,887	136,805
Selling expenses						73,153	101,643	7,860	0	182,656	281,963
Professional fees									181,980	181,980	141,829
Contracted services	4,322	66,432	3,569		6,421	15,043	1,652		57,248	154,687	121,039
Occupancy	82,281	77,570	6,205		4,596	106,067	67,929		292,497	637,145	606,254
Telephone	24,903	18,345	3,045	35	2,115	22,063	11,541		59,081	141,128	130,422
Equipment maintenance	3,827	2,970				4,192			52,805	63,794	51,596
Furniture and equipment	345	225				5,022		7,629	73,836	87,057	109,909
Stationery and office supplies	47,363	4,117	5,791	565	10,806	3,572	33,039		87,230	192,483	192,601
Office service and expense	6,208	12,441	12,596	225	3,988	11,279	33,039	1,858	154,208	235,842	254,545
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,166	38,830	319,341	758	52,655	13,767		581	360,476	787,574	887,947
Bad debts & misc.								579	16,489	17,068	28,292
Delegate fees			(83,299)							(83,299)	(212,002)
Total Operating Expenses	1,581,448	1,327,117	474,320	2,178	218,476	1,289,451	743,837	99,389	3,856,955	9,593,171	9,745,851
Severance benefits (Note 3)									271,214	271,214	151,368
Postretirement health benefits									253,855	253,855	(27,419)
Depreciation									254,414	254,414	254,413
Retirement expense adjustment (Note 3)									(354,754)	(354,754)	-
Total Expenses	1,581,448	1,327,117	474,320	2,178	218,476	1,289,451	743,837	99,389	4,281,684	10,017,900	10,124,213
Allocation of supporting services to activities	1,094,522	918,500	328,278	1,507	151,208	1,114,437	673,232	-	(4,281,684)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,675,970	2,245,617	802,598	3,685	369,684	2,403,888	1,417,069	99,389	-	10,017,900	10,124,213
Services	\$2,675,970	\$2,245,617	\$802,598	\$3,685	\$369,684					\$6,097,554	\$6,303,551
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	\$2,403,888	-	-	-	2,403,888	2,305,196
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,417,069	\$99,389	-	1,516,458	1,515,466
										10,017,900	10,124,213
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 1996	\$2,879,910	\$2,258,497	\$774,513	\$39,738	\$350,893	\$2,305,196	\$1,388,173	\$127,293	-	\$10,124,213	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Combined Statement of Cash Flows
Year Ended December 31, 1997
(with comparative totals for 1996)

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>1997</u>	<u>1996</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ (100,164)	\$ (1,236,452)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(63,744)	(105,699)
Amortization of bond premiums	4,125	5,478
Depreciation	254,414	254,413
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(47,066)	(11,470)
Inventories	85,030	(91,741)
Deferred charges and other assets	(48,412)	(64,163)
Accounts and accruals payable	279,787	(289,365)
Deferred income	43,113	160,681
Prepaid pension cost	(354,754)	-
Postretirement health benefits obligation	253,855	(27,419)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (Used)</u>		
<u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>306,184</u>	<u>(1,405,737)</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Proceeds from sales of investments	2,250,000	3,000,000
Purchases of investments	(2,754,649)	(2,751,016)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>(504,649)</u>	<u>248,984</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in cash	(198,465)	(1,156,753)
Cash, beginning of year	2,081,012	3,237,765
Cash, end of year	<u>1,882,547</u>	<u>2,081,012</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 5, 1998

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying combined statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1997 and the related combined statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the combined financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 1997 and the combined changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO COMBINED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 1997

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND—This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. That committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating

entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held as a deferred liability for subscribers reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND—This fund was established in 1990 to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The GENERAL FUND—This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges for donations, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received. Fund-raising costs are considered to be immaterial.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the combined totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

The combined financial statements include certain prior year summarized comparative information. Such information does not include sufficient detail to constitute a presentation in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles. Accordingly, such information should be read in conjunction with the Organization's financial statements for the year ended December 31, 1996, from which the summarized information was derived.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at cost under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Fixed Assets: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1997 and the accumulated reserves for depreciation at that date:

	<u>Life</u>	<u>Cost</u>	<u>Current Year</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Leasehold improvements				
	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$1,625,457		\$ 171,100
\$ 983,829				
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	83,314	522,974
Computer—hardware	5 Years	502,054		502,054
—software	5 Years	271,671		271,671
		<u>3,088,780</u>	<u>254,414</u>	<u>2,280,528</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes normally held to maturity.

Prior to 1996, the investments were carried at amortized cost. Effective in 1996, however, Statement of Financial Accounting Standards No. 124 required such investments to be recorded at fair value. The difference between cost (\$7,473,908) and fair value (\$7,760,665) at January 1, 1996 of \$286,757 has been recorded in the combined statement of activity as the cumulative effect of a change in accounting principle.

Investment income for 1997 and 1996 is comprised of the following:

	<u>1997</u>	<u>1996</u>
Interest	\$511,065	\$563,690
Realized gains on redemptions	3,220	6,289
Change in unrealized gains	60,524	(187,347)
Investment expenses	(3,488)	(2,713)
	<u>571,321</u>	<u>379,919</u>

Functional Expenses: The combined statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the combined statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services." Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the *Box 4-5-9* newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French-speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human

resources and other miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statements of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Prior to 1997, pension expense had been consistently reported as the contributions made to actuarially fund plan benefits. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement NO. 8 in 1966.

Effective in 1987, Statement of Financial Accounting Standards No. 87 ("SFAS 87"), introduced the concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirement. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan is considered to be over-funded or under-funded. It was clear from the actuarial data that there was no unfunded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Also, at that time, the actuaries stated that the difference in expense between the actuarial funding requirement and SFAS 87 periodic pension cost would not be material. Therefore, since management believed that the actual cash expenditure to fund the pension was the more relevant measure of retirement costs, no changes were made to the previously established accounting and reporting practices for pension expense through the end of 1996.

By 1997, however, as a result of substantial investment returns earned on the assets of the Retirement Plan in recent years, the assets of the Plan had grown faster than the obligation to provide for pension benefits. As a result, there was now a substantial difference between the actuarial funding requirement and net periodic pension cost calculated under SFAS 87. Accordingly, SFAS 87 was adopted on January 1, 1997.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are still recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic

pension cost under SFAS 87 has been recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

Net periodic pension cost for 1997 is comprised of the following:

Service cost	\$396,629
Interest cost on projected benefits obligation	563,052
Actual return on plan assets	(550,204)
Net amortization and deferral	(590,456)
Net Pension Cost	<u>(180,979)</u>
Reported as:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$173,775
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>(354,754)</u>
	<u>(180,979)</u>

The following table sets forth the Plan's funded status and amount recognized on the Company's combined statement of financial position (Exhibit A):

Actuarial Present Value of Benefit Obligation	
Vested	\$(6,082,367)
Nonvested	<u>(785,136)</u>
Accumulated benefit obligation	(6,867,503)
Present value of benefit obligation related to projected future compensation levels	<u>(1,303,244)</u>
Projected benefit obligation	(8,170,747)
Plan assets at fair value	10,856,727
Unrecognized net loss	392,395
Unrecognized prior service cost (asset)	<u>(2,723,621)</u>
Prepaid Pension Cost (Exhibit A)	<u>354,754</u>

The actuarial assumptions used in determining net periodic pension cost for 1997 were:

Discount rate	7.5%
Expected long-term return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.5%

Plan assets at December 31, 1997 were comprised as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 227,719
Common stock	5,530,614
Government bonds	2,765,744
Corporate and other bonds	2,212,650
Other investments	<u>120,000</u>
	<u>10,856,727</u>

Effective March 31, 1996, the General Service Board approved an early retirement "window" for A.A.W.S. and General Service Board employees. Employees age 55 or older with combined age and service of 64 or more are eligible. Participating employees would receive a higher pension benefit by adding five years of age up to age 65, and a temporary Social Security supplement up to age 62. Severance pay was also provided based on years of service, and was borne by the General Service Board.

The program was voluntary. The original ending date of the window of September 30, 1996 was extended to September 30, 1997.

Severance benefits under this program of \$178,967 and \$151,368 were incurred in 1997 and 1996, respectively. In addition, \$92,247 of severance costs were incurred by the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. in 1997, so that \$271,214 has been reported on Exhibit C.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 1997, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$347,275 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective July 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

\$129,116 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective June 1, 1995 through September 30, 2001.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1997 is \$1,786,000.

The rent expense for the years ended December 31, 1997 and 1996, was as follows:

	1997	1996
Total Rent Expense	<u>\$607,200</u>	<u>\$585,100</u>
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$153,700	\$148,100
General Service Board	362,400	349,200
A.A. Grapevine	<u>91,100</u>	<u>87,800</u>
	<u>607,200</u>	<u>585,100</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 7.5% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the reconciliation of the plan's liability for 1997:

Liability - beginning of year		\$1,923,912
Service cost	\$ 213,389	
Interest (at 7.5% discount rate)	<u>144,293</u>	cost
	357,682	
Benefit payments	<u>(103,827)</u>	
Net change		<u>253,855</u>
Liability - end of year:		
Retirees	1,390,072	
Active employees	<u>787,695</u>	<u>2,177,767</u>

An increase of 1% in the assumed health care cost trend rate from 5% to 6% would increase the liability at the beginning of the year by \$253,935 and increase the aggregate service and interest costs for 1997 by \$33,040, so that the liability at December 31, 1997 would be \$286,975 higher, or \$2,464,742.

The postretirement health benefit obligation has been recorded by the Reserve Fund. The operating entities continue to record and expense the current net costs of retiree health insurance as paid.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Budget Highlights

1998 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 1998 sales budget of \$9,575,000 is approximately 3.8% greater than the 1997 actual results. The budget is a result of the full year effect of the May 1997 price increases described last year. Actual unit sales are estimated approximately 4% lower for 1998. Net sales after discounts allowed are projected at \$9,334,200, approximately \$436,000 greater than 1997.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately at the same level as 1997 (\$90,000 less). This represents lower unit volume of items sold. Royalties and budgeted \$76,000 less than 1997 as a result of both lower unit volume and the expiration (in October 1998) of the obligation to pay royalties to the Stepping Stones Foundation.

An increase of approximately 8% is expected in the shipping and warehousing costs anticipating increase in postage and freight. It should be noted that the 1998 budget amount of \$896,000 is \$2,000 less than 1996 actual.

Gross profit from literature, is budgeted at \$4,779,500, approximately \$535,000 greater than 1997, as result of price increases and royalty decrease.

Contributions for 1998 have been estimated at \$3,932.00, approximately a 2% increase over 1997.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$8,715,300, approximately 7.5% higher than 1997.

Total Operating Expenses for 1998 have been budgeted at \$8,477,400, approximately 1.5% higher than 1997 actual expenses.

An excess of revenue over expenses (loss) of \$237,910 is budgeted. This compares with a \$245,000 loss for 1997, \$1,264,000 loss for 1996 and a \$1,147,000 loss for 1995. These three years of losses have accomplished the goal of reducing the Reserve Fund balance to approximately 9 months.

1998 Grapevine Budget

The 1998 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for 1998 of 122,000 copies compared with the 1997 average of 120,679 copies. During 1998 the impact of higher renewals following the increase that went into effect with the May 1996 issue will peak.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,758,760 is approximately 4% higher than the \$1,689,779 in 1997 due to the price increase. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$513,000, approximately 10% greater than 1997. The Grapevine will produce a new *Best of the Grapevine, Vol. III* and new cassette tapes during 1998.

Direct Costs: Magazine direct costs are budgeted at 38.7% of income as compared with 41.9% in 1997.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items the gross profit of \$1,389,434 is 61.1% of budgeted income as compared to \$1,252,940 or 58.1% in 1997. This compares with 52.3% achieved in 1996.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 1998 are budgeted at \$1,484,000, approximately \$67,000 more than 1997 actuals of \$1,417,100.

Net Income: For 1998 net loss is budgeted at \$10,170 after interest earned as compared with a net loss of \$82,560 after interest in 1997.

1998 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture.

For 1998 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$3,706, compared with a loss of \$2,750 for 1997. Circulation for 1998 is estimated at 9,500 copies, compared with 8,391 for 1997. Total costs and expenses are budgeted at \$82,058 for 1998, compared with \$99,390 for 1997. The 1998 budget projects a net loss of \$78,352 compared with a loss for 1997 of \$102,140.

To date, the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997 and projects a \$78,352 loss for 1998.

The General Service Office 1998 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	1997 Actual	1998 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$ 9,221,300	\$ 9,574,800
Discounts allowed	323,022	240,600
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>8,898,278</u>	<u>9,334,200</u>
Cost of Literature Distributed		
Manufacturing	3,072,175	2,982,900
Royalties	751,780	675,800
<u>Gross Margin</u>	<u>5,074,323</u>	<u>5,675,500</u>
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	<u>829,915</u>	<u>895,990</u>
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	<u>4,244,408</u>	<u>4,779,510</u>
Contributions Received	3,854,627	3,932,000
Interest Income	3,947	3,800
<u>Total Revenue</u>	<u>8,102,982</u>	<u>8,715,310</u>
 OPERATING EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,787,273	3,890,500
Payroll taxes	282,387	298,000
Insurance	664,087	633,100
Retirement expense	217,689	150,025
Other program printing	337,676	393,800
Mailing, labor, etc.	147,644	152,000
Postage & express	362,244	360,700
Writers' fees	129,397	119,800
Other literature assistance	64,887	142,000
Selling expenses	73,153	85,180
Professional fees	142,399	139,500
Contracted services	149,039	164,900
Occupancy	538,697	560,900
Telephone	124,402	124,500
Furniture & equipment maintenance	63,793	62,400
Furniture & equipment	70,210	101,500
Stationery & office supplies	154,112	157,300
Office service & expense	195,615	207,175
Travel, meals, & accommodations	665,380	724,120
Bad debts	(1,123)	10,000
Severance	178,967	0
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	<u>8,347,928</u>	<u>8,477,400</u>
Income (loss) for period	<u>(244,946)</u>	<u>237,910</u>
Drawdown from Reserve Fund	<u>244,946</u>	<u>— 0 —</u>
Net income (loss) for period	<u>— 0 —</u>	<u>— 0 —</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1998 BUDGET

	1997 Actual	1998 Budget	Spanish Grapevine	
			1997 Actual	1998 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION—AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>120,679</u>	<u>122,000</u>	<u>8,391</u>	<u>9,500</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE				
Subscription income	\$ 1,682,650	\$ 1,752,960	\$ 62,400	\$ 70,506
Single copies and back issues	<u>7,130</u>	<u>5,800</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>500</u>
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,689,780</u>	<u>1,758,760</u>	<u>62,410</u>	<u>71,006</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>709,540</u>	<u>681,174</u>	<u>65,160</u>	<u>67,300</u>
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE	<u>980,240</u>	<u>1,077,586</u>	<u>(2,750)</u>	<u>3,706</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	468,230	513,126		
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>198,350</u>	<u>201,278</u>		
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS	<u>269,880</u>	<u>311,848</u>		
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>	<u>1,250,120</u>	<u>1,389,434</u>		
COSTS AND EXPENSES				
EDITORIAL COSTS				
Salaries, including temporary help	169,700	174,855	36,180	31,050
Payroll taxes and benefits	41,940	41,630	9,270	7,667
Occupancy costs	57,590	60,950	—	—
Office supplies and expenses	26,850	26,510	1,780	1,500
Product development	<u>1,650</u>	<u>2,000</u>	<u>—</u>	<u>—</u>
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>297,730</u>	<u>305,945</u>	<u>47,230</u>	<u>40,217</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS				
Salaries, including temporary help	526,060	585,017	20,950	14,285
Severance benefits	164,490	0	—	—
Payroll taxes and benefits	92,250	198,192	14,290	7,456
Occupancy costs	57,590	60,950	—	—
Office supplies and expense	39,230	42,250	—	500
Subscriber services	3,820	4,500	—	—
Selling expense — regular	65,910	125,000	7,860	12,000
— GvR program	31,910	28,000	—	—
Postage	<u>18,700</u>	<u>20,600</u>	<u>70</u>	<u>600</u>
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>999,960</u>	<u>1,064,509</u>	<u>43,170</u>	<u>34,841</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE				
Consultant fees	4,000	4,000	—	—
Insurance	2,520	2,625	200	200
Professional fees	39,580	26,000	—	—
Meetings and conferences	38,310	41,850	580	2,500
Furniture and equipment	9,220	15,875	7,630	4,000
Canadian exchange and other	<u>25,750</u>	<u>23,250</u>	<u>580</u>	<u>300</u>
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>119,380</u>	<u>113,600</u>	<u>8,990</u>	<u>7,000</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,417,070</u>	<u>1,484,054</u>	<u>99,390</u>	<u>82,058</u>
Add: Interest earned	<u>84,390</u>	<u>84,450</u>		
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>(82,560)</u>	<u>(10,170)</u>	<u>(102,140)</u>	<u>(78,352)</u>

() denotes red figures

1997 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1	Ala./N.W. Fla.	406	229	56.4%	\$30,508.26	8,083	\$3.77	59	Pennsylvania						
2	Alaska	202	88	43.5	10,426.84	3,704	2.81	59	East	1,416	718	50.7%	\$119,425.57	33,559	\$3.55
3	Arizona	792	374	47.2	72,752.31	17,130	4.24	60	West	767	377	49.1	35,135.40	11,505	3.05
4	Arkansas	246	126	51.2	15,316.63	4,383	3.49	61	Rhode Island	253	103	40.7	13,187.28	5,915	2.22
	California							62	South Carolina	301	196	65.1	31,657.02	6,537	4.84
5	Southern	1,943	732	37.6	110,569.64	60,466	1.82	63	South Dakota	162	55	33.9	3,634.47	3,635	0.99
6	N. Coastal	1,928	1,075	55.7	179,811.48	63,431	2.83	64	Tennessee	476	228	47.8	32,802.59	10,905	3.00
7	N. Interior	704	336	47.7	44,512.59	19,416	2.29		Texas						
8	San Diego/Imp.	829	365	44.0	54,016.87	25,732	2.09	65	Northeast	449	191	42.5	45,394.97	17,645	2.57
9	Mid-South	1,783	673	37.7	98,350.98	58,036	1.69	66	Northwest	237	82	34.5	14,824.01	7,316	2.02
10	Colorado	629	353	56.1	52,149.86	15,265	3.41	67	Southeast	500	231	46.2	38,905.95	15,600	2.49
11	Connecticut	1,398	535	38.2	63,471.15	34,488	1.84	68	Southwest	466	207	44.4	35,928.33	11,123	3.23
12	Delaware	198	122	61.6	21,796.41	3,267	6.67	69	Utah	269	151	56.1	25,347.88	5,307	4.77
13	D.C.	449	214	47.6	39,118.59	14,664	2.66	70	Vermont	228	96	42.1	9,841.31	4,407	2.23
	Florida							71	Virginia	1,161	621	53.4	82,838.12	22,662	3.65
14	North	636	353	55.5	64,056.92	14,621	4.38	72	Washington West	1,076	516	47.9	85,297.25	24,177	3.52
15	South/Bahamas	1,531	791	51.6	127,300.02	32,610	3.90	73	West Virginia	294	120	40.8	10,260.90	3,445	2.97
	V.I.								Wisconsin						
16	Georgia	707	445	62.9	65,755.40	17,031	3.86	74	N. Wis./Upper	602	268	44.5	22,777.76	9,770	2.33
17	Hawaii	291	167	57.3	26,052.37	5,584	4.66		Pen. Mich.						
18	Idaho	196	97	49.4	9,410.96	3,247	2.89	75	South	955	438	45.8	41,475.57	18,679	2.22
	Illinois							76	Wyoming	104	53	50.9	5,425.22	1,862	2.91
19	Chicago	1,176	293	24.9	45,475.74	28,059	1.62	77	Puerto Rico	140	78	55.7	6,382.67	1,750	3.64
20	North	1,031	415	40.2	40,608.89	21,321	1.90	78	Alberta/N.W.T.	574	209	36.4	27,038.09	8,472	3.19
21	South	465	179	38.4	24,476.63	7,770	3.15	79	B.C./Yukon	746	361	48.3	47,661.87	13,987	3.40
	Indiana							80	Manitoba	155	55	35.4	4,624.52	4,185	1.10
22	North	667	263	39.4	29,647.09	10,405	2.84	81	N.B./P.E.I.	208	89	42.7	6,625.63	3,486	1.90
23	South	540	246	45.5	28,714.22	10,432	2.75	82	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	265	105	39.6	8,714.38	3,696	2.35
24	Iowa	649	299	46.0	39,442.74	12,765	3.08		Ontario						
25	Kansas	352	181	51.4	27,149.41	8,835	3.07	83	East	610	247	40.4	29,340.66	15,073	1.94
26	Kentucky	619	332	53.6	53,845.83	10,108	5.32	84	Northeast	174	49	28.1	6,851.13	2,422	2.82
27	Louisiana	517	185	35.7	25,641.69	10,489	2.44	85	Northwest	92	15	16.3	2,723.51	1,577	1.72
28	Maine	480	142	29.5	12,915.67	8,184	1.57	86	West	517	186	35.9	26,038.48	10,205	2.55
29	Maryland	902	385	42.6	58,269.70	14,576	3.99		Quebec ¹						
	Massachusetts							87	Southwest	596	384	64.4	13,750.08	15,692	0.87
30	East	1,484	566	38.1	82,844.24	50,589	1.63	88	Southeast	222	130	58.6	7,055.82	3,483	2.02
31	West	252	120	47.6	16,665.71	5,375	3.10	89	Northwest	369	295	79.9	4,531.50	7,461	0.61
	Michigan							90	Northwest	421	379	90.0	5,269.40	8,529	0.62
32	Central	535	230	42.9	32,475.29	12,379	2.62	91	Saskatchewan	328	113	34.4	12,026.34	4,231	2.84
33	Southeast	682	283	41.4	51,769.51	17,159	3.01	92	Washington East	428	172	40.1	17,555.42	5,996	2.92
34	West	473	201	42.4	26,538.52	9,114	2.91		Total U.S./Canada	56,274	25,038	44.5	3,399,042.15	1,268,578	2.68
	Minnesota								Individual, in memoriam, & special meetings				184,514.12		
35	North	538	228	42.3	17,323.68	8,177	2.11		Specials				244,277.61		
36	South	997	381	38.2	49,541.22	21,774	2.27		Total for U.S. & Canada				3,827,833.88		
37	Mississippi	235	117	49.7	14,719.73	4,324	3.40								
	Missouri								FOREIGN AND OTHER						
38	East	535	276	51.5	40,492.89	8,613	4.70		A.A. On Line				1,159.14		
39	West	206	102	49.5	11,451.66	6,645	1.72		Birds of a Feather				50.00		
40	Montana	284	129	45.4	16,797.03	4,316	3.89		Correctional facility groups				45.00		
41	Nebraska	683	337	49.3	44,983.40	14,520	3.09		Foreign				22,126.80		
42	Nevada	404	169	41.8	23,318.32	8,556	2.72		Internationalists				25.00		
43	New Hampshire	563	211	37.4	22,427.53	9,317	2.40		Loners				1,158.50		
	New Jersey								Internationalists groups				150.20		
44	North	1,293	479	37.0	64,742.64	32,467	1.99		International Dr.'s in A.A.				2,000.00		
45	South	485	230	47.4	41,141.36	8,885	4.63		World Hello				78.00		
46	New Mexico	352	140	39.7	17,537.22	6,107	2.87		Grand Total				3,854,626.52		
	New York														
47	Central	735	266	36.1	35,540.40	11,973	2.96								
48	H.M./B.	749	274	36.5	24,648.09	11,721	2.10								
49	Southeast	1,767	777	43.9	155,535.47	56,031	2.78								
50	West	333	96	28.8	11,029.56	5,997	1.83								
51	North Carolina	868	470	54.1	77,630.53	14,026	5.53								
52	North Dakota	167	75	44.9	6,359.55	3,226	1.97								
	Ohio														
53	Cent. & S.E.	630	158	25.0	16,402.45	9,248	1.77								
54	Northeast	1,274	289	22.6	29,095.77	24,040	1.21								
55	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	276	117	42.3	11,974.38	3,872	3.09								
56	S.W. Ohio	512	216	42.1	30,135.92	10,455	2.88								
57	Oklahoma	377	224	59.4	28,614.65	6,480	4.41								
58	Oregon	758	364	48.0	45,395.44	14,796	3.06								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1997-1996

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada						
1997	56,274	25,038	44.5%	\$3,399,042.15 ²	1,268,578	\$2.68
U.S. & Canada						
1996	55,956	25,138	44.9%	\$3,392,480.34 ²	1,257,570	\$2.70
Increase (Decrease)	318	(100)	-0.4%	\$6,561.81	11,008	(\$0.02)

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).² Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as special, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1998 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Art Carmona
Linda Heckathorn
Dave Madison
²Eddie McGee
Jeannine Presley
Jim Skees
Jim Tallman
¹Joe Varonin

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Wilf Antheunis
Sue Felgenauer
John Gehrman
¹David Hansen
Marshall Lynn
Frank Petska
²Lisa Tyler
Marcia Walker

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Correctional Facilities

Darla Branton
Ken Brueggemann
Isadora Drayton
¹Tim Hoft
²Will Kilkeary
Bob Kosloff
Rick Swaney
Peggy Trapp

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Finance

Wayne Coull
²Tanya Every
John King
Roger Lambert
Nick Murray
Jerry Pelan
Sonny Sampson
¹John Skilton

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

¹John Admire
Cesar Borri
Robert Caron
²Michaelene Fortner
Nat Hemenway
B.J. Kristiansen
Bob McKimm
Sallye Ann Martinez

Secretary: Cynthia Keyworth

Literature

Susie Ardolf
Ginger Bell
²Rod Betonney
John Egan, Jr.
Christine Hofer
Jerry Honeycutt
Jeff Osuch
¹Jane Sheppard
Jim West

Secretary: Doug Richardson

Policy/Admissions

Danie Broussard
Charlie Contro
¹Ric Downey
Loyd Gerstner
Carol Rohloff
Larry Hoult
²Keith Lake
Carl Oseen
Ron Schudel

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Public Information

Art Denning
Eric Donaldson
Tom Kraemer
¹Roberta Lindeman
Monique Noel
²Bill Reinhart
Jerry Scott
Mark Simonson
Robbie Walker

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Report and Charter

Vic Booth
Billie Bozone
John Carroll
²Dick Gallagher
Lisa Hens
Ken Knowles
¹Steve Thompson
Laura Zeitlin

Secretary: Richard Bush

Treatment Facilities

²Dave Bowman
¹Larry Cassady
Leon DeLong
Phil Ernst
Sandy Koerner
Robert Lalonde
Karl Mehrhof
Karin Nord

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Trustees

Raymond Dionne
Bill Farnsworth
¹Phyllis Halliday
Elaine Owen
Lisa Reich
Clay Rittenhouse
Gord Sytnick
Phil Von Schaff
²Mike Wise

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Eric Donaldson
Sue Felgenauer
Michaelene Fortner
¹Lisa Hens
Jeff Osuch
²Sonny Sampson
Gord Sytnick
Joe Varonin

Co-secretaries: Valerie O'Neill
Susan Ulseth

1999 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Dave Madison, Delaware	Linda Heckathorn, NW Texas
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Sue Felgenauer, So. Indiana	John Gehrman, California, Northern Interior
Correctional Facilities	Peggy Trapp, Maryland	Darla Branton, Mississippi
Finance	Wayne Coull, New Hampshire	Roger Lambert, SW Texas
Grapevine	Sallye Ann Martinez, California, San Diego/Imperial	B. J. Kristiansen, Wyoming
Literature	Ginger Bell, Washington State East	Jeff Osuch, New Mexico
Policy/Admissions	Ron Schudel, NW Ohio/SE Michigan	Carl Oseen, Idaho
Public Information	Mark Simonson, Oregon	Tom Kraemer, Saskatchewan
Report and Charter	Ken Knowles, Alaska	Billie Bozone, W. Massachusetts
Treatment Facilities	Karl Mehrhof, Arizona	Sandy Koerner, Rhode Island
Committee on Trustees	Lisa Reich, South Dakota	Phil Von Schaaf, Tennessee
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Jeff Osuch, New Mexico	Gord Sytnick, Manitoba

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment and not a primary committee assignment.

⁴The 1998 Committee chairs rotated at the end of the 48th General Service Conference.

1998 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Robert Miller, D.D. *chairperson*
William Bungay
Linda Chezem
Tom Maguire
Gerry Ouellette
MaryJane Roy
Betty Stevens
Greg Tobin
Judith Santon, *secretary*

Conference

William Bungay, *chairperson*
Jackie Johnston
Art Knight
Tom Maguire
Jack Ostrem
Julian Rhinehart
Richard Roughton
Betty Stevens
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John N. Chappel, M.D.,
chairperson
Carl Budd
William Bungay
Linda Chezem
John Koster
*Robert McCoy
Robert Miller, D.D.
Peter Roach
Betty Stevens
*Patricia Walters
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Carl Budd, *chairperson*
John N. Chappel, M.D.
Linda Chezem
Chuck Crist
*Mark Gornik
*Bruce Henry
Jack Ostrem
Betty Stevens
Ray Stiver
*Sharon Stone
Warren Stafford, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Art Knight, *chairperson*
Chuck Crist
Michel Girard
Gerry Ouellette
Julian Rhinehart
MaryJane Roy
Greg Tobin
Dennis Manders,
senior advisor
Kevin Sunkel, C.P.A.,
independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Michel Girard, *chairperson*
John N. Chappel, M.D.
David Every
John Koster
Robert Miller, D.D.
Gerry Ouellette
Dean Rinehart
Peter Roach
Richard Bush, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Garry McAuley,
chairperson
Carl Budd
Linda Chezem
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Jackie Johnston
Jack Ostrem
Dean Rinehart
Peter Roach
Greg Tobin
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*
—*International Conventions*
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*
—*Regional Forums*

Literature

Julian Rhinehart, *chairperson*
*Frank Berls
William Bungay
*Jim Clough
David Every
Jackie Johnston
Arthur Knight
Garry McAuley
Richard Roughton
Ray Stiver
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Nominating

Elaine Johnson, Ph.D., *chairperson*
Michel Girard
Art Knight
Garry McAuley
Robert Miller, D.D.
Julian Rhinehart
Richard Roughton
MaryJane Roy
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Public Information

Jack Ostrem,
vice-chairperson
*Tony Hurley
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
John Koster
*Lindajo Loftus
Tom Maguire
*Jim Puckett
Dean Rinehart
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Peter Roach,
chairperson
John N. Chappel, M.D.
*Paul Cleary
Chuck Crist
David Every
*Martha Lewis
Dean Rinehart
Peter Roach
Ray Stiver
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Tom Maguire, *chairperson*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Gary Glynn

First vice-chairperson
John N. Chappel, M.D.

Second vice-chairperson
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.

Secretary
Julian Rhinehart

Treasurer
Art Knight

Assistant secretary
Lois Fisher

Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 34



*Denotes appointed committee members

** Gary Glynn and George Dorsey are ex officio members of all committees.

1998 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Gary A. Glynn (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1997 Conference. He has been a member of the board since 1993 and has served as treasurer of the General Service Board, as well as chair of the Finance & Budgetary Committee. A graduate of the University of Vermont and the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for 25 years, and is active in various professional organizations and committees.

John N. Chappel, M.D. (School of Medicine, University of Nevada, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine, since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities and International Committees.

Linda L. Chezem, J.D. (530 Denny Dr., Mooresville, IN 46158) was elected to the board in April 1997. A graduate of Indiana University School of Law, Linda is a former judge, Court of Appeals of Indiana. She started the first certified court alcohol and drug program in Indiana, and has conducted seminars and written articles on such subjects as DWI, family and addiction. Linda serves on the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Communities and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Catonsville, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. A graduate of Morgan State University and the University of Maryland, Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is professor of social work at Morgan State University, Baltimore, Maryland, and is a past director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, which is a component of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services. Elaine chairs the Nominating Committee and also serves on the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr. (560 Stockbridge Court, Lake Forest, IL 60045-2680) was elected to the board in 1995. Art's professional background is in the field of business, where he has held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies. He is a graduate of Dartmouth College and holds an M.B.A. from the University of New York, Buffalo. While Art is no longer involved in day-to-day business operations, he serves on a variety of business, professional and civic boards. He is treasurer of the General Service Board, chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and also serves on the Conference, Literature and Nominating Committees.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (Episcopal Diocese of Alabama, 521 N. 20th St., Birmingham, AL 35203) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama in 1988, Bob has served as deacon and rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees. Bob chairs the Archives Committee and also serves on the

Cooperation With the Professional Community, International and Nominating Committees.

Peter Roach (1332 Edmison Dr., Peterborough, ON K9H 6V3, Canada) was elected to the board in 1994. Peter has been an elementary and secondary school teacher. When he retired in 1992, he had completed 18 years as director of education for Peterborough Separate School Board. Since his retirement he is involved extensively in the community by serving on the Hospital Board, United Way, the Ontario Superannuated Teachers' Board and on a standing committee of the Community College. He is also chair of the Pastoral Council for his parish. Peter chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and also serves on International, International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Cooperation With the Professional Communities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Carl Budd (1405 Collins St., Rock Springs, WY 82901) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 1996. A Panel 30 delegate, Carl has remained active in his area, particularly in collecting material for the area archives. After many years in the oil and gas industry, he retired in 1995 from the Department of the Interior, after 14 years of service. Carl chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

William Bungay (24 Johnson's Ave., Corner Brook, Newfoundland, A2H 1V8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1994. Bill, a Panel 39 delegate, has a background in accounting and business. He chairs the Conference Committee and also serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Archives and Literature Committees.

Chuck Crist (3227 E. Cedarwood Lane, Phoenix, AZ 85044) was elected general service trustee in April 1996, after serving three years as a director on the Grapevine Board. Chuck, a Panel 40 delegate, works in the computer field. He chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board and is a member of the Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Michel Girard (67, Aubert Blvd., Repentigny, Quebec, J6A 4N9, Canada), a Panel 42 delegate, was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 1995. He has been active in service in his area and served on the boards of A.A. French Publications and *La Vigne*. Michel is now retired from a 30-year position with a telecommunications company. He chairs the International Committee and also serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Garry McAuley (6115-51 Avenue, Stettler, Alberta, T0C 2L2, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1996. A Panel 40 delegate, he was safety and environmental advisor for a processing plant of a petroleum company and retired in 1997. Garry chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and also serves on the Literature and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Tom Maguire (941 Pineview Circle, Live Oak, FL 32060) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. Tom served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He is general manager for a national radio network, and has had a long

¹ Rotating at the close of the 1998 Conference meeting.

career in television station management. He is a member of the Archives, Conference and Public Information Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Raul Marin, deceased, of San Antonio, TX, was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 1995. Raul was long active in the Southwest Texas Area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area chair and delegate (Panel 30), and was involved in starting bilingual Spanish groups, conferences and intergroups. Raul was an architect, semi-retired when he joined the board. He chaired the Public Information Committee and served on the International and Nominating Committees and was a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board. Raul's last service commitment was to chair the Southwest Regional Forum last December, through ill at the time. He died March 5, 1998.

Jack L. Ostrem (913 Grand Blvd., Joliet, IL 60436) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate, Jack has long been active in his area, especially in corrections service work. Now retired, his major occupation for many years was in warehouse management. Jack serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Conference, and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Julian Rhinehart (1127 Seno Court, Boulder City, NV 89005) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1994. Julian was a Panel 41 delegate, where he chaired the Conference P.I. Committee. He has long been active in area service. Retiring from the Federal Government in 1994 after a 25-year career in public relations, he now does freelance writing and consulting work. Julian chairs the Literature Committee and also serves on the Conference, Finance & Budgetary, and Nominating Committees.

Dean Rinehart (613 Matthews, El Reno, OK 73036) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1997. As a Panel 37 delegate, he chaired the Grapevine Conference Committee, and has continued to be active in service work in the area and region. A practicing attorney, Dean is also engaged in cattle and farming activities. He serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Public Information, Treatment Facilities, and International Committees.

MaryJane Roy (430 Moonstone Beach Rd., Wakefield, RI 02879) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1995. MaryJane began her service work in young people's groups, local central offices and at the group level. She was a Panel 42 delegate, and chaired the Conference C.P.C. Committee. MaryJane, a physician's assistant, is clinical director of a vascular lab. She chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and also serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary, and Nominating Committees.

Richard Roughton (1250 N. Dearborn Pkwy., Apt. 14-B, Chicago, IL 60610) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate from Rhode Island, Richard served as a non-trustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board, 1993-1997. He has a Ph.D. in history and is dean of Continuing Education at a college in the Chicago area. Richard serves on the Literature, Nominating, and Conference Committees.

Elizabeth (Betty) Stevens (1420 Nunemaker Dr., Columbia, SC 29210) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 31 delegate, Betty has held various service positions in her area and currently is active in committee work for her local intergroup. Now retired, she has worked in EAP and as an alcoholism counselor. Betty serves on the Archives, Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 1998 Conference

Class A

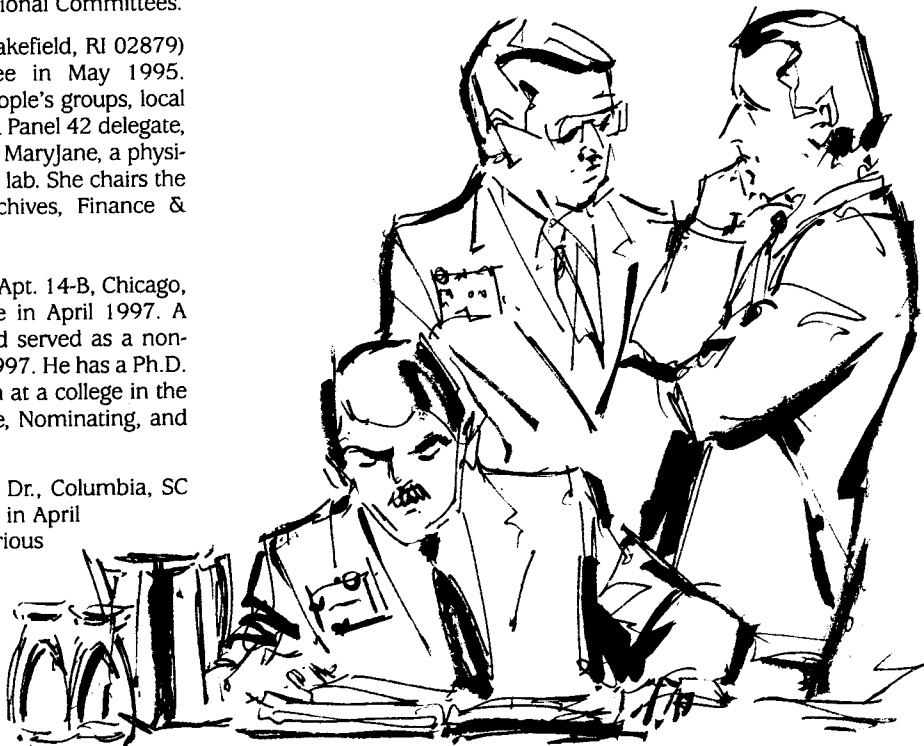
George E. Vaillant, M.D. (Brigham and Women's Hospital, 75 Francis St., Boston, MA 02115) was elected to the board in 1998. A graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and on the faculty of Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. He has lectured widely and is the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction.

Class B

Jim Clough (1201 Kings Rd., Newport Beach, CA 92663) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 42 delegate, Jim has been active in his area and has served as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee. A retired naval architect and marine engineer he is currently co-owner of a company involved in the publishing, wholesaling, and retailing of art.

Marne Hill (270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 3T3) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 41 delegate she has held many service positions at the local and area level, including Area 85 archivist. Marne, whose background is in banking, is currently a financial planner.

Jacqueline Johnston (1169 Nottingwood Circle, Westlake Village, CA 91361) was elected general service trustee in April 1998, after serving as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Jackie has been active for many years in area and district service work and was Panel 41 delegate from Southern California. Now retired, she worked as a C.P.A. for a national accounting firm in both New York and California, and as a teacher in Los Angeles.



A.A. World Services Directors

MaryJane Roy, *chairperson, regional trustee*
George Dorsey, *G.S.O. general manager*
Michel Girard, *trustee-at-large/Canada*
Jacqueline Johnston, *nontrustee director*

Garry McAuley, *regional trustee*
John Koster, *nontrustee director*
Gerard Ouellette, *nontrustee director*
Richard Roughton, *general service trustee*
Lois Fisher, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Chuck Crist, *chairperson, general service trustee*
Carl Budd, *regional trustee*
David Every, *nontrustee director*
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D., *Class A trustee*

Thomas Maguire, *general service trustee*
Ray Stiver, *nontrustee director*
Greg Tobin, *nontrustee director*
Ames Sweet, *Grapevine executive editor*

General Service Office Staff

George Dorsey, *general manager*
Tom Jasper, *services director*
Adrienne Brown
Richard Bush
Lois Fisher
Joanie Moncrief

Daniel Mooney
Valerie O'Neill
Doug Richardson
Eva Sanchez
Warren Stafford
Susan Ulseth

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet, *executive editor*

Cynthia Keyworth, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
Daniel Brown, *typesetter*
Angel Calvillo, *translator*
Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*
Yee Eng, *staff assistant*
Lourdes Figueroa, *staff assistant*
Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
Mara Hennessey, *GV executive secretary*
Elaina Johnson, *staff assistant*
John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
Steve Linek, *general office clerk*
Vanessa Luyando, *receptionist*
Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor, finance committee*
Jaime Manrique, *GV Spanish-language editor*
Lynda Maziarz, *staff assistant*
Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
Lilianna Murphy, *information services manager*
Paul Murphy, *GV editorial staff asst.*
Ramona Ortiz, *staff assistant*
Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
Miguel Rodriguez, *general office clerk*
Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
Judit Santon, *archivist*
Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
Bob Slotterback, *GV assistant controller*
Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
Stephen Turchyn, *data processing supervisor*
Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 48th Conference includes Panel 47 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 48 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	47	Charles (Mike) Wise 4621 Bridgedale Rd. Pensacola, FL 32505
Alaska	2	48	Ken Knowles Box 1934 Kodiak, AK 99615
Arizona	3	48	Karl Mehrhof 8841 W. Port Royale Lane Peoria, AZ 85381
Arkansas	4	47	William (Bill) Reinhart 2003 McCracken Stuttgart, AR 72160
California Southern	5	47	Joseph (Joe) Varonin 16738 Tiara Court Canyon County, CA 91351
Northern Coastal	6	47	Robert (Bob) Kosloff 535 Main St., Suite 316 Martinez, CA 94553
Northern Interior	7	48	John Gehrmann 738 Anderson Rd. Davis, CA 95616-3513
San Diego/Imperial	8	48	Sallye Ann Martinez 589 N. Johnson Ave., #127 El Cajon, CA 92020-3145
Mid-Southern	9	48	Nick Murray 3505 S. Olive St. Santa Ana, CA 92707
Colorado	10	47	David Hansen 16458 Buckthorn Lane Parker, CO 80134
Connecticut	11	47	Elizabeth (Lisa) Tyler 117 Fair St. Wallingford, CT 06492
Delaware	12	48	David (Dave) Madison 1 Wellspring Dr. Bear, DE 19701
District of Columbia	13	47	John Skilton 201 Kerby Hill Rd. Ft. Washington, MD 20744
Florida North	14	47	Richard (Dick) Gallagher 410 Spring Valley Ln. Altamonte Springs, FL 32714
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	47	John King 7518 NW 41st St. Coral Springs, FL 33065-2055
Georgia	16	48	Jerry Honeycutt 4685 Kings Down Rd. Dunwoody, GA 30338
Hawaii	17	47	Tanya Every 150 Hauoli St., #203 Wailuku, HI 96793
Idaho	18	48	Carl Oseen 5275 W. Franklin Rd. Meridian, ID 83642

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Illinois				Montana	40	48	Eric Donaldson Box 165 Kalispell, MT 59903
<i>Chicago</i>	19	47	Laura Zeitlin 2214 Churchill Ln. Highland Park, IL 60035-1647	Nebraska	41	48	Kenneth (Ken) Brueggemann 6111 Belvedere Blvd. Omaha, NE 68111
<i>Northern</i>	20	48	Jerome (Jerry) Pelan 733 Park Ave. Sycamore, IL 60178-2417	Nevada	42	47	Roberta Lindeman Box 1672 Fallon, NV 89407-1672
<i>Southern</i>	21	47	Larry Hoult 14657 Grapevine Rd. Chrisman, IL 61924	New Hampshire	43	48	Wayne Coull Box 106 Salisbury, NH 03268
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	47	Gerald (Jerry) Scott 7014 Chadwick Dr. Ft. Wayne, IN 46816	<i>Northern</i>	44	47	Edmund (Eddie) McGee 239 Montgomery St., Apt. 1C Highland Park, NJ 08904
<i>Southern</i>	23	48	Sue Felgenauer R.R. #1, Box 400, Hwy. 41 Rosedale, IN 47874	<i>Southern</i>	45	48	Robert (Robbie) Walker 1346 N. Orchard Rd. Vineland, NJ 08360
Iowa	24	47	Frank Petska 814 E. Fifth St. Spencer, IA 51301	New Mexico	46	48	Jeffrey (Jeff) Osuch Box 1456 Peralta, NM 87042
Kansas	25	48	Carol Rohloff 1247 N. Emporia Wichita, KS 67214	New York			
Kentucky	26	48	Jim Skees Box 846 Elizabethtown, KY 42702-0846	<i>Central</i>	47	47	Lisa Hens 123 Myers Rd., Apt. 1 Lansing, NY 14882
Louisiana	27	47	Danie Broussard 104 Avenue C Broussard, LA 70518	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	48	*Charles (Charlie) T. Contro 219 Main St. Cooperstown, NY 13326
Maine	28	48	Elaine Owen Box 153 Morrill, ME 04952	<i>Southeast</i>	49	47	Isadora Drayton 311 Sterling Pl. Brooklyn, NY 11238
Maryland	29	48	Peggy Trapp 108 W. 39th St., Apt. 26 Baltimore, MD 21210-3116	<i>Western</i>	50	48	Marcia Walker 5 Main St., #801 Tonawanda, NY 14150-2138
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	47	Arthur (Art) Denning Box 310 Morehead City, NC 28557-0310
<i>Eastern</i>	30	47	John Egan, Jr. 20 Kendall Ave. Braintree, MA 02184	North Dakota	52	48	Loyd Gerstner 2402 S. 18th St., #6 Fargo, ND 58103
<i>Western</i>	31	48	Billie Bozone 164 Red Gate Ln. Amherst, MA 01002-1845	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central Southeast</i>	53	47	Bill Farnsworth 716 Fifth St. Marietta, OH 45750
<i>Central</i>	32	47	Arturo (Art) Carmona 1549 Jane Ave. Flint, MI 48506	<i>Northeast</i>	54	47	Bob McKimm 3378 Washington Blvd. Cleveland Hts., OH 44118-2541
<i>Southeast</i>	33	47	Christine Hofer 24434 Ann Arbor Trail Dearborn Hts., MI 48127	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	48	Ronald (Ron) Schudel 302 Parker Ave. Toledo, OH 43605-1751
<i>Western</i>	34	48	Leon DeLong 542 Fairfield Ave. Battle Creek, MI 49015	<i>Southwest</i>	56	48	Richard (Rick) Swaney 11246 Shelby-Freyburg Rd. Wapakoneta, OH 45895-8448
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	47	Steven (Steve) Thompson 12307 W. Elm El Reno, OK 73036
<i>Northern</i>	35	48	Susan (Susie) Ardolf 2992 Country Rd. 137 Waite Park, MN 56387	Oregon	58	48	Mark Simonson 1402 12th Ave. Seaside, OR 97138
<i>Southern</i>	36	47	Karin Nord 275 Shelard Pkwy., #319 St. Louis Park, MN 55426	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	48	Darla Branton 308 Lakeview Leland, MS 38756	<i>Eastern</i>	59	47	Clay Rittenhouse 541 Colwell Ln. Conshohocken, PA 19428
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	47	David (Dave) Bowman 1306 Superior Ave. Pittsburgh, PA 15212-2722
<i>Eastern</i>	38	47	Timothy (Tim) Hoft 2723 Ashrock Dr. St. Louis, MO 63129				
<i>Western</i>	39	47	John Admire 5813 Oxford Raytown, MO 64133				

* Former delegate Richard Ferrari died.

State	Area no.	Panel	
Rhode Island	61	48	Sandra (Sandy) Koerner 21 Starr Dr., #202 Narragansett, RI 02882
South Carolina	62	48	William (Marshall) Lynn 1812 Madison Rd. Columbia, SC 29204
South Dakota	63	48	Lisa Reich 1740 S. Fourth St. Aberdeen, SD 57401
Tennessee	64	48	Charles (Phil) Von Schaaf 7010 Genoa Dr. Chattanooga, TN 37421
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	47	Geoffrey (Phil) Ernst 116 N. Suttonwood Dr. Fort Worth, TX 76108
<i>Northwest</i>	66	48	Linda Heckathorn 1308 Davis St. Borger, TX 79007
<i>Southeast</i>	67	47	Jane Sheppard Box 214 Beasley, TX 77417
<i>Southwest</i>	68	48	Roger Lambert 2713 Jorwoods Dr. Austin, TX 78745
Utah	69	47	Rod Betonney 10026 Opal Circle Sandy, UT 84094
Vermont	70	48	Nathaniel (Nat) Hemenway Box 6 Strafford, VT 05072
Virginia	71	47	Michaelene Fortner 8654 Poplar Springs Dr. Gloucester, VA 23601
Washington			
<i>East</i>	92	48	Ginger Bell 3473-B E. Jumpoff Joe Rd. Valley, WA 99181
<i>Western</i>	72	47	Phyllis Halliday 3805 Cortez Loop SW Olympia, WA 98512-7065
West Virginia	73	47	Larry Cassidy P.O. Box 307 Williamstown, WV 26187-0307
Wisconsin			
<i>No. WI/ Up. Penn. MI</i>	74	48	John Carroll 9166 River Rd. Berlin, WI 54923
<i>Southern</i>	75	47	William (Will) Kilkeary E13953 Maple Ridge Rd. Lafarge, WI 54639-8624
Wyoming	76	48	Bjarne (B.J.) Kristiansen 1224 Park Dr. Sheridan, WY 82801
Puerto Rico	77	48	Cesar O. Borri Urb. El Verde/Calle Neptuno #83 Caguas, PR 00726

CANADA

Province	Area no.	Panel	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	48	Jim Tallman 9611 86th Ave. Peace River, AB T8S 1G4
B.C./Yukon	79	47	Richard (Ric) Downey PH4 9541 Erickson Dr. Burnaby, BC V3J 7N8
Manitoba	80	48	Gordon (Gord) Sytnick Box 3 Valley River, MB ROL 2B0
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	48	Jim West 301 Heatherway, Bldg. 2, #609 Saint John, NB E2J 3R8
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	47	Charles (Sonny) Sampson General Delivery— Antigonish County Haure Bouchie, NS BOH 1P0
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	47	Wilfried (Wilf) Antheunis 33 Shaw St., Unit B Toronto, ON M6J 3T5
<i>Northeast</i>	84	47	Jeannine Presley 63 Pearson Dr. Elliot Lake, ON P5A 2X2
<i>Northwest</i>	85	47	Keith Lake RR 1, Airport Rd. Kenora, ON P9N 3W7
<i>Western</i>	86	48	Victor (Vic) Booth 44 Simcoe St. Scotland, ON NOE 1R0
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	48	Robert Lalonde 5398 Baldwin Montreal, PQ H1K 3B5
<i>Southeast</i>	88	47	Raymond Dionne 21, Route De La Greve Saint-Denis, PQ GOL 2R0
<i>Northeast</i>	89	47	Robert Caron 3443 Sarnia Ste-Foy, PQ GIX 2K5
<i>Northwest</i>	90	48	Monique Noel 2 Chemin Mullen L'Annonciation, PQ JOT 1T0
Saskatchewan	91	48	Tom Kraemer Box 121 Vibank, SK SOG 4Y0

